WEDNESDAY
October 14, 2026

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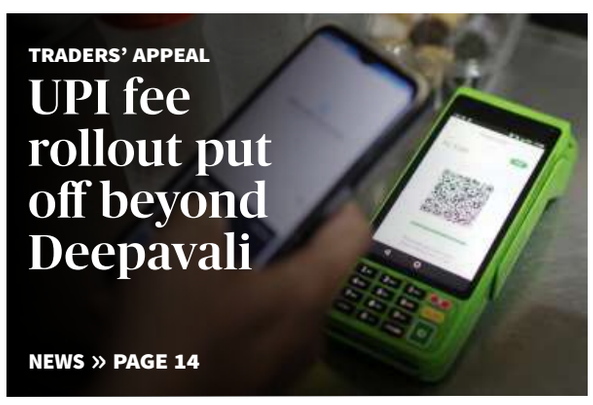
BEIJING'S STANCE

'Never recognised' U.T. of Ladakh, says China

NEWS » PAGE 14



TRADERS' APPEAL

UPI fee rollout put off beyond Deepavali

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REJIG BUZZ

Murugan exits Union Cabinet and Rajya Sabha

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INDIAN HEALTHCARE

The problem of overtreatment, overmedication

Unnecessary procedures part of the growing issue

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FOURTH T20I

Shreyas's men look to seal series against WI

SPORT » PAGE 18

NEARBY

Vijay meets Naidu in A.P., seeks more water for Chennai

VIJAYAWADA
Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Tuesday met his Andhra Pradesh counterpart N. Chandrababu Naidu and sought the release of more water to Chennai for drinking purposes. » PAGE 8

'High-cost power purchase to avoid power cuts in T.N.'

CHENNAI
Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar has said the TNPDCL had to resort to purchasing power at more than ₹30 per unit to avoid unscheduled outages. » PAGE 8

OPPORTUNITIES PAGE 5 & 19
▸ Over 45 Jobs in today's issue

Resistance will go on, says Rahul after meeting allies

Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha discusses future course of agitation against CEC and SIR over tea; representatives of political parties, civil society activists and student leaders take part

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

INDIA bloc members, student leaders, and activists after a meeting at Rahul Gandhi's residence on Tuesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

There are no parallel protests, but only one movement to restore democracy, Rahul Gandhi, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said on Tuesday as he hosted Opposition politicians, civil society activists, and student leaders for tea to discuss the future course of the agitation demanding the suspension of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Sources told *The Hindu* that leaders of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) were not present at the meeting. Mr. Gandhi's office had tried reaching out to them through an intermediary, but it did not work out. The CJP had been among the groups that issued a call for Saturday's protest, provoking a harsh police crackdown.

Mr. Gandhi, who hosted the discussion a day after a march to the Supreme Court to file a petition to halt the SIR, made it clear that political resistance will continue, regardless of the court's response. "We have extreme respect for the Supreme Court, for the Chief Justice of India, for the judicial system. They have a role to play; we hope they will play that role but we are also political people. No matter what happens, no matter which institution plays a role or not, political resistance will continue, people's resistance will continue, and it will triumph," he said after the meeting.

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GOVT. GIVEN TIME TO REPLY
» PAGE 12
MORE REPORTS ON
» PAGES 9, 12 & 13

Muslim electors over-flagged in Delhi SIR: data

CHENNAI
An analysis of draft electoral rolls in Delhi released as part of the ongoing special intensive revision has shown that the software-driven "logical discrepancies" check is flagging a disproportionately high number of Muslims. » PAGE 13

13 children killed in Bihar boat capsize

First responders gather at a local hospital after a boat capsized in the Ganga in Vaishali district, Bihar, on Tuesday night. PTI

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

At least 13 children died after a boat capsized in the Ganga in the Raghopur area of Bihar's Vaishali district on Tuesday night.

According to local people, the boat was carrying about 20 passengers from one village to another for a feast. A team rushed to the spot and started rescue operations.

All the deceased children were below the age of 15, Vaishali District Magistrate Varsha Singh said.

"We received the information around 8.30 p.m. that a private boat carrying children overturned. Seven have been rescued and their condition is stable. Rescue operation will continue throughout the night. So far, 13 bodies have been recovered," she said. The SDRF team and divers are also on site.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

HC upholds T.N. Speaker's decision on resignation of AIADMK MLAs

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Tuesday upheld the decision of Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar to accept the resignation of six AIADMK MLAs, who later joined the ruling TVK, between May 26, 2026 and June 29, 2026. But it directed him to decide within two months the disqualification proceedings pending against four of them.

The First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan said the Speaker was duty-bound to rise above his individual predilections and respect the robe which the Constitution had gifted to him.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

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Actual site image

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LIC/R1/2026-27/16/Eng

INBRIEF

B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

North Chennai gets new super-specialty hospital

VS Hospitals opened its third super-specialty hospital in the city on Tuesday. Located in Tondiarpet, the new facility is designed for comprehensive cancer care and advanced medical services for residents of north Chennai. To promote awareness and encourage early detection, the hospital will offer free breast cancer screening services until the end of this month. The hospital was inaugurated by S. Subramanian, Chairman & Managing Director of VS Hospitals, in the presence of G.K. Vasan, president of Tamil Maanila Congress. Sundar Subramanian, Medical Director; Muthu Subramanian, Executive Director; and Prassanna Srinivasan, Group Chief Operational Officer of VS Hospitals were present. The hospital now operates with a capacity of 130 beds and a team of 200 medical and paramedical professionals.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (October 14, Wednesday), the following articles are available:

- What the law says about preventive detention **newsth.live/preventivedetention**
- India's water plants are failing to catch elusive 'forever chemicals' **newsth.live/elusivechemicals**

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

HC prevents unauthorised exhibition of Rajinikanth's *Jailer 2*, Kannada film *Bail*

Justice P.B. Balaji passed the interim injunction orders on individual copyright infringement suits filed by Sun TV Network Limited and KVN Productions LLP. *Jailer 2* is releasing tomorrow

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Tuesday restrained the unauthorised exhibition of Rajinikanth-starrer *Jailer 2* and *Bail*, starring Shivarajkumar, on websites and other digital platforms, in violation of the copyrights held by the film producers, Sun TV Network Limited of Chennai and KVN Productions LLP of Bengaluru.

Justice P.B. Balaji granted the interim injunction pursuant to individual suits filed by the two production firms to protect their copyrights on their respective movies.

The judge also accepted a request made by Sun TV Network's counsel Rahul Balaji to issue the copy of the order at the earliest, since *Jailer 2* was scheduled for release on Thursday.

The counsel said those who indulge in piracy end up exhibiting movies without authorisation on digital platforms within 30 minutes of their worldwide release and hence, he required the order copy as soon as possible so that it could be communicated to all the telecommunication companies, including BSNL, Airtel, Hathway, Tata Communications, Vodafone, and Reliance Communications.

He said the order had to be communicated to cable television operators and others, especially since the plaintiff had filed a John Doe suit (a legal action initiated against unknown individuals and entities). The judge directed the Registry to issue a web copy of the interim injunction order by the end of the day.

Jailer 2 is a much-awaited multilingual sequel to the blockbuster movie *Jailer*, directed by Nelson Dilipkumar, which was released in 2023.

While Mr. Rajinikanth plays the role of a retired police officer whose peaceful life is disrupted by a gang of criminals, the sequel also stars top actors, including Vijay Sethupathi, S.J. Suryah, Mohanlal, Shivarajkumar, Ramya Krishnan, Vidya Balan, Mithun Chakraborty, Suraj Venjaramoodu, Yogi Babu, and Hrithik Roshan.

Bail, a Kannada movie directed by Pavan Wadeyar, was released in theatres on October 2, 2026.

However, KVN Productions LLP filed the present copyright infringement suit only on October 8. The suit was listed for admission on Tuesday, along with the applications for interim injunctions.

A still from the trailer of *Jailer 2*.

The judge accepted a request made by Sun TV Network's counsel to issue the copy of the order at the earliest, and directed the Registry to issue a web copy by the end of the day

TNSTC to operate 14,963 buses from city for Ayudha Puja

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu State Transport Corporation (TNSTC) would operate a total of 14,963 buses, comprising regular and special buses, from Chennai to various parts of the State for the Ayudha Puja festival, which will be celebrated on October 19.

Transport Minister A. Vijay Tamilan Parthiban, after chairing a high-level coordination committee meeting in the city on Tuesday, said 8,764 regular buses along with an additional 6,199 special buses would be operated from the city from October 15 to 18. The buses would be operated from bus termini in Kilambakkam, Koyambedu and Madhavaram, and from the bus stand in Maraimalai Nagar. Buses bound for Puducherry, Cuddalore, Tiruchi, Madurai, Coimbatore, Tirunelveli, Vandavasi, Polur, and Tiruvannamalai would be operated from the Kilambakkam Bus Terminus.

Buses bound for destinations on the ECR, Kancheepuram, Vellore, and Bengaluru would be operated from the Koyambedu Bus Terminus. The Madhavaram bus terminus would see buses plying to Andhra Pradesh via Uthukottai. From Maraimalai Nagar, buses headed for Kumbakonam, Thanjavur, and Nagapattinam would be operated.

Following Ayudha Puja, a total of 9,191 buses will be operated between October 20 and 21 for passengers from various towns to return to Chennai. Of the 9,191 buses, 4,382 are regular buses and 4,809 are special buses.

Round-the-clock control centres have been opened to provide the details of bus services. Commuters can contact 9445014436 to avail the services. A toll-free number, 1800-425-6151, has also been provided for registering complaints of overcharging.

Similarly, for Deepavali, which will be celebrated on November 8, a total of 15,659 buses will be operated from November 5 to 7, consisting of 6,573 regular buses and an additional 9,086 special buses from the city. After Deepavali, a total of 11,197 buses will be operated between November 9 and 10 from various locations towards the city.

The Minister emphasised that no excess fares should be charged and warned that strict action would be taken in the event of any violations.

Kauvery Hospital launches comprehensive suite of advanced ECMO and multi-organ life support services

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Kauvery Hospital, Vadapalani, in Chennai has launched a suite of specialised Extracorporeal Membrane Oxygenation (ECMO) services to support patients with complex clinical needs as part of a comprehensive critical care approach that considers the heart, lungs and other organs collectively.

According to a release, the hospital's Kauvery Centre for ECMO and Advanced Life Support offers a range of specialised services, including VV-ECMO for severe respiratory failure, VA-ECMO for cardiac failure, V-AV ECMO (Hybrid ECMO) for combined heart and lung failure, awake ECMO, and ECMO-supported road and air transfers. The programme is led by K. Madhan Kumar, Director - ECMO and VAD, and Senior Consultant - Cardiothoracic and Transplant Surgeon at Kauvery Hospital, Vadapalani, who currently serves as president of the ECMO Society of India.

According to the release, Dr. Kumar said, "When severe heart or lung failure does not respond to conventional treatment, ECMO provides temporary life support, allowing doctors to treat the underlying condition and assess the potential for recovery. Managing such patients often involves addressing complications affecting other organs, requiring careful monitoring and timely clinical decisions."

Aravindan Selvaraj, Co-founder and Executive Director of Kauvery Group of Hospitals, said, "Advanced critical care depends on the strength of the team behind it. The ability to manage complex conditions comes from bringing together the right specialists, technology and clinical judgement, particularly when a patient's needs change rapidly."

The hospital's Kauvery Centre for ECMO and Advanced Life Support offers a range of specialised services, including VV-ECMO for severe respiratory failure, and VA-ECMO for cardiac failure.

Govt. of Bihar

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Pre-bid meeting (Date, Time& Venue)	**28/10/2026 (Wednesday) at 11:30 AM** Conference Hall, 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Patna-800014
Last date & time for submission (upload) of online bidding document.	**11/11/2026 (Wednesday) till 05:00 PM**, on the e-Procurement Portal (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Time, Date of opening of Technical Bid	**12/11/2026 (Thursday) at11:00AM** on the e-Procurement Portal (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Time, Date of Technical Presentation	**13/11/2026 (Friday), 12:00 PM onwards** Conference Hall, 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Patna-800014
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CHANGE OF NAME

My Daughter, Chloe Chang Pou Nyuk, born on 04/12/2019, residing at Gemini Parsn Apartments, F - Block No. 32, 599, Cathedral Garden Road, Greams Road, Chennai - 600006, shall henceforth be known as Chloe Chang for all purposes, vide Affidavit No. EY 474092 dated 08/10/2026 sworn before Notary A. Thangavelu, Chennai. - Anthony Chang Mung Thow (Father)

I, NAVEEN Kumar R, son of Thiru Ravi, born on 5th March 1999. (District of Birth: The Nilgiris), residing at No. 4/495, Kagguchi, The Nilgiris–643 214, shall henceforth be known as Naveen Kumar –Naveen Kumar R

I, MOHAMED Aabid, Son of Feroz Nafeez Mohamed, having permanent address at 4/4-1, HPK Spring Apartment. Thillainayagam 1st Street, Sembium, Perambur, Chennai - 600011, hereby declare that my name has been incorrectly recorded in my passport as "Mohamed Aabid Nafeez Mohamed". My correct name as per my Birth Certificate is "Mohamed Aabid". I am applying for correction of the passport record to match my Birth Certificate. This is a correction/rectification only and not a change of name.

I, NOORJABEEN ASIUL SHAIKH, W/o: SK Hossen Ali, D.O.B.: 12.04.2005, R/o: 21/18A, Thiruvalluvar Street, Gandhi Road, Velachery, Chennai-600042, shall henceforth be known as NOORJABEEN SHAIKH

MY DAUGHTER HANIYA D.O.B. 07/03/2026 Residing at No.4, 2nd cross, Power House Colony, Krishnagiri - 635001, Tamil Nadu shall henceforth will be called as Given Name: HANIYA / Surname: SHAMEEL IMRAN - Shameel Imran (Father)

I, SARANYA PRABHU, W/o. PRABHU, born on 20/08/1986 (native district: Tanjore), residing at B1-9B, DRA Tuxedo Elite, Velachery, Chennai-600042, shall henceforth be known as SARANYA ANNADURAI. - SARANYA PRABHU

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81898 94555

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PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that our clients are in the process of purchasing the below-referred rights for multiple telecasts of the below-referred films (Films), for the period detailed in the schedule hereinbelow.

To the best of our knowledge and belief, the Film is free from any encumbrances, claims or demands, whatsoever. However, should any person(s) have claim against, to, or in respect of the Film, whether by way of any sale, lease, assignment, license, pledge, gift, mortgage, charge, sale, litigation, and/or transfer of any kind whatsoever or otherwise, such person(s) are hereby required to make the same known in writing along with documentary proof/evidence (certified true copies) of the aforesaid claim to the undersigned at the address given below, within 7 (seven) days from the date of publication hereof, failing which the transaction will be completed without reference to such claims and the claims, if any, will be deemed to have been waived. Claims without any documentary proof and / or any claims received after the expiry of the stipulated 7 (seven) days shall not be entertained.

SCHEDULE

Title of the Film	:	**Idhyam Murali**
Language(s)	:	Tamil (original), Telugu (dubbed), Kannada (dubbed), Malayalam (dubbed) and their dialects.
Star Cast	:	Atharva, Preity Mukundan & Others
Director	:	Akash Bhaskaran
Effective Date	:	85 (eighty-five) days from Theatrical Release Date (**"Pay TV Start Date"**) 6 (six) months from Theatrical Release Date (**"Free TV Start Date"**)
End Date	:	Perpetual
Territory	:	Entire World (Exclusive for India territories and non-exclusive for rest of the world)
Runs	:	Unlimited
Rights	:	Shall mean the Linear (i)Satellite Broadcasting rights; (ii) Cable TV Rights; (iii)Terrestrial Rights; (iv) DTH Rights; (v) IPTV Rights; (vi)Simulcast Rights; (vii)Subtitling Rights in English, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam & Kannada; (viii) Digital Terrestrial Television ("DTT") (ix)Syndication Rights in India;(x) Ancillary Rights;(xi) Clip Rights; (xii) Catch up TV Rights ;(xiii) Direct - to - Mobile Rights and (xiv) New Exploitation Rights & Methods.

Dated : 14th October 2026
Place : Chennai
Sd/-
Nanavati & Co Advocates
1206-1208, 12th Floor, Elite Business Park, In the lane of Shapath Hexa rights, Next to Prajapati Bhavan, Near Kargil Petrol Pump, Sola, Ahmedabad, Gujarat- 380 060.

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வாணி மஹால், தி.நகர்.

மேலும் விவரங்களுக்கு
9677761352

DAY - 01 | 20th OCTOBER

மாலை-04:30	மாலை-06:00	இரவு-07:00	இரவு-08:00	
கலைமாமணி திரு. O.S.அருண்	வேளுக்குடி ஸ்ரீ உ.வே. கிருஷ்ணன் ஸ்வாமி ஸ்ரீ சீதா திருக்கல்யாணம்	நடாதூர் உ.வே.DR.V.S.கருணாகராச்சாரியார் ஸ்ரீ ஸ்ரீனிவாச திருக்கல்யாணம்	ஸ்ரீ சரஸ்வதி நாடியாலய வழங்கும் ஸ்ரீ வள்ளி திருமணம் குரு ஸ்ரீமதி.பத்மினி கிருஷ்ணமூர்த்தி	தொகுப்பாளர் ஸ்ரீமதி. ரேவதி சங்கரன்

DAY - 02 | 21st OCTOBER

மாலை-04:30	மாலை-06:00	இரவு-07:00	இரவு-08:00
பிரம்மஸ்ரீ சட்காதர் பாகவதர் மற்றும் குழுவினர் வழங்கும் நாமசங்கீர்தனம்	ஸ்ரீமதி.U.E.சீர்த்தனா ஸ்ரீவள்ளி தேவசேனா முருகன் திருக்கல்யாணம் ஊஞ்சல்சேவை	மதுரை திரு.வெ.ராமகிருஷ்ணன் மதுரைவீரன் பொம்மி கல்யாணம்	ஸ்ரீ ஞானமுத்ரா வழங்கும் காந்தி திருக்கல்யாணம் குரு ஸ்ரீமதி அர்ச்சனா மகேஷ்

DAY - 03 | 22nd OCTOBER

மாலை-04:00	மாலை-05:00	மாலை-06:00	இரவு-07:00	இரவு-08:00
ஸ்ரீமதி. அபர்ணா ஸ்வாமிநாதன் பக்தி இசை	அக்ஷயா ஆர்ட்ஸ் வழங்கும் ஸ்ரீ ஆண்டாள் திருக்கல்யாணம் குரு திரு. பினேஷ் மஹாதேவன்	தாமல் ஸ்ரீ உ.வே.ராமகிருஷ்ணன் ஸ்வாமி ஸ்ரீ ஆண்டாள் திருக்கல்யாணம்	ஸ்ரீ உ.வே. துஷ்யந்த் ஸ்ரீதர் ஸ்ரீ ருக்மிணி திருக்கல்யாணம்	ஸ்ரீ. சந்தோஷ் சுப்பிரமணியம் மற்றும் குழுவினர் வழங்கும் பக்தி இசை

DAY - 04 | 23rd OCTOBER

மாலை-04:30	மாலை-06:00	இரவு-07:00	இரவு-08:00
கடையாலம்பூர் ஸ்ரீராஜகோபால் தாஸ் மற்றும் குழுவினர் வழங்கும் அபங்கம்	வடக்குடி பிரம்மஸ்ரீ சுந்தரராம தீக்ஷிதர் ஸ்ரீ பார்வதி திருக்கல்யாணம்	சூலமங்கலம் திருமதி.தேச மங்கையற்கரசி ஸ்ரீ மீனாட்சி திருக்கல்யாணம்	கலாசிந்து குழுவினர் வழங்கும் பரிவ்யாபி ரகுராமம் குரு ஸ்ரீமதி.சிந்து வர்மம் கிரணவ் மற்றும் சரித்ரா ராம்மோகன்

DAY - 05 | 24th OCTOBER

மாலை-04:30	மாலை-06:00	இரவு-07:00	இரவு-08:00
ஸ்ரீமதி.வினைகபுர கர்த்திக் ராஜன் மற்றும் ஸ்ரீமதி.வித்யா கல்யாணராமன் வழங்கும் பக்தி இசை	திரு. இரா. விஜயகுமார் வள்ளி திருமணம்	முதன்மை வழங்கும் ஸ்ரீ உ.வே DR. அனந்த பத்மநாபாச்சார்யார் ஸ்வாமி ஸ்ரீரங்க கல்யாணம்	ஆகம விதான மயூரி-இறைவியின் கடனம் ஸ்ரீ மீனாக்ஷி திருக்கல்யாணம் குரு ஸ்ரீமதி.காவ்யா முரளிதரன்

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INBRIEF

City hospital holds breast cancer awareness event

To commemorate Breast Cancer Awareness Month, Iswarya Breast Centre at Iswarya Hospital at Taramani in Chennai, organised a special Villupattu programme titled 'Varumunnar Kaappom'. The programme was held on Sunday and performed by Kalaimamani Bharathi Thirumagan to spread awareness on breast cancer and the importance of early detection, according to a release. Deepa Chegu, director and senior consultant at Iswarya Breast Centre, explained the available screening methods. S. Rajasundaram, Director of Oncology and CEO of Iswarya Hospital, highlighted the importance of timely medical intervention.

ICG rescues six fishermen off Mamallapuram coast

In a night maritime search and rescue operation on Monday, six fishermen were rescued by the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) off the Mamallapuram coast. After a distress call was received around 10 p.m., *ICGS Sujay*, which was on patrol, was deputed to locate the fishing boat. "The boat was approximately 15 km northeast off Mamallapuram and had sustained critical hull damage, resulting in flooding of the machinery compartment, thus posing a threat to the lives of all six crew members," a release from the Union Ministry of Defence said. The fishermen were administered first aid on the ICG vessel and safely brought to the Chennai harbour on Tuesday.

'Tender for construction of pathway for persons with disabilities is incomplete'

Activists say the tender omits essential specifications and a 7-year maintenance contract. They demand long-term maintenance planning and lifecycle budgeting for the facility

CITY MATTERS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Rain impact: The pathway at Marina beach was damaged during the 2023 monsoon, says GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran. R. RAGU

Activists have alleged that the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC)'s tender for the construction of a pathway for persons with disabilities at Marina beach remains incomplete. Activists demand long-term maintenance planning, lifecycle budgeting, and dedicated staffing for the facility.

'Build back better'

Disability rights activist TNM Deepak said they had started voicing issues about the pathway on social media. Disability Rights Alliance (DRA) member Vaishnavi Jayakumar said: "While we welcome the post-monsoon rebuilding of the Marina beach access boardwalk, it is crucial that we build back better. In July, Team DRA had requested a forensic analysis of the dismantled pathway's materials and an expert-led inspection of the Besant Nagar boardwalk. Neither has happened so far."

"The current tender is incomplete – it omits essential specifications and detailed drawings for decks, wood seasoning, joinery, and signage. It also fails to require a seven-year maintenance contract by the same contractor to ensure the quality is not affected during construction," she said.

"Without long-term maintenance planning, lifecycle budgeting, and dedicated staffing, Chennai's disabled community risks losing beach access all over again – a vulnerability already evident at the Besant Nagar boardwalk, which suffers from neglected routine repairs and a lack of staff. Constructing the pathway is only half the battle; ensuring it lasts is what truly provides equal access," said Ms. Vaishnavi.

Activist Gnana Bharathi said: "GCC officials do everything on their own. They never hesitate to spend money for the redesign or reconstruction. They justified the way the wooden planks were bound using thin nails and a little adhesive. When these things break, they are ready to spend money to reconstruct it."

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said: "The pathway for persons with disabilities at Marina beach was damaged during the 2023 monsoon and was repaired multiple times. A part of it was also damaged during the air show held in 2024. The present design and structure are finalised in collaboration with DRA and other stakeholders."

ICAR institute develops shrimp farming method to reduce cost of feed

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The technique produced naturally pigmented, premium-grade shrimp.

The ICAR-Central Institute of Brackishwater Aquaculture (CIBA) has developed a seaweed-integrated shrimp farming technology that reduces feed costs while providing farmers with an additional income from seaweed harvests.

The eco-friendly polyculture system integrates Pacific white shrimp (Penaeus vannamei) with two high-value seaweed species, Gracilaria salicornia and Gracilaria edulis. The technology has demonstrated improved growth and survival rates, reduced feed requirements and a shorter culture period, thereby lowering the cost of production.

According to CIBA, the natural grazing behaviour of P. vannamei on epiphytes growing on seaweed fronds provides an additional source of nutrition. This contributes to a lower feed conversion ratio (FCR) and produces naturally pigmented, premium-grade shrimp.

M. Kailasam, Director of ICAR-CIBA, said integrating seaweed into shrimp farming could improve water quality by absorbing excess nutrients and reducing the environmental footprint of aquaculture. As the seaweed requires no additional feed, its harvest provides farmers with an additional source of income.

K. Ambasankar, head of CIBA's feed development team, said the feeding regime in the polyculture system had been calibrated to complement the natural availability of micronutrients in seaweed-rich waters.

The system yielded 7.3 tonnes of shrimp and 1.8 tonnes of seaweed per hectare. The shrimp attained an average body weight of 20.2 grams in just 78 days. Conventional monoculture systems typically take 90 to 100 days to produce shrimps of a similar commercial size. It also resulted in a threefold increase in harvested seaweed biomass.

Hospital highlights benefits of awake spine surgery technique

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Karthik Kailash, professor and HoD, Spine Surgery, SRIHER, speaking at a press conference in Chennai on Tuesday. M. SRINATH

Experts at Sri Ramachandra Medical Centre described the advantages of awake spine surgery using percutaneous and endoscopic techniques.

Addressing a press conference here on Tuesday, Karthik Kailash, professor and HoD, Spine Surgery, Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research (SRIHER), said: "We have completed 100 cases. What makes this achievement particularly meaningful is our ability to offer spinal fusion procedures to selected high-risk patients without the need for conventional general anaesthesia. The awake spine surgery concept is used in foreign countries such as the U.S. We do the surgery when the patient is awake, particularly for high-risk patients who are unable to walk. We are able to operate and discharge them the next day."

G. Sudhir, Senior Consultant Spine Surgeon, SRIHER, said: "The same day we make the patient walk. Bone damage and muscle damage are minimal. Endoscopic spine procedures performed under awake spine surgery represent an evolving approach to minimally invasive spinal care. The procedure allows patients to remain responsive during selected stages of the procedure, facilitating real-time neurological assessment and communication with the surgical team."

"Endoscopic spine procedures also offer the biggest advantage of enhanced magnification and visualisation of the neural structures, which is vital in preventing intra-operative complications," said Dr. Sudhir. Aruna Parameswari, HoD, Anaesthesiology, said: "There is no need for expensive neuro monitoring. We just give a sedative dose, analgesic, so the patient is sleeping, if you call them, they will respond, but they won't feel the pain. The procedure is done with a combination of intravenous sedation and ultrasound-guided fascial plane blocks with continuous monitoring of the patient's vitals. It provides pain relief for 24 hours avoiding postoperative opioids, enabling early ambulation. It can be used in patients with cardiac and respiratory conditions that make them high risk for general anesthesia."

School students to have 3 PT periods a week, says Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Schools will now have three compulsory periods of physical education and two periods of extra-curricular and co-curricular activities a week, said School Education Minister Rajmohan while releasing a revised timetable on Tuesday.

Speaking to media persons, he said, "The other two periods designated for extra-curricular activities could also be converted to physical education periods, thereby ensuring that students can play all five days a week." Mr. Rajmohan thanked the Chief Minister for the decision.

The Minister was holding a review meeting with all the District Education Officers on curriculum, hygiene, and facilities of the schools in the districts.

Two men arrested for secretly filming woman

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Two domestic workers were arrested on Monday for allegedly concealing a mobile phone inside a box in a bathroom at a house in Anna Nagar East and secretly recording a 28-year-old woman taking a bath.

The arrested were Sanjukumar Tandi, 21, and Ashok Kumar Yadav, 33, natives of Bihar. According to the police, a woman was employed to take care of a child at the house. On Monday morning while using the bathroom, she noticed a hole in a box. On examining it, she found a mobile phone hidden inside, recording a video.

Based on her complaint, Anna Nagar police registered a case and arrested the suspects.

Govt. of Bihar
MINES AND GEOLOGY DEPARTMENT GOVERNMENT OF BIHAR
Email: auction.mineral-bih@gov.in

Notice Inviting Tender

"Invitation of bids for grant of Mining Lease for Iron Ore (Magnetite) minerals and Cu-Pb-Zn mineral blocks"

❖ In exercise of the powers conferred by **Section 10(B)** of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957, and in accordance with the Mineral (Auction) Rules, 2015 (as amended from time to time), the Government of Bihar hereby invites tenders for the grant of a Mining Lease through an electronic auction process for the following mineral blocks: 01 mineral block of Iron Ore (Magnetite)) and 01 mineral block of Cu-Pb-Zn (Polymetallic) for electronic auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of Mining Lease.

List of Mineral Blocks for Auction
1st Attempt Blocks

Sr. No.	Name of the Block (Block Code)	District	Mineral	Concession Type	Price of Tender Document without GST (in Rs.)
1.	Pindara Cu-Pb-Zn Magnetite Block (Block Code)	Banka	Cu-Pb-Zn (Ag)	ML	3,00,000

Note: GST on the tender document fee is payable by the bidder under the Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM)

2nd Attempt Blocks

Sr. No.	Name of the Block (Block Code)	District	Mineral	Concession Type	Price of Tender Document without GST *(in Rs.)*
1.	Majos and Bhanta Magnetite Block (Block Code)	Jamui	Iron Ore (Magnetite)	ML	5,00,000

Note: GST on the tender document fee is payable by the bidder under the Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM)

Bidding Process & Eligibility

- Bid Submission Format: Financial bids must be submitted in digital format only. Technical bids must be submitted in both digital and physical formats from eligible bidders.
- Tender Documents & Access: Detailed eligibility criteria, terms, conditions, timelines, and block summaries are available exclusively in electronic form. They can be downloaded from the MSTC Limited e-Auction Portal:

MSTC e-Auction Home

- Registration & Participation: Interested bidders must register on the MSTC portal (https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcl/index.jsp) to obtain a unique Login ID and Password. Participation in the bidding process is permitted only after the online purchase of the Block-Specific Tender Document through the portal.
- Amendments & Corrigenda: Any subsequent revisions, clarifications, addenda, corrigenda, or time extensions will be hosted strictly on the MSTC e-auction portal. No separate press notifications will be issued.
- Free Resources: The Model Tender Document and brief Mineral Block Summaries are available free of cost on the portal (https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcl/index.jsp)for initial review.

Key events and their timelines are as under:

Event Description	Date
Date of Publication of Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)	Thursday, October 15, 2026
Pre-Bid Conference	Thursday, November 5, 2026
Last date for sale of Block Specific Tender Document [on or before 17:00 hours (IST)]	Thursday, November 26, 2026
The last date for submission of the Technical Bid and initial price offer	Thursday, December 3, 2026

For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

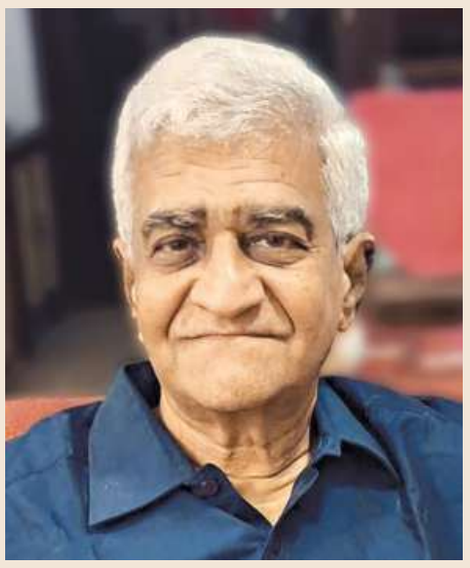
PR- 013650 (Mines) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

DIRECTOR
Department of Mines and Geology Bihar

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH



Mr. Sekhar Ramani

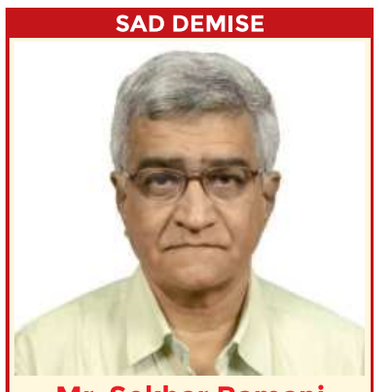
passed away surrounded by his family in the early hours of Tuesday, 13 October 2026 after a brief illness. He was 74.

Mourned by Jayanthi; Meena and Sridhar; Sriram and Dhivya; Srikrishna; and his other family, friends, and colleagues.

Contact: 9176390208

DEATH

SAD DEMISE



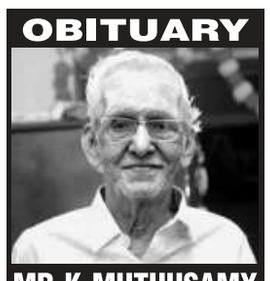
Mr. Sekhar Ramani
Director
passed away on 13.10.2026

We extend our heartfelt condolences to the bereaved family and pray for strength and courage to overcome this irreparable loss.

Deeply mourned by
Family Members, Employees of MIL family
MIL Industries Ltd
Chennai

DEATH

OBITUARY



MR.K.MUTHUSAMY

DOB: 20/06/1939 DOD: 13/10/2026

Your life is an inspiration to us & we will always cherish your loving memories. We still feel your presence around, that gives us strength to go on.

Family & Friends

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DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
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IN FOND REMEMBRANCE ON 18th ANNIVERSARY OF

M.PARTHASARATHY
Founder: MALLIKA BATTERIES
Wife & Family Members

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

Woman dies after falling through gap on 2nd floor of Thirumayilai MRTS station

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The decomposed body of a 55-year-old woman, who went missing on October 8, was found in an unused area on the ground floor of the Thirumayilai MRTS station on Monday. Preliminary investigation suggests that she may have accidentally fallen from the second floor while searching for the restroom. The deceased was identified as V. Vijaya of Balaji Nagar in Pallikaranai.

According to the Government Railway Police (GRP), a foul smell emanating from an unused area on the ground floor prompted the station manager to alert the police. The body was found around 11.50 a.m. on Monday. The Thiruvanmiyur Railway Police registered a case and initiated an investigation.

The gap in the abandoned room through which the woman fell at the Thirumayilai MRTS station.

Police sources said Vijaya's daughter had lodged a missing-person complaint at the Mylapore police station on October 8, stating that her mother went to the restroom on the second floor of the station and failed to return. The Mylapore police registered a case and launched a search to trace her. Meanwhile, the GRP recovered her body from the station.

Preliminary inquiries indicated that Vijaya might have accidentally fallen to the ground floor through an opening on the floor of an abandoned room on the second floor when she was searching for the restroom.

Blood clot near heart

A post-mortem examination was conducted at the Government Royapettah Hospital on Tuesday. According to the medical report, she had sustained rib and spinal fractures, and the cause of death was attributed to a blood clot near the heart.

After the post-mortem examination, the body was handed over to her husband on Tuesday.

Makkal Adhikaram stages rail roko, members held

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The police arrested over 50 members of Makkal Adhikaram after they blocked a train at the Egmore railway station on Tuesday.

The protesters demanded the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. They assembled on Platform 5 and staged a blockade in front of the Bikaner-Madurai Superfast Express. The police personnel removed them from the tracks and took them to a community hall. The protest delayed the train's departure by 10 minutes.

APPOINTMENT

CHENNAI METRO RAIL LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Tamil Nadu)
(ISO 9001:2015 AND ISO 14001:2015 CERTIFIED)
METROS, ANNA SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI - 600 035

EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION No: CMRL-HR-CON-DEP-06-2026 dated 14-10-2026.

CMRL invites applications from qualified and experienced personnel for the appointment of under mentioned posts on contract / deputation basis from Govt organizations:-

S. No	Name of the Post	No. of Posts	Type of Employment	Consolidated Pay for Contract / Deputation* (Per Month)	Min Exp. (Yrs)	Max Age (Yrs)	Required Qualification
1	GM (Signal & Telecom)	1	Contract / Deputation	Rs.2,25,000/-	20	55	B. E / B. Tech (ECE / EEE or a combination of any of these disciplines)
2	AGM (Safety - Operations & Maintenance)	1		Rs.1,60,000/-	17	47	B. E / B. Tech with working experience in safety organisation of Indian Railways / Metro
3	Manager (Telecom)	1		Rs.85,000/-	7	38	BE / B.Tech (ECE/EEE)
4	Manager (Electrical Traction)	1					BE / B.Tech (Electrical)
5	Manager (Electrical & Mechanical)	1					BE / B.Tech (ECE/EEE/Mech)
6	AM (Public Relations)	1		Rs.62,000/-	2	30	Graduation with PG degree in Public Relations or Communication

Note:

i) The deputationist shall have the option either to draw pay being drawn in the parent organization with deputation allowance and project allowance at 10% of Basic Pay each.
(or)
To draw equivalent cadre IDA pay scale in CMRL with IDA, HRA and Cafeteria Allowance (31.5% of Basic Pay).

ii) The detailed employment notification will be published in CMRL website under careers section vide URL: https://chennaimetrorail.org. on or before **16-10-2026.**

iii) Age, qualification & experience stipulated for the above posts should be as on **14-10-2026.** Age will be relaxed for deserving & experienced candidates.

iv) Salary is negotiable for deserving candidates.

v) Last date for receipt of online applications is **03-11-2026.**

for Managing Director
Chief General Manager (HR & Legal)
Chennai Metro Rail Limited

DIPR / 888 / DISPLAY / 2026

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Bank of Baroda
Regional Office,
(First Floor) Chennai Rural Region,
No.123, Dugar Towers, RL Road, Egmore,
Chennai- 600008.

PREMISES REQUIRED FOR BRANCHES AT PROPOSED NEW LOCATIONS

We intend to acquire premises on long lease / rental basis having clear and marketable title. The property should be commercially approved, located on Ground Floor and must be ready to occupy for our following branches.

S. No.	Branch Name	Approx carpet area
1.	Thiruporur	1000-1200 sq.ft
2.	Padappai	1000-1200 sq.ft

For details, please log in to tender section of our web site **www.bankofbaroda.bank.in** or contact us at +91 9600137161.
Last date of submission of bid : **03.11.2026, 3 p.m.**
Date : 13.10.2026 **Regional Manager**

Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Govt. of India
Khadi India

No. SOA/GVY/Tender/ 2026-27

Tender Notice

The Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC), a statutory organization functioning under the administrative control of the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, Government of India, has invited bids through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal for the procurement of Paper Conversion Machines (HMPAFI) under the Gramodyog Vikas Yojana, for distribution to beneficiaries through all offices in the Northern Region (Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8087649).

Interested bidders may participate in the tender through the GeM portal. For further details, please visit the official website of the Khadi and Village Industries Commission at **https://www.kvic.gov.in** or contact this office at telephone number **0171-2630334** or via email at **soambala.kvic@gov.in.**

The last date for submission of bids is as indicated on the GeM portal.

KHADI AND VILLAGE INDUSTRIES COMMISSION
Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises Govt. of India

State office, KVIC Ambala	राज्य कार्यालय, के.वी.आई.सी अम्बाला
103-A ,The Mall, Ambala Cantt-133001 (Haryana) Tel.- 0171-2630334, email- soambala.kvic@gov.in	103–ए, दी माल, अम्बाला छावनी–133001 (हरियाणा) Tel.- 0171-2630334, email- soambala.kvic@gov.in

THE HINDU

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Over 45 Jobs in today's issue

AI-linked job fraud on the rise

A new survey by YouGov has found that Indian employers are most likely to have discovered identity fraud among their candidates and employees, leading to an increased emphasis on trust in the workforce.

With AI-powered fraud, identity misrepresentation, and fake candidate profiles becoming more sophisticated, many Indian employers are looking for ways to mitigate these emerging threats. HireRight's research found that nearly three-quarters (74%) of HR and recruitment decision makers said they uncovered identity fraud among candidates or employees during 2025, the highest rate reported across the markets surveyed, said a release. Verifying each candidate's identity, qualifications, and employment history becomes an increasingly important part of workforce governance. According to the study, brand reputation (39%), strengthening workplace safety (36%), and identifying behaviours that conflict with corporate values (36%) are among the key risks screening aims to help mitigate. Almost half (49%) identified accuracy and quality of results as one of the most important considerations when selecting a screening provider, followed by candidate experience (36%) and speed (32%).

GENERAL

SRI KRISHNA COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY
(An Autonomous Institution, Affiliated to Anna University, Chennai, Accredited by NAAC with A++ Grade)
Kuniamuthur, Coimbatore - 641 008. Phone: 0422-2678001 to 07, Web: www.skcet.ac.in

Applications are invited from exceptionally smart, passionate, young professionals aged below fifty years who have the desire to learn and upgrade themselves for the position of

PROFESSOR / ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR / ASSISTANT PROFESSOR

- Computer Science and Engineering
- Electrical and Electronics Engineering
- Mechanical Engineering
- Management
- Information Technology
- Electronics and Communication
- Civil Engineering
- English

Qualification and Experience as per AICTE norms.
Doctorate candidates with good communication skills will be preferred.

Candidates with/without a Ph.D. and with 15 years or more of relevant industry experience are invited to apply for the position of **Professor of Practice**

Bright candidates with B.E./B.Tech. degree in the relevant discipline are invited to apply for the position of **Teaching Assistants**

Interested candidates may submit their detailed CV within 7 days to:
careers@srikrishna.ac.in

UDUPI COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED
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Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Government of India.

RECRUITMENTS

Sl. No.	Name of Posts	No. of Posts
	OFFICERS ON REGULAR BASIS FOR MALPE Ref. No. UCSL/IMS/HR/VN/F/11-AGMs(Dsn/CC)M(Hull)DMs(QC/EleDsn)/96 dated 07 October 2026	
1	Assistant General Manager (Contract cell)	1 Post
2	Assistant General Manager (Design)	1 Post
3	Manager (Hull)	1 Post
4	Deputy Manager (Electrical Design)	1 Post
5	Deputy Manager (Quality control)	1 Post
	OFFICER ON CONTRACT BASIS FOR CHENGALPATTU Ref No. UCSL/IMS/HR/VN/F/11- AM/FIN/CPT/VN98 dated 07 October 2026	
6	Assistant Manager (Finance)	1 Post
	SUPERVISORS ON REGULAR BASIS FOR MALPE Ref No. UCSL/IMS/HR/VN/F/11-SUPs(Mech/Nest)/97 dated 07 October 2026	
7	Supervisor (Nesting)	1 Post
8	Supervisor (Mechanical)	1 Post

For more details on age, qualification, remuneration, reservations, etc with regards to this advertisement visit www.cochinshipyard.in or www.udupicsl.com
Last date for Application: 28 October 2026.
Sd/-
MANAGER (HR&IR)

MOIL LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ENTERPRISE)
Registered & Corporate Office:
MOIL Bhawan, 1- A, Katol Road, Nagpur - 440013, Maharashtra.
CIN: L99999MH1962GOI012398

Recruitment under Fixed Term Employment

MOIL Ltd, Miniratna Category-I, schedule "A" CPSE under the Ministry of Steel, Govt. of India, invites applications under **Fixed Term Employment** basis as under:

Sr.	Name of the Posts	No. of Posts
1	Project Engineer (Mechanical)	2
2	Project Engineer (Electrical)	1
3	Sr. Project Engineer (Mechanical)	2
4	Sr. Project Engineer (Electrical)	2
5	Functional Consultant (SAP S/4 HANA with RISE HCM)	1
6	Functional Consultant (SAP S/4 HANA with RISE FICO)	1
7	Functional Consultant (SAP S/4 HANA with RISE MM)	1
8	Functional Consultant (SAP S/4 HANA with RISE PM)	1
9	Functional Consultant (SAP S/4 HANA with RISE SD)	1
10	Functional Consultant (SAP S/4 HANA with RISE PP)	1

For details log on to our website **www.moil.nic.in** on the link "Recruitment".
Any amendment /modification relating to this advertisement will be notified on MOIL's website only.
For MOIL LIMITED
GM (Mines)
& Addl. Charge HOD (Pers.)
PAMM

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Email: nagaraj.v@thehindu.co.in
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2-3, EVK Sampath Salai, Vepery, Chennai – 600 007.
Phone: 2532 2675, 2643 3090. email: ptleecntrust@gmail.com
Web: www.ptleecntrust.com

Applications are invited for the post of
SECRETARY
from retired State or Central Govt. servant who have held a responsible post, in the cadre of DRO, Superintendent of Police or Subordinate Judge or an equivalent post.

Apply on or before 28.10.2026 with copies of all credentials to the Secretary.
SECRETARY (FAC)

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Villankurichi Road, Civil Aerodrome Post, Coimbatore - 641 014, Tamil Nadu.
0422-2513604 | hr@tidelcbe.com | www.tidelcbe.com

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION NO. TPCL / HR / 001 & 002 / 2026

Applications are invited for the following posts only through online mode from 14.10.2026 to 03.11.2026 from eligible candidates who wish to join services in TIDEL Park Coimbatore Limited (TPCL) on contract basis:

Sl. No.	Position	No. of Post	CTC	Age as on 01.09.2026
1	Deputy Manager [Client Relations]	1 (One)	Rs.50,000/- per month	Min: 28 Years Max: 40 Years
2	Assistant Manager [HR & Administration]	1 (One)	Rs.40,000/- per month	Min: 28 Years Max: 45 Years

For detailed notification, qualification, experience, selection process, online application and other details, please visit our website: **https://tidelcbe.com / https://tidelcbe.com/en/careers**.

DIPR/880/Display/2026 MANAGING DIRECTOR

COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED
KOCHI - 15
(A GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ENTERPRISE)

No. CSL/P&A/RECTT/CONTRACT/Guarantee Engineer/2026/13 Dt : 12 October 2026

GUARANTEE ENGINEER ON CONTRACT BASIS – 1 POST (UR) AT SHIP REPAIR FACILITY IN KARWAR

Educational Qualification:
a) Pass in X Standard.
b) Diploma in Mechanical Engineering or Electrical Engineering or equivalent in Indian Navy.

Experience: Ex-Indian Navy personnel with a minimum of 15 years post qualification experience in operation & maintenance and watchkeeping of marine equipment and systems on Indian Naval Surface Ships / Submarines.

Consolidated Pay: ₹1,00,000/- per month for the first year of contract.

For more details, please read the vacancy notification on CSL website **www.cochinshipyard.in (Career page→CSL, Kochi).**

"Hindi version of detailed advertisement is published on the website (www.cochinshipyard.in) of CSL."
Sd/-
GENERAL MANAGER (HR & LD)

Continued on page 19

'Is Wetland Authority accountable to govt. or construction companies?'

Anbumani alleges that the authority has moved with 'lightning speed' to reduce buffer zone around the Pallikaranai marsh in order to protect the interests of construction firms. He demands that the government notify all wetlands across the State

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

PMK president Anbumani Ramadoss on Tuesday criticised the Tamil Nadu government on the delay in notifying the Pallikaranai marshland as a wetland and demanded that all wetlands in the State be notified.

In a statement, he said the Tamil Nadu State Wetland Authority (TNSWA) had informed the Madras High Court that the extent of the buffer zone (Zone of Influence) around the Pallikaranai marshland had been reduced to 316 acres. "The Wetland Authority has been refusing to notify wetlands, including Pallikaranai, but its speed in reducing the buffer zone apparently to ensure that construction companies do not suffer any business losses raises a serious question: is the Authority working for the Government or for construction companies?"

The TNSWA had filed a counter affidavit in the case filed by certain private construction companies, which sought the quashing of the National Green Tribunal's order dated September 24 last year, which prohibited construction activities within a one-kilometre radius of the Pallikaranai marshland. "In its counter affidavit, the Tamil Nadu State Wetland Authority stated that, at a meeting held with officials from various departments on September 30, 2026, it had been decided to reduce the buffer zone around the Pallikaranai marshland from the 8,397 acres identified by the National Green Tribunal to just 316 acres," he said. While he supports determination of buffer zone around the wetlands, Dr. Anbumani said it should be "scientifically determined".

Anbumani Ramadoss

"The Wetland Authority has moved with lightning speed to reduce the buffer zone in order to protect the interests of construction companies, which claim that their businesses have been affected by the National Green Tribunal's order issued a year ago. Why, then, has the Authority shown no similar urgency in implementing the Supreme Court's judgment of December 11, 2024, which directed that the boundaries of the Pallikaranai marshland be surveyed and officially notified to protect it from decades of degradation? Is protecting the interests of private construction companies more important than protecting the Pallikaranai marshland?"

He said: "The Tamil Nadu government must immediately take steps to notify Pallikaranai and all wetlands across Tamil Nadu. The government must also immediately abandon the work to construct a six-foot-high protective wall extending three kilometres around the Pallikaranai marshland and a two-kilometre-long walkway."

Man gets 20 years in jail in POCSO case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A special court for POCSO cases in Tiruvallur district sentenced a 29-year-old man to 20 years in prison for abducting and sexually assaulting a minor girl in 2019.

According to the Ennore All-Women Police, a case was registered against M. Ramakrishnan, a resident of Kodungaiyur, following a complaint lodged by the mother of a 13-year-old girl. The complaint alleged that Ramakrishnan had abducted and sexually assaulted the girl on January 2, 2019. The court also imposed a fine of ₹20,000 on Ramakrishnan.

Man stabs elder brother to death in Ambattur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 44-year-old man allegedly stabbed his 58-year-old brother to death at an apartment complex in Ambattur Industrial Estate, following a dispute over the latter's alleged sexual abuse of the former's daughter five years ago.

After the sexual abuse came to light, the elder brother was sent out of the house. He moved to his native village near Tindivanam.

On Tuesday, he returned to his brother's house. An argument broke out between them over the sexual abuse and resulted in the murder. The accused then surrendered before the police.

Tej Partap Singh is Principal Chief Safety Officer of Southern Railway

Tej Partap Singh

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tej Partap Singh has assumed charge as Principal Chief Safety Officer of Southern Railway. Mr. Singh, who is an officer of the Indian Railway Traffic Services from the 1998 Batch, has vast experience in various facets of the Indian Railways and had held the post of Chief Freight Transportation Manager of Southern Railway. He has held positions such as Senior Divisional Operations Manager, Senior Divisional Safety Officer, Deputy Chief Safety Officer, Deputy General Manager, and Chennai Additional Divisional Railway Manager.

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invites tenders in Two Stage Tender System from eligible Contractors for the following Works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount Put to Tender / EMD Amount
	Office of the Chief Engineer (IP-R&D), 3rd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bengaluru - 560009.	
	IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1367/2026-27	**Date: 12-10-2026**
1	Work of Clear Water Distribution Pumping Station at Doddakannahalli GLR (48 ML) to Distribution Network of 110 Villages of Bommanahalli and Mahadevapura Zone. **(Call-2)**	**Rs. 791.56 Lakhs** / **Rs. 7.92 Lakhs**
	For the above work, Last Date for Receipt of Tenders: **23-10-2026 upto 16.00 Hours.** Tender will be Opened on: **27-10-2026 after 12.00 Hours.**	
	IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1370/2026-27	**Date: 13-10-2026**
2	Work of Providing and Laying 600 mm Dia MS Water Supply Feeder Main from K. Channasandra Arch, Channasandra Main Road to Kalkere Udhyanavana Kalkere Village and Linking to Existing, Distribution Pipeline of Kalkere Village coming under AEE(IP-R&D)-2-2 Sub Division.	**Rs. 734.16 Lakhs** / **Rs. 11.02 Lakhs**
	IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1371/2026-27	**Date: 13-10-2026**
3	Work of Providing and Laying 600 mm Dia MS Water Supply Feeder Main from Ayyappa Temple Road, Byrathi to Near Edify School Bileshivale Main Road and Linking to Existing, Distribution Pipeline of Bileshivale Village coming under AEE(IP-R&D)-2-2 Division.	**Rs. 737.83 Lakhs** / **Rs. 11.07 Lakhs**
	IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1372/2026-27	**Date: 13-10-2026**
4	Work of Providing and Laying 600 mm Dia MS Water Supply Feeder Main from Aneppa Layout Hormavu Main Road to Kalkere GLR at NRI Layout and Linking to 700 mm Dia GLR Inlet Pipe coming under AEE(IP-R&D)-2-2 Sub Division.	**Rs. 354.36 Lakhs** / **Rs. 5.32 Lakhs**
	IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-2/1374/2026-27	**Date: 13-10-2026**
5	Work of Tapping the Existing 1016 mm Dia MS Pipeline near Halanayakanahalli Junction to Sarjapura Main Road, Doddakanahalli.	**Rs. 630.07 Lakhs** / **Rs. 9.45 Lakhs**
	For the above works, Last Date for Receipt of Tenders: **28-10-2026 upto 16.00 Hours.** Tender will be Opened on: **29-10-2026 after 17.00 Hours.**	**Sd/- Chief Engineer (IP-R&D)**

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement Process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** For further details contact the above signed office during working hours. DIPR/CP/Adverto/3224/2026-27

Timings
CHENNAI

WEDNESDAY, OCT. 14
RISE 05:59 SET 17:51
RISE 08:56 SET 20:27

THURSDAY, OCT. 15
RISE 06:00 SET 17:51
RISE 09:50 SET 21:17

FRIDAY, OCT. 16
RISE 06:00 SET 17:50
RISE 10:42 SET 22:08

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	28

Chennai Airport Today
34°C The weather will be warm. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower will occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
32°C The weather will be a little warm. Night will be comfortable. Few spells of light to moderate rain and thundershower will occur.

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THE HINDU
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ELECTRICAL WORK

E-Tender Notice No. Sr. DEE/G&CHG/LMG/26 of 2026-27; dated: 08-10-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN.1**; **Tender No:** EL-LM-26-27-31; **Name of work:** Comprehensive Maintenance and Four-Monthly Preventive Schedule Maintenance of 25 kVA Inverters of M/s Hitachi HI-Rel Power Electronics Make Fitted on RMPU SG AC Coaches over N.F. Railway for a Period of Three (03) Years. Tender Value: ₹1,17,30,708.00; Earnest Money: ₹2,08,700.00. **E-tender will be closed at** 11:00 hrs. on 30-10-2026 and **Opened** at 11:30 hrs. on 30-10-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available upto 11:00 hrs. on 30-10-2026 on website http://www.ireps.gov.in.

Sr. DEE/G&Chg/Lumding
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

WESTERN RAILWAY
REPLACEMENT WORKS

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer (South), 2nd Floor, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Mumbai Central, Mumbai-400 008, invites **E-Tender Notice No.: SG_217_2_314_WA, Dated:8.10.2026. Work and location**: Mumbai Suburban Section - Replacement of overaged AFTC with MSDAC at Churchgate, Marine Lines, Mumbai Central, Ram Mandir, Goregaon & Malad stations. **Approx. Cost of Work**: ₹ 16,28,20,943.21. **EMD**: ₹ 32,56,400/-. **Time & Date for Submission**: Till 02.11.2026, 15:00 hrs. **Time & Date for Opening**: On 02.11.2026 at 15:30 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.ireps.gov.in 0694

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WESTERN RAILWAY
SHOT BLASTING AND FLUORO POLYMER (JAPANESE) PAINTING

Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage Repair Workshop, Western Railway, N. M. Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai - 400013, invites **E-Tender Notice No: WR-PL-MnP-FIAT-SB-PAINT, Date: 05.10.2026. Name of work with its location**: Shot Blasting and Fluoropolymer (Japanese) Painting of FIAT Bogies, Bolsters and Bogie Components for 03 years at Lower Parel Workshop. **Approx. Estimated Cost**: ₹13,49,35,020/-. **EMD**: ₹ 26,98,700/-. **Last date & time for Submission**: Till 27.10.2026, 12:00 hrs. **Last date & time for Opening**: On 27.10.2026 at 12:30 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.ireps.gov.in 0696

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South East Central Railway
E-Tender Notice

E-Tender Notice No. WRSR-09-25-26-OT-ABC-RT2 Dt. 08/10/2026 Name of the work: Work contract for "stripping and fitment of sub-assemblies of Air brake system of various types of wagons within the premises of WRS/R" through open tender for a period of 36 (Thirty-Six) months. **Approximate Tender Value:** Rs 5,27,00,769 (Rupees Five Crore Twenty-Seven Lakh Seven Hundred Sixty-Nine Only) Only including GST @ 18% **Quantity and Contractual Period:** As per annexure enclosed for a period of 36 (Thirty-six) months. **Earnest Money (Rs.):** Rs.10,54,000.00/- (Rs. Ten Lakh Fifty-Four Thousand only) **Cost of Tender Forms (Rs.):** Nil **Tender Closing Date and Time:** 11/11/2026 15:00 Hrs. **Bidding Start Date:** 28/10/2026 **Eligibility criteria:** Can be seen on website. Manual tender shall not be accepted. The details of the tender are available on website **www.ireps.gov.in**.

Dy.CME WRS/ Raipur
PR/R/WRS/D360/232
South East Central Railway @secrail

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
E-TENDER NOTICE

TENDER NOTICE NO.: CLW-DKAE-WC-570-eqm-2026. E-tenders are invited for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work: **SI. No.: [01]. Tender No.: CLW-DKAE-WC-570-eqm-2026. Name of the work:** Outsourcing of a part of equipment mounting work in 213 nos. of WAG- 9HC locomotives at DLW of CLW/ Dankuni for financial year 2026-28. **Tender value (Rupees):** ₹1,23,99,982.44 (Rupees One crore twenty three lakhs ninety nine thousand nine hundred and eighty two and forty-four paise) only. **Cost of tender document (Rupees):** ₹5,000.00 (Rupees Five thousand only). **Earnest money (Rupees):** ₹2,48,000.00 (Rupees Two lakhs forty-eight thousand only). **Period of completion:** 24 (twenty-four) months. **NOTE:** (i) Complete details can be seen in the Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in**. (ii) Contact Number: 03212-230003. (iii) Date of closing of tender submission is **23.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs.**

PR7/519 AEE/P/ Dankuni/DLW/CLW(WB)
Like us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
TAMILNADU SKILL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EoI)

EoI No. 3142/SDC-SDT/2026 **Dated:13.10.2026**

Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation (TNSDC) invites applications from leading Firms/Industries/Companies to partner in the Vettri Thiran Payirchi Thittam (VTPT) for skill-based training of Arts & Science, Engineering and Polytechnic students across Tamil Nadu for the Even Semester of Academic Year 2026–27.

Interested organisations can download the EOI document and apply for registering themselves as Industry Partners / Training Partners / Assessment Partners through the TNSDC–VTPT portal **(https://portal.skilldevelopment.tn.gov.in/eoi).**

Application Window: **14.10.2026, 3.00 PM to 29.10.2026, 3.00 PM**

Note: Physical applications will be considered only when specifically requisitioned by TNSDC.

TNSDC reserves the right to amend the existing norms as and when necessary, and such amendments will be notified on the portal.

Managing Director
TAMILNADU SKILL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION,
Nandanam, Chennai - 35

DIPR / 886 / Display / 2026

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD
(SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION)
VARIOUS WORKS FOR CONSTRUCTION OF NEW RAILWAY LINE BETWEEN DESHALPAR-HAJIPIR-LUNA
TENDER No. DyCE-C-BHUJ-NL-EPC-02

Dy. Chief Engineer (C) Bhuj for & on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-Tender for the following work: **(1) Name of work:** Construction of New Railway Line between Deshalpar-Hajipir-Luna (82.38 Kms) (including all yards falling in the section) covering all works of Earthwork, Blanketing, Retaining Wall, Toe Wall, Side drain, Construction of Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, RUB/LHS all P. Way works (including Laying and Linking), Supply of all types of Sleepers, P. Way Fittings (excluding Rails, steel girder), other Civil engineering works, Signal, Telecom and Electrical (General Services and TRD) complete Works in Ahmedabad Division of Western Railway in the Gujarat State on EPC basis. **(2) Approx. cost of work:** ₹ 1061,76,40,907.85 **(3) Bid security:** ₹ 21,23,52,800.00, **Type of Tender:** ***Two Packet System,*** **Completion period:** 2 Years (6 Months)/ 913 Days (including monsoon period), **(4) Closing time & Date: 09-02-2027 at 11:00 AM Hrs., Date & Time for opening of E-Tender: Any time after 11:00 AM Hrs. on 10-02-2027 (5) Website particular and Notice Board Location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office:** Complete details of tender including eligibility criteria are available on Western Railway website www.ireps.gov.in **Office of Deputy Chief Engineer (C)Bhuj, Nirman Bhavan, 1st Floor, Opp. GCS Hospital, Naroda Road, Near DRM Office, Ahmedabad: 382345** In case of any clarification the firm may contact at the above office during the working hours in person or at office **Mobile No.9724093262.**

CPM-087
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ANNA UNIVERSITY,
Chennai - 600 025
NOTICE INVITING e -TENDER through GEM portal

The Department of Textile Technology, Anna University, Chennai, invites all eligible vendors to participate in the procurement of a **"Field Emission Scanning Electron Microscope (FESEM)"** through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal.

The detailed technical specifications, eligibility criteria, terms and conditions and the last date for submission of bids are available on the GeM portal.

Interested and eligible vendors are requested to submit their bids through GeM within the prescribed deadline.

Note: For further details, Please visit **GeM Portal: https://gem.gov.in /**
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/8126472

DIPR.3123/Tender/2026 **REGISTRAR i/c**

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number **1800 102 1878**
Or write to us at **customercare@thehindu.co.in**
Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU thehindu businessline. FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR The Hindu Young World THE HINDU

Uttarakhand Urban Sector Development Agency (UUSDA)
Urban Development Department, Government of Uttarakhand
777, Saatvik Tower, Kaulagarh Road, Rajendra Nagar, Dehradun
Telephone +91-135-2753894, Tele-fax +91- 135-2754895
Email: uusdip@gmail.com, Website: www.uusdip.org

Adv. No: UUSDA/P-112/1724 Date: 13.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The **"Program Director"**, Uttarakhand Urban Sector Development Agency (UUSDA), Government of Uttarakhand" **(the Employer)** invites online bids through the Uttarakhand State e-procurement portal https://uktenders.gov.in from eligible Bidders for the execution of the works as detailed below:

S. No.	Name of Work	Package No.	Last Date & Time of Submission
1.	**Development of Interception and Diversion works with Sewage Treatment Plant (STPs) with 5 years of O&M for Pithoragarh Town, Uttarakhand**	**WW-PTH-01**	**29.10.2026 upto 03:00 PM (15:00 Hrs.) IST**

Publishing Date of Bid document	**15.10.2026 at 05:00 PM, (17:00 Hrs.) IST**
Date of Pre-Bid Meeting	**22.10.2026 at 12:00 Noon, (12:00 Hrs.) IST**
Bid Submission Start Date	**23.10.2026 at 03:00 PM, (15:00 Hrs.) IST**
Last date for submission of original tender fee & EMD in the office of Bid inviting officer	**27.10.2026 upto 03:00 PM, (15:00 Hrs.) IST**
Bid Submission Closing & Last Date/Time for downloading of the Bid document	**29.10.2026 at 03:00 PM, (15:00 Hrs.) IST**
Bid Opening Date and time	**29.10.2026 at 04:00 PM, (16:00 Hrs.) IST**

The prospective bidders can download the detailed bidding document and upload the bid on the website, https://uktenders.gov.in. Program Director, UUSDA reserves the right to reject any or all the proposals or to cancel the entire process without assigning any reasons thereof. Further details of the bid document including subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancellation etc. may be downloaded from the website https://uktenders.gov.in.

Program Director
UUSDA

"हमारा संकल्प आपका सहयोग बेहतर कल"

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Assistant Director (AH), KR Puram, Old Madras, Bengaluru-560036

No: GBA/BECC/AD(AH)/PR/110/ 2026-27 **Date: 13-10-2026**

NOTIFICATION

Sub: Regarding quotation from interested parties for supplying an animal incinerator to the Animal Husbandry Department of Bengaluru East City Corporation.

In connection with the above matter, it is necessary to dispose of the dead animals (small animals and large animals) in the jurisdiction of Bengaluru East City Corporation scientifically. In this context, it is proposed to set up an animal crematorium in the jurisdiction of the Corporation during the year 2026-27 by the Animal Husbandry Department. Interested parties are requested to submit their price proposals for the cost (including GST) of the said animal incinerator in a sealed envelope to the above address by **21-10-2026** at **5:00** pm.

Interested parties may obtain details by sending a request to **adahkrp01@gmail.com** or directly from the Assistant Director (Animal Husbandry), Bengaluru East City Corporation, K.R.Puram, Old Madras Road, Bengaluru – 560036 **Sd/- Assistant Director (AH) BECC, GBA**

बिहार सरकार
श्री फणीश्वर नाथ रेणु अभियंत्रण महाविद्यालय,अररिया
(विज्ञान, प्रावैधिकी एवं तकनीकी शिक्षा विभाग, बिहार सरकार) 854318
email-gecararia@gmail.com website-http://spnrecararia.ac.in/

विज्ञापन सं० SPNREC/03/2026-27

साक्षात्कार सूचना

विज्ञान, प्रावैधिकी एवं तकनीकी शिक्षा विभाग, पटना बिहार के अन्तर्गतश्री फणीश्वर नाथ रेणु अभियंत्रण महाविद्यालय, अररिया के अंग्रेजी एवं रसायनशास्त्र विशय में रिक्त पदों के विरूद्ध अतिथि सहायक प्राध्यापक की आवश्यकता है। अतिथि सहायक प्राध्यापक से संबंधित आवश्यक शैक्षणिक योग्यता एवं मानदेय निम्न है :–

क्र० सं०	पदनाम	विषय	साक्षात्कार तिथि / समय	शैक्षणिक योग्यता	मानदेय	अभियुक्ति
1	अतिथि सहायक प्राध्यापक	English	29.10.2026 09:00 पूर्वाह्न	AICTE/UGC/ DSTTE, Patna के नियमानुसार	विज्ञान, प्रावैधिकी एवं तकनीकी शिक्षा विभाग, पटना बिहार के नियमानुसार	–
2	अतिथि सहायक प्राध्यापक	Chemistry	29.10.2026 09:00 पूर्वाह्न	AICTE/UGC/ DSTTE, Patna के नियमानुसार	विज्ञान, प्रावैधिकी एवं तकनीकी शिक्षा विभाग, पटना बिहार के नियमानुसार	विज्ञापन संख्या PR-012732 (Sci. & Tech) 2026-27 में प्रकाशित Chemistry विषय का साक्षात्कार तिथि एवं समय को विस्तारितकिया जाता है।

निर्देश:–
1.इच्छुक उम्मीदवार से निर्धारित प्रारुप में (प्रारुप महाविद्यालय के वेबसाइट– www.spnrecararia.ac.in पर उपलब्ध है) सभी प्रमाणपत्रों की स्वप्रमाणित छायाप्रति (pdf file)संलग्न कर email id (gecararia @gmail.com) के माध्यम से दिनांक 27.10.2026 के रात्रि 12 बजे तक आवेदन आमन्त्रित किया जाता है।
2. यह कार्यानुमति बिल्कुल ही एक वैकल्पिक / कार्यकारी व्यवस्था है जो बिना किसी पूर्व सूचना के समाप्त की जा सकती है। इस विशय मे कोई भी दावा स्वीकार्य नहीं होगा।
3. इस कार्यानुमति के आधार पर सेवा स्थायीकरण / नियमितिकरण आदि का दावा नहीं किया जा सकता है।
4. विभाग द्वारा नियमित / संविदा पर नियुक्ति होने पर कार्यानुमति स्वतः समाप्त हो जायेगी।
5. साक्षात्कार हेतु किसी प्रकार का TA/DA देय नहीं होगा।
6. विस्तृत जानकारी एवं आवेदन पत्र संस्थान के वेबसाईट (www.spnrecararia.ac.in) पर उपलब्ध है।
7. संस्थान के पास बिना कोई कारण बताए किसी भी समय चयन प्रकिया को निरस्त करने या संशोधित करने का अधिकार सुरक्षित है।
8. किसी भी प्रकार के कानूनी विवाद की स्थिति में न्यायिक क्षेत्र केवलअररिया जिला न्यायालय (बिहार) के अधीन ही होगा।

नोट :–साक्षात्कार के समय सभी मूलप्रमाण–पत्र एवं उनकी दो प्रतिस्वप्रमाणित छायाप्रति तथा दो पास्पोर्ट साईज फोटोग्राफ लाना अनिवार्य है।

प्राचार्य,
श्री फणीश्वर नाथ रेणु अभियंत्रण महाविद्यालय अररिया

PR- 013538 (Sci & Tech) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

CORPORATE IDENTITY NUMBER: U40109PB2010SGC033814
Office of CE / P&M, PSTCL, Ludhiana- 141001, www.pstcl.org
Tel. No. 0161-2456704 & Mob-9646118208 email: srxen-proc-ldh@pstcl.org

Sr. No	Description of Tender
1	**Tender Reference No. 187/2026-27** **(Short Term Open Tender)** The department of Punjab State Transmission Corporation Limited invites online bids for **"Protection of Porcelain Insulators String of 400 KV Transmission Lines by offline washing Under P&M Organization of PSTCL".** **Closing date and Time: 28.10.2026 11:00 AM** **Opening date and Time: 29.10.2026 11:00 AM**

Note: It is informed that in case tender process is not completed due to any reason, no corrigendum will be published in newspapers. Details regarding corrigendum may be seen on official PSTCL website **www.pstcl.org**. Terms and conditions may be downloaded from PSTCL's web site **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

Sr. Xen. / W & A,
1078/12/2026-27/16107 **O/o CE/P&M PSTCL, Ludhiana**

Government of Jharkhand
Department of Higher and Technical Education
(Jharkhand Council on Science, Technology and Innovation)

Yojna Bhawan, Nepal House Campus, Doranda,
Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
Email- jharkhandcouncilonsct@gmail.com

Ref. No: Vi.Pra./Kau.-04/2015- **285** / Ranchi, Date:**12/10/2026**

NOTICE

Subject: Cancellation of Advertisement for Engagement of Chief Mentor and Junior Mentor issued vide Ref. No. Vi.Pra./Kau.-04/2015-221 dated 10.08.2026

It is hereby notified for information of all concerned that the advertisement issued vide Ref. No. Vi.Pra./Kau.-04/2015-221 dated 10.08.2026 for engagement of Chief Mentor and Junior Mentor on contractual basis at Innovation Hub, Regional Science Centre, Ranchi stands cancelled with immediate effect due to unavoidable administrative circumstances.

Accordingly, the engagement process initiated under the aforesaid advertisement is hereby withdrawn. No further action shall be taken in pursuance of the said advertisement.

JCSTI reserves the right to issue a fresh advertisement for these positions, if required, at a later date. Any inconvenience caused in this regard is regretted.

This has been issued with the approval of the competent authority.

PR No. 387147

Sd/-
PR.NO.391693 Higher Education,Technical Education and Skill Development Department(26-27):D **(Dr. Raj Shekhar Prasad)**
Executive Director, JCSTI

TAMILNADU NURSES AND MIDWIVES COUNCIL

(Constituted under Tamilnadu Act III of 1926)
Jayaprakash Narayanan Maligai, Old No.140, New No.56,
Santhome High Road, Mylapore, Chennai 600 004.
Tel:044-46786510; Email: info@tamilnadunursingcouncil.com
Web: www.tamilnadunursingcouncil.com

File No : 3661/NC/2026 Date: 09.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council, Chennai-4 invites tender application from the reputed Printers/Firms/suppliers for Printing & Supply work of OSCE/MLHP Books at Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council on or before **03.11.2026** at **12 noon**.

For more details please contact to above address.

Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council reserves the right to accept or reject any tender application without assigning any reasons thereof.

DIPR/3083/Tender/2026 **REGISTRAR**

TAMILNADU NURSES AND MIDWIVES COUNCIL

(Constituted under Tamilnadu Act III of 1926)
Jayaprakash Narayanan Maligai, Old No.140, New No.56,
Santhome High Road, Mylapore, Chennai 600 004.
Tel:044-46786510; Email: info@tamilnadunursingcouncil.com
Web: www.tamilnadunursingcouncil.com

File No: 3662/NC/2026 Date: 09.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council, Chennai-4 invites tender application from the reputed Printers/Firms/suppliers for Printing & Supply work of B.Sc.,(N) Log Books & Records at Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council on or before **03/11/2026** at **12 noon.**

For more details please contact to above address.

Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council reserves the right to accept or reject any tender application without assigning any reasons thereof.

DIPR/3082/Tender/2026 **REGISTRAR**

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER **TENDER NOTICE**

ADV No.38/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.96 to 98 /SE-I/TTD/ 2026-27 dt:13-10- 2026

NAME OF WORK:(1) Construction of additional floors over existing two hostel blocks with precast concrete technology in SPW College campus at Tirupati **Amount Rs.2739.20 Lakhs,Time for Completion:15 months.** (2) Modification and Improvements of Bhudevi Hostel Block in SPW Degree & PG College at Tirupati **Amount Rs.574.96 Lakhs, Time for Completion:12 months**,(3) Modification and Improvements of Sridevi Hostel Block in SPW Degree & PG College at Tirupati **Amount Rs.565.89 Lakhs,Time for Completion:12 months. NOTE:** For full details, log on to the Website **https://www.tirumala.org.**

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.215) Date:13-10-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

APSRTC

పల్లె వెలుగు

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) FOR SELECTION OF OPERATOR FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF 1450 AC (9M/12M) ELECTRIC BUSES AND DEVELOPMENT OF ALLIED ELECTRICAL AND CIVIL INFRASTRUCTURE FOR CHARGERS ON GCC (Dry Lease & Wet Lease)

e-tenders are invited from the interested bidders for procurement, supply, operation and maintenance of 1450 AC Electric buses (9M/12M) and development of allied electrical and civil infrastructure for chargers on Gross Cost Contract (GCC) model - dry lease & wet lease, at 29 depots of APSRTC. **(1)** Bids shall be submitted in the e-commerce portal of MSTC. **(2)** Start date for submission of bids: **09-11-2026 from 10.00 hrs. (3)** Last date for submission of bids: **24-11-2026 up to 17.00 hrs. (4)** For full details visit our website **http://www.apsrtc.ap.gov.in** (Tenders) and MSTC Portal **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/eproc. (5)** APSRTC reserves the right to cancel this notification without assigning any reason.

TENDER NOTICE NO: APSRTC/C&B-03/2026-27-MED, Dt.13-10-2026 Sd/-Chief Mechanical Engineer(C&B)

GOVERNMENT OF GOA

CAPTAIN OF PORTS DEPARTMENT, PANAJI - GOA

E-TENDER NOTICE (E-Tendering Mode Only)

Tender Notice No:MS/F-115/SDV-HB&GD/2025-26/3937 Dated:12/10/2026

Sale of Department Vessels **"MV Hopper Barge COP II PNJ 693 & Priestman Grab Dredger - II"** on "as is where is, what is basis and no complaint basis" (2nd Call), from Indian Buyers.

EMD	Tender Document Cost	Processing Fee
₹8,00,000/-	₹4,000/-	₹3,000/-

Payment mode: e-Payment only (NEFT/RTGS/net banking)

Last date of online submission	04/11/2026, up to 17:00 Hrs

Tender documents & details: **eprocure.goa.gov.in | www.ports.goa.gov.in**
Ph: 0832-2225070 / 2426109 | cpt-port.goa@nic.in

DI/ADVT/1703/2026. **-sd-**
Captain of Ports, Panaji – Goa

TAMILNADU NURSES AND MIDWIVES COUNCIL

(Constituted under Tamilnadu Act III of 1926)
Jayaprakash Narayanan Maligai, Old No.140, New No.56,
Santhome High Road, Mylapore, Chennai 600 004.
Tel:044-46786510; Email: info@tamilnadunursingcouncil.com
Web: www.tamilnadunursingcouncil.com

File No.:3660/NC/2026 Date : 09.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council, Chennai - 4 invites tender application from the reputed Printers/Firms/suppliers for Printing & Supply work of General Records for GNM/ B.Sc.,(N) / PBBSc.(N)/ M.Sc.,(N) & DGNM LOG books at TamilNadu Nurses and Midwives Council on or before 03/11/2026 at 12 noon.

For more details please contact to above address.

Tamil Nadu Nurses and Midwives Council reserves the right to accept or reject any tender application without assigning any reasons thereof.

DIPR/3084/TENDER/2026 **REGISTRAR**

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
(Contact Number 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 14/ 2026 Dated: 13.10.2026

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No. D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPs & CPPs from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is www.mstcecommerce.com and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power (www.Powermin.nic.in) and PFC Consultancy Limited (www.pfcindia.com). For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

Note:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com.**

C 977/26 1079/12/2026-27/16127

GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
EDUCATION DEPARTMENT

No. EDN.124/2026/29 Dated Shillong, the 30th September, 2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Conduct of examinations and academic progression of existing enrolled students of CMJ University, Meghalaya

With reference to the UGC letter D.O. No. 8-21/2010(CPP-I/PU)/78587, dated 02-09-2026, the office of the Administrator, under the Government of Meghalaya, is directed to inform all students of CMJ University as follows: **"All students presently studying Diploma, Undergraduate and Postgraduate programmes at the University may be allowed to appear in examinations conducted under the supervision of an external agency/third party, under the overall responsibility of the State Education Department"**.

Therefore, students are required to complete the form to submit their personal details for the examination using the QR code provided. Failure to submit the details will hinder the examination process, as these details are needed to arrange examinations with third-party institutions. The form link will remain active to accept responses until **01-11-2026**.

Link - **https://forms.gle/3aMvMVWX2DxnNSzv5**

MIPR No.: 1769
Dated: 30-09-2026

Sd/-
Administrator of CMJ University, Meghalaya & Joint Secretary to the Govt. of Meghalaya
Education Department

தொழிலாளர் வருங்கால வைப்பு நிதி நிறுவனம்
कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन
EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION

தொழிலாளர் மற்றும் வேலைவாய்ப்பு அமைச்சகம், இந்திய அரசு
श्रम एंव रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
Ministry of Labour and Employment, Govt. of India

மண்டல அலுவலகம் தாம்பரம், 3, ராஜாஜி சாலை, மேற்கு தாம்பரம், சென்னை-600045
क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, ताम्बरम 3, राजाजी सालै, पश्चिम ताम्बरम चेन्नै - 600045
Regional Office, Tambaram 3, Rajaji Salai, West Tambaram, Chennai - 600 045

Tel. : 044-2226 1925 / 1935/2297/4376/97/98; Toll Free Number: 1800 425 6749
E-mail: ro.tambaram@epfindia.gov.in
Facebook: @EPFOTambaram; Twitter: @epfotambaram; Website: www.epfindia.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby issued under Section 127&128 of the Code on Social Security, 2020 (Repealed Section 7A & 14B of the Employee's Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952).

Whereas, the undersigned being the officer authorized under the Employee's Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 in exercise of powers conferred under Section 127 & 128 of the Code on Social Security, 2020 (Repealed Section 7Q & 14B of the Employee's Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952). Section **127 & 128** of the Code, do hereby summon the Employer of the following establishment to attend the inquiry under Section **127 & 128** of the Code on Social Security, 2020 before the Assistant P.F. Commissioner (Assessing Officer) on or before **28.10.2026**. **Any other stakeholder having information of the whereabouts of the establishments or the Employer can appear personally or inform by E-mail at: ro.tambaram@epfindia.gov.in**

S. No.	Establishment code	Establishment Name	Section 127& 128 (repealed Sec 7Q & 14B) Period of Inquiry
1	TBTAM0063864000	**Staar Enterprises** Old No.3/475'476, New No.2/724, 2nd street, Kazura Garden, Neelangarai, Chennai 600115	01/10/2014 - 31/03/2025
2	CBTRY0082426000	Main unit of the establishment **Omega Garments,** # 6/11, Vairivayal, Aranthangi, Kattumavadi Main Road, Pudukottai 622301	01/10/2014 - 31/03/2025

As per Section 127 & 128 of EPF & MP Act, the undersigned have the same powers as are vested in a court under CPC 1908 to enforce the attendance of any person or examine him on oath before the respecting Assessing Officer on respective date of next inquiry in his chamber at the above said address. Any such inquiry shall be deemed to be a judicial proceeding within the meaning of Section 193 and 228, and for the purpose of Section 196 of Indian Penal Code (45 of 1860). Failure to appear before the authority on the said date/time/send representation before the inquiry date, the inquiry authority may conclude inquiry based on available records.

Issued at Tambaram on this 08.10.2026 **Sd/**
Place : Tambaram **Assistant P.F. Commissioner,**
Date : 09.10.2026 **Regional Office, Tambaram**

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD

SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION
CONSTRUCTION OF 2ND NEW RAILWAY LINE (DOUBLING WORKS)
E TENDER NOTICE NO. DYCECJAM-KNLS-OKHA-EPC-01

Dy.Chief Engineer (Construction), Western Railway, Jamnagar for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-Tender for following work: **1.Name of work with its location :** Construction of 2nd New Railway Line (Doubling works) between Section Kanalus(Including) - Okha (Including) from Km:853.36 to Km:994.35 (including all yards and stations falling in the section) covering all works that are Earthwork, Blanketing, Retaining Wall, Toe Wall, Side drain, Construction of Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, RUB/LHS, All P. Way works (including Laying and Linking), Supply of all types of Sleepers, All P. Way Fittings, Other Civil engineering works, Signal & Telecommunication and Electrical (General Services and OHE) complete Works in connection with Kanalus-Okha Doubling Project in Rajkot Division of Western Railway in the State of Gujarat on EPC mode. **2. Approx. cost of the work**: Rs. 1197,60,50,692.56 (Rupees Eleven Hundred Ninety-Seven Crore Sixty Lakh Fifty Thousand Six Hundred Ninety-Two and Fifty-Six Paise Only. **3. Completion Period:** 30 Months. **4. Earnest Money :** Rs. 239521100.00 **5. Date & time for submission of bid:** 11.02.2027 upto 11.00 Hrs. **Web site particulars Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office:** Office of the, Deputy Chief Engineer Construction Jamnagar /Western Railways, behind SSE /WORKS /HAPA office, near Hapa Railway station, Hapa, Gujarat-361120
Website: www.ireps.gov.in CPM 085

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WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD

(SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION)
VARIOUS WORKS FOR CONSTRUCTION OF NEW RAILWAY LINE BETWEEN VAYOR-LAKHPAT
TENDER No. DyCE-C-BHUJ-NL-EPC-01

Dy. Chief Engineer (C) Bhuj for & on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-Tender for the following work: **(1) Name of work:** Construction of New Railway Line between Vayor-Lakhpat (including all yards falling in the section) covering all works of Earthwork, Blanketing, Retaining Wall, Toe Wall, Side drain, Construction of Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, RUB/LHS all P. Way works (including Laying and Linking), Supply of all types of Sleepers, P. Way Fittings (excluding Rails, steel girder), other Civil engineering works, Signal, Telecom and Electrical (General Services and TRD) complete Works in Ahmedabad Division of Western Railway in the Gujarat State on EPC basis. **(2) Approx. cost of work:** ₹ 984,30,42,826.82 **(3) Bid security:** ₹ 19,68,60,900.00, **Type of Tender:** ***Two Packet System,*** **Completion period:** 2 Years (6 Months)/913 Days (including monsoon period), **(4) Closing time & Date: 09-02-2027 at 11:00 AM Hrs., Date & Time for opening of E-Tender: Any time after 11:00 AM Hrs. on 10-02-2027 (5) Website particular and Notice Board Location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office:** Complete details of tender including eligibility criteria are available on Western Railway website www.ireps.gov.in **Office of Deputy Chief Engineer (C)Bhuj, Nirman Bhavan, 1st Floor, Opp. GCS Hospital, Naroda Road, Near DRM Office, Ahmedabad: 382345** In case of any clarification the firm may contact at the above office during the working hours in person or at office **Mobile No.9724093262.** CPM-086

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GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

(www.kpwd.gov.in)
Office of the Executive Engineer, PWD Bangalore Division, 2nd Floor, PWD Annexure Building, K.R. Circle, Bangalore-01
Telephone No. 080-22133370 **Email ID:** eepwdbngdn@yahoo.com
E-Portal: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/#/portal/portal-home

Short Term Tender Notification No. 35/2026-27
Dated: 12.10.2026

Item-rate tenders, for the work in PWD, **Doddaballapura & No.2 North** Sub Division under this office noted below, are invited by the undersigned on behalf of the Governor of Karnataka in accordance with Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement rules 2000 and as per Standard Tender Documents for procurement of works from the contractors registered in K.P.W.D. as per KPPP.

Tender Notification are Published for **02 Works (Rs. 500.00 to 1600.00 Lakhs)** Details of the tender works can be obtained from the above Office during office hours on working days**. EMD & Tender processing fees are mentioned in KPP portal.**

For Sl No.01
1. Tenders must be submitted online through KPP portal on or before **4.00 PM on Dated: 22.10.2026**
2. The opening of tenders through KPP portal on Dated: **23.10.2026 at 4.30 PM** or further date and time will be Intimate.

For Sl No.02
1. Tenders must be submitted online through KPP portal on or before **4.00 PM on Dated: 28.10.2026**
2. The opening of tenders through KPP portal on Dated: **29.10.2026 at 4.30 PM** or further date and time will be Intimate.

For more details contact this office.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
PWD Bangalore Division,
Bangalore

DIPR/DD-CP/3210/MCS/2026-27

CANTONMENT BOARD

St. Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram
Ministry of Defence, Government of India
Chennai-600 016.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Draft St. Thomas Mount-cum-Pallavaram Cantonment Building Bye-laws, 2026 have been published by the Government of India, Ministry of Defence, in the Gazette of India (Extraordinary), vide S.R.O. 64(E), dated **09.10.2026**.

The said publication is being brought to the notice of the General Public in accordance with the directions issued by the Director General, Defence Estates, Ministry of Defence, New Delhi, vide Letter No.12/1/Building Bye-Laws/Gen/C/DE/2022 Vol-VII, dated 25.09.2026, and the Principal Director, Defence Estates, Southern Command, Pune, vide Letter No.962/XVII/C/DE/2026, dated 30.09.2026.

Objections and suggestions, if any, are hereby invited from the General Public in respect of the aforesaid Draft Building Bye-Laws within 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice.

Such objections or suggestions may be submitted in writting to the Chief Executive Officer, Cantonment Board, St. Thomas Mount-cum-Pallavaram, Chennai-600 016, within the stipulated period.

The Draft Building Bye-Laws, 2026 are available for Public Inspection at the following locations: Cantonment Board website: **https://stm.cantt.gov.in/public-notice/,** Gazette of India, website: **https://egazette.gov.in/** and Office Notice Board: Cantonment Board Office, St. Thomas Mount, Chennai-600 016.

The General Public are requested to take note of the above and submit their objections or suggestions, if any, within the prescribed period.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
Office of the Cantonment Board
St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram
Chennai-600 016.

No.STM/Works/1/2220
Dated 12.10.2026

ENGINEERING WORKS

Tender Notice No. CON/2026/AUG/02; Dated: 08-10-2026. Open tender through e-tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor (s)/firm(s) for the following works. **Tender No.** CE/CON/NK/MB/2026/03. **Name of work:** Left over works of supply, fabrication and launching of Girders (2x24.40 CG + 1x106.70m OWG) of Br. No. 756, launching of PSC slab (6x6.10m) and protection work of Br. No. 750, drain between UP an DN Main Line, Km 170/0-173/0 and other ancillary works, in Azara - Kamakhya section in c/with New Bongaigaon-Goalpara Town-Kamakhya DL project. **Approximate Value:** ₹31,87,27,450.70/-; E-tender will be closed at **14:30 hrs.** on **05-11-2026** and opened at **15:30 hrs.** on **05-11-2026.** For details of Tender and any corrigendum, please visit www.ireps.gov.in.

Chief Engineer/Con/Kamakhya Project/Maligaon
Northeast Frontier Railway
(Construction Organisation)
"Serving Customers with a smile"

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

Government of Uttarakhand, Department of Higher Education

No. :- 439094 / XXIV-C-1/2026-E-42533/01(08)2020 08 October, 2026

NOTICE FOR INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR THE APPOINTMENT OF VICE- CHANCELLOR OF SOBAN SINGH JEENA UNIVERSITY, ALMORA

The Uttarakhand Government has announced the appointment for the post of Vice Chancellor at Soban Singh Jeena University Almora. Under the provisions mentioned in Section 10(1) of the Soban Singh Jeena University Act, 2019 and as per conditions stipulated in UGC Notification dated 18.07.2018; applications are invited for the appointment on the one post of Vice Chancellor with a pay scale of Rs. 2,10,000 and a special allowance of Rs.11,250.00, with total emoluments of Rs. 2,21,250.00.

2- The Vice Chancellor will be appointed from individuals possessing the highest level of efficiency, integrity, morality, and commitment to the institution. Eligible candidates must have at least 10 years of experience as a professor in a university or 10 years of educational leadership experience in a recognized research or educational administrative organization. The applicant should be a distinguished academician with relevant experience.

3- The age of the person applying for the post of Vice-Chancellor shall not be more than 65 years.

4- "Applicants/post-holders fulfilling the eligibility criteria must submit their applications online on the Samarth Portal URL (https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in/) within 15 days from the date of issuance of this advertisement, by 6:00 PM. The application must be filled out completely in the prescribed format, accompanied by the attached declaration form, along with photocopies of all relevant eligibility documents based on the said conditions—including proof of date of birth, appointment order to the post of Professor, date of joining, and certificates related to the pay scale for the post of Professor.

Additionally, one hard copy along with all supporting documents must be sent via Speed Post or Registered Post to the **Office of the Secretary, Department of Higher Education, Government of Uttarakhand, Election Office, 1st Floor, Vishwakarma Bhawan, 04 Subhash Road, Dehradun.**

Prescribed Format

Name & Address	Date of Birth	Age as on date of Publication of advertisement	Education/ Qualification	Position held Presently	Date of Joining on Post of Professor and Equivalent	Teaching/Past Position held (From -To) Experience			Administrative Experience			Awards/ Patents/ Recognition	Publication/ Research Work	Remarks
						Post	Duration		Post	Duration				
							From	To		From	To			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15

(Dr. B.V.R.C. Purushottam)
Secretary

KERALA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD

Head Office, Pattom P.O., Thiruvananthapuram - 695 004
Web: www.kspcb.kerala.gov.in
email: kspcbendosulfan@gmail.com

Ref No: KSPCB/1939/2023-SEE-2 Date: 13/10/2026

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Kerala State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) invites Expression of Interest (EoI) from authorized and eligible operators/agencies having operational integrated HazardousWastes Treatment, Storage, and Disposal Facilities (HWTSDF)/Hazardous waste incineration facility with high-temperature hazardous waste incineration capabilities for the safe packaging, loading, inter-state transportation, treatment, and scientific disposal of legacy Endosulfan waste stocks stored at the various cashew estates of Plantation Corporation of Kerala Limited in the state of Keralam.

For further details please refer to web link: https://kspcb.kerala.gov.in/tenders

Contact Officer & Queries:
Chief Environmental Engineer,
Kerala State Pollution Control Board
E-mail: kspcbendosulfan@gmail.com
Mob. No.: 9447975729

Last Date for Submission of EOI: 27-10-2026

(Sd/-) Member Secretary
Kerala State Pollution Control Board,
Thiruvananthapuram.

COMPREHENSIVE CONSULTANCY SERVICES

E-Tender Notice No. CPM-GS-MLG-PC2-2026-08RT1 Date: 08-10-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Tender No. CPM-GS-MLG-PC2-2026-08RT1. Name of Work:** Request for Proposal (RFP) for providing Project consultant (PC) for providing "Comprehensive Consultancy services from the stage of Feasibility Study & DPR preparation for elimination of Level Crossing gates in NF Railway by constructing ROB and/ RUB/LHS/ Other Structures/ Road Diversion as required including Detailed Design of required components of finalised scheme, Tendering for execution of works as per finalized scheme, Techno-Managerial Consultancy, Processing & Facilitation for land acquisition, Project supervision Services/Project Management Consultancy etc. for execution of work till closure of level crossings/Defect Liability Period of execution contract". **Tender Value:** ₹89,74,67,325.18/- **Earnest Money:** ₹46,37,300/-. **Date & time for Closing/opening of tender:** At **15.00** hrs. on **30-10-2026.** The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

CPM/GS/Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES VIJAYPUR, JAMMU-181134

(A Central Autonomous Body under PMSSY, MoH&FW, Government of India)

Employment Notification No.05/2026

All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Vijaypur, Jammu invites online applications for following **Faculty posts** in various departments on Direct Recruitment Basis.

Post Code	Department	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	Anaesthesiology		UR-1	OBC-1	
2.	Anatomy	OBC-1			
3.	Biochemistry	UR-1			UR-1 SC-1,ST-1
4.	Burns & Plastic Surgery	UR-1			
5.	Cardiology	SC-1			OBC-1
6.	Community Medicine	OBC-1			
7.	Dermatology	EWS-1	UR-1		
8.	E.N.T	UR-1			OBC-1
9.	Forensic Medicine & Toxicology	OBC-1	OBC-1		
10.	Gastroenterology	SC1			
11.	General Medicine	ST-1		ST-1	OBC-1
12.	General Surgery	UR-1 OBC-1		UR-1 OBC-1	
13.	Hospital Administration		EWS-1		OBC-1
14.	Medicine Oncology	UR-1	UR-1	UR-1	UR-1
15.	Microbiology	UR-1	OBC-1 SC-1	OBC-1 SC-1	SC-1
16.	Neonatology	SC-1	ST-1	EWS-1	
17.	Nephrology	OBC-1			
18.	Neurology	EWS-1			OBC-1
19.	Nuclear Medicine		UR-1		SC-1
20.	Obstetrics & Gynecology		OBC-1		
21.	Ophthalmology	UR-1		OBC-1	
22.	Orthopaedics	OBC-1			
23.	Pediatric Surgery		SC-1		
24.	Pediatrics		OBC-1	OBC-1	OBC-1
25.	Pathology	ST-1	EWS-1 UR-1		
26.	Pharmacology	OBC-1		SC-1	
27.	Physical Medicine & Rehabilitation			OBC-1	
28.	Physiology	UR-1	OBC-1	UR-1	UR-1 OBC-1
29.	Psychiatry	EWS-1		SC-1	UR-1
30.	Pulmonary Medicine	SC-1		UR-1	
31.	Radio Diagnosis	OBC-1		OBC-1	ST-1
32.	Surgical Oncology	UR-1			
33.	Transfusion Medicine& Blood Bank	UR-1			UR-1
34.	Urology				OBC-1

Important Dates

Opening date of Online Application forms/Job portal	14.10.2026 (Wednesday)
Last date of Filling up online application form	13.11.2026 (Friday)
Last date to submit hard copy of Application form	18.11.2026 (Wednesday)

Online Application form, Vacancy details, general terms & conditions and prescribed Recruitment Rules etc. for the aforesaid posts are available at www.aiimsjammu.edu.in under 'Recruitment> open Jobs.

Sd/-
Deputy Director (Admin)
For& on behalf of ED & CEO AIIMS, Vijaypur, Jammu

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE DEPARTMENT
NATIONAL HEALTH MISSION - TAMIL NADU

INVITATION OF BIDS UNDER STATE LEVEL COMPETITIVE BIDDING FOR SERVICES

- For details visit : **http://tntenders.gov.in**
- Tender ID : **2026_NHMT_713219_1**
- On behalf of the Government of Tamil Nadu the Mission Director, National Health Mission – Tamil Nadu, DMS Campus, Teynampet, Chennai-6 invites Bids for the following works.

Name of the Work	Date of availability of Bid Documents	Due date for submission of online Bid	Date and Time of opening of Technical Bid
Request for Proposal for Selection of an Agency for Establishment and Operation of the Social Media under National Health Mision, Tamil Nadu for a period of 1 year	14.10.2026 10:00 hrs. Onwards	29.10.2026 12:00 hrs.	29.10.2026 16:00 hrs.

DIPR/3100/TENDER/2026 **MISSION DIRECTOR**

கண்டோன்மெண்ட் கழகம்

செயின்ட்.தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கண்டோன்மெண்ட்
இந்திய அரசு, பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகம்
சென்னை - 600 016.

பொது அறிவிப்பு

பரங்கிமலை மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கண்டோன்மென்ட் வாரியத்திற்கான வரைவு கட்டடத் துணை விதிகள், 2026, இந்திய அரசின் பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகத்தால் **09.10.2026** தேதியிட்ட இந்திய அரசிதழின் சிறப்பு வெளியீட்டில், S.R.O. 64(சி) என்ற அறிவிக்கையின் மூலம் வெளியிடப்பட்டுள்ளன என்பது பொதுமக்களுக்குத் தெரிவிக்கப்படுகிறது.

இது தொடர்பாக, புதுதில்லி பாதுகாப்பு நிலங்கள் தலைமை இயக்குநரகத்தின் 25.09.2026 தேதியிட்ட கடித எண்.12/1/Building Bye-Laws/Gen/C/DE/2022 Vol-VII மற்றும் புனே, தென் மண்டல பாதுகாப்பு நிலங்கள் முதன்மை இயக்குநரகத்தின் 30.09.2026 தேதியிட்ட கடித எண். 962/XVII/C/DE/2026 ஆகியவற்றில் வழங்கப்பட்டுள்ள அறிவுறுத்தல்களின்படி, மேற்கண்ட வரைவு கட்டடத் துணை விதிகள் பொதுமக்களின் பார்வைக்கும் கருத்துத் தெரிவிப்பதற்கும் அறிவிக்கப்படுகின்றன.

மேற்கண்ட வரைவு கட்டடத் துணை விதிகள், 2026 தொடர்பாக பொதுமக்களுக்கு ஏதேனும் ஆட்சேபனைகள் அல்லது ஆலோசனைகள் இருப்பின், இப்பொது அறிவிப்பு வெளியிடப்பட்ட நாளிலிருந்து 30 நாட்களுக்குள் அவற்றைத் தெரிவிக்குமாறு கேட்டுக்கொள்ளப்படுகிறது.

ஆட்சேபனைகள் மற்றும் ஆலோசனைகளை எழுத்துப்பூர்வமாக, தலைமைச் செயல் அலுவலர், பரங்கிமலை மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கண்டோன்மென்ட் வாரியம், சென்னை-600016 என்ற முகவரிக்கு நிர்ணயிக்கப்பட்ட காலக்கெடுவிற்குள் சமர்ப்பிக்கலாம். மேற்கண்ட வரைவு கட்டடத் துணை விதிகள், 2026-ஐ பொதுமக்கள் கீழ்க்கண்ட இடங்களில் பார்வையிடலாம்: கண்டோன்மென்ட் வாரிய இணையதளம்: **https://stm.cantt.gov.in/public-notice/,** இந்திய அரசிதழ் இணையதளம்: **https://egazette.gov.in/** மற்றும் அலுவலக அறிவிப்புப் பலகை: கண்டோன்மென்ட் வாரிய அலுவலகம், பரங்கிமலை, சென்னை-600 016.

எனவே, பொதுமக்கள் இவ்வறிவிப்பைக் கவனத்தில் கொண்டு, தங்களது ஆட்சேபனைகள் மற்றும் ஆலோசனைகள் ஏதேனும் இருப்பின், நிர்ணயிக்கப்பட்ட காலக்கெடுவிற்குள் சமர்ப்பிக்குமாறு கேட்டுக்கொள்ளப் படுகிறார்கள்.

Sd/-
தலைமை நிர்வாக அதிகாரி
கண்டோன்மெண்ட் கழகம் அலுவலகம்
செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம்
சென்னை-600 016.

No.STM/Works/1/2220
Dated 12.10.2026

From Page One

HC upholds Speaker's decision on resignation of six AIADMK MLAs

"The Speaker is expected to respect the sensitive constitutional trust by acting on the said disqualification proceedings with utmost expedition," it added.

The judges expressed surprise over the disqualification proceedings kept pending for the last four months against the four resigned MLAs – Esakki Subaya (Ambasamudram), S. Jayakumar (Perundurai), Maragatham Kumaravel (Madurantakam) and P. Sathyabama (Dharapuram) – with the last two having been re-elected to the Assembly recently from the same constituencies.

The court directed the Speaker to prepare a timetable within seven days, providing timelines and deadlines for various stages of the proceedings. It also directed the Speaker not to allow any of the defecting MLAs to delay the proceedings by seeking adjournments on flimsy grounds.

Authoring the verdict, the Chief Justice relied on a few Supreme Court verdicts to hold that the High Court could fix such a timeline for the Speaker to dispose of the disqualification proceedings. The court passed the orders while partly allowing a batch of writ petitions filed by AIADMK whip Agri S.S. Krishnamurthy and the Desiya Makkal Sakthi Katchi, challenging the Speaker's decision to accept the resignation of the six MLAs.

The disqualification proceedings had been initiated against them on AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami's complaint that 25 of his party MLAs had violated the whip to vote against a confidence motion moved by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on May 13. However, on May 27, he had given a letter to the Speaker, condoning the act of 14 of the 25 MLAs.

Noting that the names of C. Vijayabaskar (Viralimalai) and M.R. Vijayabhaskar (Karur) found a place in the list of MLAs whose act had been condoned by Mr. Palaniswami, and that no request had been made thereafter to revive the disqualification proceedings against those two MLAs, who also resigned subsequently, the Division Bench dismissed Mr. Krishnamurthy's writ petitions with respect to them alone.

The Bench concluded that the handwritten resignations submitted by the six MLAs to the Speaker were genuine and voluntary, and that the latter was not required to undertake a roving or detailed inquiry into the alleged motives behind those resignations.

HC calls for report on plaint against Udhayanidhi's poll affidavit

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Tuesday directed its Registry to call for a report from a metropolitan magistrate's court at George Town in Chennai on the numbering of a complaint accusing Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin of having submitted a false election affidavit along with the nomination form he had filed for this year's Assembly election in the State.

Numbering of plea

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan sought to know from the magistrate by Thursday (October 15) how long it would take to number the petition that was filed by P. Milany of Theni district, who was one of the contestants in the Chepauk-Thiruvallikeni constituency from where the DMK leader and former Deputy Chief Minister was elected for a second consecutive term.

The judge called for the report since Mr. Milany's counsel told the court that he had lodged the complaint against the Leader of the Opposition, under Section 125 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, for allegedly furnishing false information in the election affidavit, but the magistrate court was yet to entertain the petition filed on September 8.

CM seeks more water from A.P. for Chennai

Andhra Pradesh will consider the request, depending on the availability of water and its own requirements, Chandrababu Naidu tells Vijay

G.V.R. Subba Rao
VIJAYAWADA

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu and Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay during a meeting at Undavalli.

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Tuesday sought the release of more water from Andhra Pradesh to meet the drinking water requirements of Chennai. However, the Andhra Pradesh government did not give any assurance, saying it would consider the request depending on the availability of water in Krishna River and the requirements of the State.

Mr. Vijay met Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu at the latter's camp office in Vijayawada and discussed inter-State water issues, including the proposed Godavari-Cauvery link and drinking water supply to Chennai.

Mr. Naidu said the Andhra Pradesh government was sympathetic to Chennai's drinking water needs, despite a decline in water availability in Krishna River due to the El Niño effect this year and the consequent water scarcity. He informed Mr. Vijay that Andhra Pradesh had already released 4.08 tmc to Chennai. "The Andhra Pradesh government will consider releasing additional water to Chennai, depending on water availability and the requirements of the State," he told his Tamil Nadu counterpart.

Mr. Vijay, who arrived in the State to take part in the Vijayawada Utsav, was accorded a warm welcome by Mr. Naidu and Human Resources Development Minister Nara Lokesh. The two Chief Ministers held discussions on issues of mutual interest. During the meeting, Mr. Naidu explained the importance of linking the Godavari and the Cauvery, describing it as a permanent solution to drought.

Mr. Vijay, meanwhile, requested Andhra Pradesh to release additional water to Chennai through the Telugu Ganga project.

Under the inter-State agreement signed in 1983, 15 tmc of Krishna water is to be delivered annually at the Tamil Nadu border to cater to Chennai's drinking water needs. However, inadequate flood flows into Krishna River at Srisailam and low storage in key reservoirs have complicated the prospects of meeting the demand in full.

The Andhra Pradesh government is understood to be examining the possibility of releasing a proportionate quantity from the available reserves at the Somasila and Kandaleru projects. A partial release of up to 5 tmc is likely to be a possible compromise, though a final decision may be disclosed later. "The Andhra Pradesh government cannot release the full quantity of water, given the availability in the reservoirs. However, a proportionate release from the available storage at the Kandaleru and Somasila projects is likely to be considered," sources said.

Mr. Vijay also offered prayers at the Sri Kanaka Durga Temple atop Indrakeeladri.

HC quashes money laundering case against Ponmudy

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

K. Ponmudy

The Madras High Court on Tuesday quashed money laundering proceedings initiated by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) against former DMK Minister K. Ponmudy, his son Gowtham Sigamani, and five others on the basis of a red sand quarrying case.

The First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan quashed the proceedings initiated under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, as the petitioners had been acquitted from the sand quarrying case on April 2. The orders were passed on a batch of writ petitions, which had challenged the continuance of the PMLA proceedings even after the acquittal of the petitioners from the predicate offence.

In his plea, Mr. Ponmudy said the Villupuram District Crime Branch Police had registered an FIR against him, his son, and others on September 23, 2012. The case was registered under various provisions of the Indian Penal Code and the law pertaining to mines and minerals. The charge against them was that, when Mr. Ponmudy served as the Minister for Mines and Minerals between 2007 and 2011, he had entered into a criminal conspiracy and awarded licences to his son, the latter's friend, Mr. Sigamani's brother-in-law, and others for quarrying red sand.

The charge sheet claimed that the licensees had quarried red sand over and above the permitted quantity without paying seigniorage fees to the State government, thereby causing a loss of ₹28.37 crore to the public exchequer. However, after a full-fledged trial, the Villupuram Principal District and Sessions Court on April 2, 2026, acquitted all seven accused and held that the prosecution had failed to establish any nexus between the grant of quarry lease and the alleged illegal gain or conspiracy.

The trial court also observed that the prosecution had failed to prove the charge of conspiracy or abuse of official position against the former Minister. It concluded that the alleged revenue loss figures were speculative and unsupported by primary data, Mr. Ponmudy told the High Court.

'High-cost power to be purchased for 16 days to avoid unscheduled cuts'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

> The current peak power demand is 21,000 MW when compared to 16,000 MW last year — a 30% increase due to the El Niño effect
>
> **C.T.R. NIRMAL KUMAR**
> Energy Resources Minister

Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar on Tuesday said a prolonged summer had led to a spurt in electricity demand in the State, and the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL) had to resort to purchasing power at more than ₹30 per unit to avoid unscheduled power cuts.

Addressing the media, he said the current peak power demand was 21,000 MW when compared to 16,000 MW last year – a 30% increase due to the El Niño effect. He said the entire country was facing an energy shortage.

Only available source

The Minister said that currently, gas power was the only source available, and it was being purchased at more than ₹30 per unit.

The expensive power was being purchased for managing the evening peak-hour demand for six hours from October 15 to 31, he added.

Mr. Nirmal Kumar said TNPDCL had to purchase expensive gas power owing to the central generating station at Neyveli Lignite Corporation reducing output by nearly 1,850 MW.

Also, despite the State having tied up with wind power generators to generate 3,500 MW of wind power, only 500 MW was being generated and supplied, he added.

Mr. Nirmal Kumar sought the setting up of a nationwide energy forecasting centre for alerts on power shortfall.

Leaders condemn govt.

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami criticised the TVK-led government for reportedly purchasing electricity at rates as high as ₹37 per unit, and for its alleged attempt to favour private players.

Citing reports in this regard, Mr. Palaniswami said the Andhra Pradesh government had signed an agreement on September 9 to buy electricity at ₹16-₹20 per unit.

No other State, except Tamil Nadu, had signed an agreement to buy power at ₹32-₹37 per unit, he said. He demanded that the agreement be cancelled.

BJP State unit president Nainar Nagenthran also criticised the TVK-led government over the issue. Citing media reports that electricity was to be purchased at ₹35 per unit as per the agreement, Mr. Nagenthran expressed shock over the rate.

Pointing to the prevailing weather conditions in the country, Mr. Nagenthran said the State government should have taken precautionary measures and planned electricity procurement properly in advance. He also referred to reports that Andhra Pradesh had signed agreements to procure electricity at ₹16-₹20 per unit.

Inflation, price rise spiralling out of control, says Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

M.K. Stalin

In the five months since the TVK-led government assumed office, Tamil Nadu had been witnessing an uncontrolled rise in prices and inflation, DMK president M.K. Stalin said on Tuesday.

In a statement, he alleged that the government had failed to keep the prices of essential commodities under control. He also criticised Food Minister P. Venkataramanan's claim that there had been no price rise, describing it as a blatant lie.

Power cuts

"The government should have taken measures when the Opposition parties flagged power cuts. But the Electricity Minister cited the situation in Punjab, while the Chief Minister flew to London. Now, the government is purchasing power in the open market at ₹35 a unit. It had cancelled the agreements signed by the DMK government, and is buying power at rates unheard of in other States. Is this the change it had promised?" he said.

Mr. Stalin alleged that the ruling party was publicly claiming that it would buy 15 AIADMK MLAs (Revenue Minister K.A. Sengottaiyan had said in Erode on Tuesday that 15 AIADMK functionaries would soon join the TVK). "The people are wondering if the government is spending money on purchasing MLAs, and has no money left to buy electricity," he said.

Referring to the agricultural situation, Mr. Stalin said the Kuruvai crop had failed and the government, instead of listening to farmers, had "acted on an astrologer's advice" and opened the Mettur dam on the wrong date. "Nothing happened other than the erection of barricades at a cost of ₹5 crore during the Chief Minister's visit to open the dam. Now, there is uncertainty over the Samba crop," he said.

Mr. Stalin felt the State was in the hands of a "stupid crowd".

"We are worried about how the people of Tamil Nadu are going to face the crises in the coming months because of those who do not have even a basic understanding of administration," Mr. Stalin said.

Key evidence seized from Veeramani's residence

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

In a significant development in the sexual assault case against Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani, investigators are learnt to have found photographs of minor girls, including complainants, at his house.

Acting on an input, the police searched the residence of the businessman in Chennai, and found the photographs of the girls, including some survivors who had lodged complaints, leading to the filing of cases under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, police sources said.

The seizure of the incriminating material further corroborated the allegations made against the granite baron that he had exploited poor girl children and subjected them to sexual abuse. The victims who had lodged complaints had identified Veeramani as the man who had abused them, the sources said.

So far, six cases under the POCSO Act and one abetment to suicide case have been filed against the main accused. Though the abetment to suicide in 2004 also involved a minor girl, provisions under the Act could not be invoked since it was not in force then.

Inquiries revealed that the hidden cameras used to record videos of Veeramani and the survivors were purchased online by Mahendra Simhan, the husband of Shanti, another accused.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-2464 0050)

'TMC(M) will function independently until local bodies elections, but will work with Congress in the future'

K. Muralitharan
CHENNAI

> Our members say the party could be strengthened only when there aren't any elections by functioning independently without being tied to any alliance
>
> **G.K. VASAN**
> TMC(M) leader

The Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) will function independently of any alliance until the local bodies elections, its leader G.K. Vasan has said.

However, going forward, it will continue to work closely with the Indian National Congress, he told *The Hindu 360* Tamil YouTube channel in an interview.

"A month after the Assembly election [this year], the executive committee of the TMC met. Several functionaries pointed out that we have consistently remained a part of one alliance or the other, and emphasised that the party could be strengthened only when there aren't any elections by functioning independently without being tied to any alliance. Consequently, we resolved that if the TMC is to establish a robust foundation in the upcoming local bodies elections, we must operate distinctively on our own strength," Mr. Vasan said.

"However, we have not decided to contest elections without any alliance. We have only decided to function independently until the elections," he added.

According to Mr. Vasan, the TVK-led government is performing commendably.

"They are functioning with the intent of delivering honest governance. Naming the breakfast scheme after Kamaraj is commendable. When such governance is being provided, members of our party feel we should extend our support," he said.

After parting ways with the Congress in 2014 to revive the TMC(M), Mr. Vasan contested the 2016 Assembly election with the People's Welfare Front. In the subsequent elections, his party remained a part of the BJP alliance.

However, going forward, the party will work in tandem with the Indian National Congress, he said.

'15 more functionaries may leave AIADMK'

The Hindu Bureau
ERODE

Minister for Revenue and Disaster Management K.A. Sengottaiyan on Tuesday said 15 more functionaries were likely to quit the AIADMK. Those planning to leave the party had held a meeting on Monday, he added.

"It is a good thing that Edappadi K. Palaniswami expelled me from the AIADMK. Had I not left the party, I would have been sitting on the Opposition benches. Look where I am now," he said.

"The AIADMK has become a story of an elephant having shrunk to the size of an ant," he added.

Referring to the Dharapuram byelection, Mr. Sengottaiyan said it was not an ordinary constituency. He recalled that TVK leader C. Joseph Vijay had undertaken a campaign tour in the constituency. "The people want a well-organised and clean administration," he said.

Mr. Sengottaiyan said Mr. Vijay treated everyone with warmth and brotherly affection.

INBRIEF

Sugar cane farmers block highway for higher prices

Sugar cane farmers in Karnataka began a protest for higher prices by blocking the Pune-Bengaluru National Highway at Hire Bagewadi and Hattaragi in Belagavi district on Tuesday. Their demands include doubling the minimum selling price of sugar to ₹60 per kg, increasing the fair and remunerative price to ₹5,500 per tonne of sugar cane, and transparency in weighing in factories. The farmers also urged authorities to buy more ethanol from Karnataka.

Court issues gag order on airing videos on Siddaramaiah

A Bengaluru civil court on Tuesday issued an ad-interim ex-parte temporary injunction restraining further circulation of two videos telecast on two private YouTube channels making allegedly defamatory remarks against former Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah. The interim order restrains 42 media houses from disseminating the impugned videos. Mr. Siddaramaiah had filed a suit in which he denied all the allegations made in the two videos.

Cannabis seized, passenger arrested at Hyderabad airport

The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) seized 7.75 kg of high-grade cannabis from an Indian passenger arriving from Bangkok at the Rajiv Gandhi International Airport in Hyderabad on October 12 and arrested him. The contraband, suspected to be hydroponic cannabis, is worth approximately ₹2.71 crore on the black market. The DRI officers intercepted him at the airport on specific intelligence alert. The contraband was concealed in an electric geyser.

Shivakumar seeks report on police action at SIR protest

Will take action if there was 'unnecessary use of force', says Karnataka CM; his assurance comes a day after police manhandled protesters; govt. says people can hold peaceful protests without fear

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said on Tuesday that he had taken note of the police action against protesters and members of the media on Monday, and had sought a full report on the circumstances that led to it.

"If there has been any unnecessary use of force or excess, accountability will follow," he said.

On Monday, the Bengaluru police detained over 100 persons for attempting to march to the office of the Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka, in protest against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The police also manhandled journalists and photographers, apart from protesters, on a day Mr. Shivakumar was participating in an anti-SIR rally in New Delhi, drawing widespread criticism.

Dissent hour: A protest under way in Bengaluru on Tuesday against SIR and the assault on protesters. K. MURALI KUMAR

"The right to peaceful protest is fundamental to our democracy. We cannot demand that right for ourselves in Delhi and deny it to others in Bengaluru. Karnataka must hold itself to the democratic standards that we expect from the rest of the country. There will be no double standard," the Chief Minister said. "Let me be clear: disagreement with the Election Commission, disagreement with my government or disagreement with me personally does not diminish anyone's right to peacefully express it," he added.

Home Minister Priyank Kharge said he had told the police to ensure that no peaceful demonstration is disrupted. "Our responsibility is not merely to maintain law and order, but to create an environment where every citizen can express dissent freely, peacefully and without fear. In a democracy, peaceful dissent is not a threat to law and order. It is a right that law and order must protect," Mr. Kharge said on X.

Life-saving drugs in short supply in Keralam govt. hospitals: Opposition

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Opposition Left Democratic Front (LDF) and the ruling Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) traded barbs in the Keralam Assembly on Tuesday over the state of the health sector, with the former citing medicine shortages, arbitrary staff retrenchments and transfers, and cases of medical negligence.

Moving an adjournment motion to discuss the shortage of medicines in government hospitals across the State, K.V. Sumesh, MLA, said the health sector had been put "on a ventilator" since the UDF came to power. "Thousands of patients are struggling to obtain medicines for lifestyle diseases from government hospitals, while a critical shortage of life-saving drugs had compounded the crisis," said Mr. Sumesh, citing an alleged leaked audio recording of senior health officials.

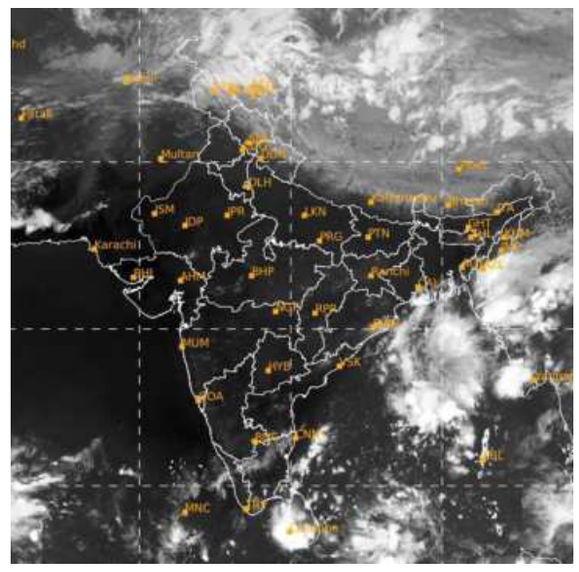
Dismissing the Opposition's allegations, Health Minister K. Muraleedharan maintained that the situation in the health sector was "under control". He remarked that "the only medicine in short supply was one that could cure the Opposition of its ailment of having lost power". He also alleged that the Opposition was working in the interests of private hospitals.

The Minister's remarks triggered an uproar in the Assembly. Opposition leader Pinarayi Vijayan accused the Minister of downplaying the crisis.

The Opposition members subsequently staged a walkout after they were denied permission to discuss the issue.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Wednesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Muzaffarabad, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Chandigarh, Delhi, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Keralam and Mahe

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	34.7	23.8	Kurnool	—	37.7	25.2
Ahmedabad	—	38.5	23.1	Lucknow	—	33.6	22.5
Aizawl	—	32.8	22.8	Madurai	—	37.5	25.6
Bengaluru	—	31.3	21.1	Mangaluru	—	35.2	24.4
Bhopal	—	33.4	20.4	Mumbai	—	38.0	24.0
Bhubaneswar	—	33.6	23.6	Mysuru	—	30.8	19.8
Chandigarh	—	32.8	19.0	New Delhi	—	32.5	21.2
Chennai	—	36.3	27.4	Patna	—	32.8	25.0
Coimbatore	—	35.4	24.2	Port Blair	6.3	31.7	26.2
Dehradun	—	31.6	17.7	Prayagraj	—	34.4	23.5
Gangtok	—	24.2	14.5	Puducherry	—	34.5	25.4
Goa	—	37.2	23.6	Pune	—	35.4	21.1
Guwahati	—	34.0	22.8	Raipur	—	33.2	23.6
Hubballi	—	34.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	30.6	19.0
Hyderabad	—	33.8	21.5	Shillong	—	25.5	15.6
Imphal	—	31.4	16.7	Shimla	—	25.0	15.0
Jaipur	—	35.4	24.3	Srinagar	—	20.0	11.2
Kochi	—	33.0	24.6	Thiruvananthapuram	18	33.4	24.4
Kohima	—	22.6	14.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.5	25.6
Kolkata	—	34.5	26.2	Vijayawada	—	32.8	26.7
Kozhikode	—	36.8	27.0	Visakhapatnam	—	33.8	27.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	9	.45	30	110	224	
Bengaluru	.30	.34	37	98	172	
Chennai	6	.13	52	173	161	
Delhi	.15	.56	50	219	211	
Hyderabad	1	.3	26	113	112	
Kolkata	7	.66	31	143	129	
Lucknow	5	.44	34	70	104	
Mumbai	7	.48	57	122	144	
Pune	.17	.87	45	112	124	
Visakhapatnam	8	.36	26	88	91	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Panipat, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 280 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Gangtok, Sikkim recorded a healthy AQI score of 20

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Satheesan govt. did not stand up to ED like other non-BJP States, says CPI(M)

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The CPI(M) on Tuesday accused Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan of "slyly playing second fiddle" to the RSS agenda to weaken the opposition to the BJP-led Centre by using the Enforcement Directorate (ED) to foist false charges against Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan and others in the CMRL-Exalogic pay-off case.

CPI(M) State secretary M.V. Govindan told the media that Mr. Satheesan's statement that the government would not appeal the High Court single Bench order to register an FIR against Mr. Vijayan, his daughter T. Veena, and former Minister P.A. Mohamed Riyas, based on a "dubious" ED report, corroborated Mr. Satheesan's "cosy deal" with the Sangh Parivar. (A Division Bench on Tuesday declined to stay the single Bench order.)

Mr. Govindan said that in contrast, the non-BJP governments in Tamil Nadu and Punjab had shown the grit to protect their constitutionally guaranteed jurisdictional mandate over law-enforcement matters by rejecting similar ED demands. He sought a clarification from the AICC on Mr. Satheesan's stand.

Minister warns bars after accident

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Keralam Excise Minister M. Liju on Tuesday said that strict action would be taken against bars that serve alcohol to people below the legal drinking age of 23. His assurance came in the wake of the fatal road accident near Nedumbassery in Kochi that claimed the lives of three young people.

Responding to a question raised by Ernakulam MLA T.J. Vinod in the Kerala Assembly on Tuesday, Mr. Liju said the Excise department had registered cases against three bars for allegedly serving alcohol to the 19-year-old driver who hit the trio. The government was considering stricter guidelines to prevent violations of the existing law, he said.

Raising the issue in the House, Mr. Vinod pointed out that Abkari Act prescribes 23 years as the minimum age for consuming alcohol at bars. He expressed concern that the rule was frequently violated.

TAMILNADU TOURISM DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED,
Tamilnadu Tourism Complex, No.02, Wallajah Road, Chennai–02
Telephone No. 25333851 to 25333854 and 25361743
e–Mail Id: ttdcfair@gmail.comWebsite:https://tntenders.gov.in//

e-Tender Document for conduct of "Diwali Crackers Fair 2026"
for Sale of Crackers at Island Grounds for 9 days
e-Tender Notice Ref: HOTTDC/1313/FAIR/2026, Dt. 14.10.2026

For and on behalf of TTDC, e-Tenders are invited from the reputed Traders / Crackers Associations / Manufacturers /registered Cracker Dealers Associations/Event Managers by the General Manager as per the following schedule: -

Description	Tender Schedule	
Conduct of "Diwali Crackers Fair 2026" for sale of crackers in an extent of 1,20,000 sq.ft (Approx.) area on War Memorial side of the Island Grounds as per the terms and conditions prescribed in the e-Tender documents.	EMD	**Rs.50,000/-** to be paid through e-procurement portal
	Uploading of e-Tender through	**https://tntenders.gov.in//**
	Bid Published Date	**14.10.2026 at 12.00 Noon**
	Last date for receiving queries/ clarifications	**16.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.**
	Pre-bid meeting date and time	**16.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.** Address: Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation, Tourism Complex, No.2, Wallajah Road, Chennai-600002
	e-Tender Bid Submission Starting	**14.10.2026 at 12.00 Noon**
	Last Date for Submission of e-Tender	**22.10.2026 at 12.00 Noon**
	e-Tender Technical Bid Opening	**23.10.2026 at 02.30 P.M.**
	e-Tender Financial Bid Opening	To be intimated to technically qualified bidders only.
	Submission of e-Tender, Opening of Technical & Financial Bid	Through TN Government e-Tender website only **https://tntenders.gov.in//**

The Bid Documents are available only on the Tamil Nadu Government e-Tender portal TN Government e-Tender Portal **(https://tntenders.gov.in//).** The eligibility criteria and other terms and conditions stipulated in the Bid Documents shall be followed strictly. Any changes or amendments to the conditions of the e-Tender document, if any, will be intimated only through the Tamil Nadu Government Tenders website.

The Managing Director, Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation Limited (TTDC), reserves the right to accept or reject any or all of the Tenders, assigning valid reasons.

DIPR/3124/Tender/2026

MANAGING DIRECTOR

Interested Sand Artists
are requested to apply by logging on to
odishatourism.gov.in

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37001/57/2627

OIPR-37001/37001/2/26-27/0014

Spiralling food prices

Rural households have felt the greatest impact of rising inflation

September's retail inflation, at 5.54%, an almost two-year high, marks the fourth consecutive month that price increases have kept headline CPI above the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) 4% target. The impact has been particularly severe for rural Indians, whose inflation rate reached 6.08%. Rural food inflation rose almost two percentage points between August and September, touching 8.06%. Onion (108.09%), garlic (54.62%) and ginger (62.85%) drove the surge, even as potato (-11.50%) and tomato (-8.62%) prices remained below year-earlier levels. The festive season ahead will be expensive for rural households already facing the uncertainties of a deficient monsoon, El Niño-related risks to harvests and incomes, and unusually high temperatures. Headline CPI is now just 0.46 percentage points below the RBI's upper tolerance limit of 6%. The Monetary Policy Committee raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% in October, ending a pause that began after its previous increase in February 2023. Another increase in December cannot be ruled out if price pressures continue to broaden. Chief among the factors driving inflation since the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran have been fuel, food and transport, compounded by a depreciating rupee.

The Indian crude basket, according to the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell, rose from $82.04 a barrel in July to $116.09 in September – a 41% increase – with economy-wide implications for freight, production and distribution. The RBI's special dollar facility for oil marketing companies may ease spot-market pressure on the rupee, but only temporarily if the underlying import dependence and geopolitical risks persist. The crucial subgroup, transport services for goods, recorded inflation of 14.73% in September, up from 14.64% in August. Restaurant and accommodation services inflation has reached 9.36%, while inflation in personal care, social protection and miscellaneous goods and services, which include precious metals, has moderated to 13.75%. Core inflation, excluding food and fuel but including precious metals, rose to 4.6% in September from 4.16% in August, suggesting that price pressures are broadening. Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) have pulled a record ₹3.08 trillion ($32.73 billion) out of Indian equities in the nine months ending September this year, which is almost double that of the whole of CY2025. FPIs have been net sellers in six of the past nine months as they seek safe havens, stronger dollar-denominated returns, and bond yields. Selling resumed in October, adding to pressure on the rupee, which weakened by about 7% against the dollar over the year to early October, despite RBI interventions such as direct dollar sales and attracting foreign-currency inflows. The central bank's latest steps have helped the rupee recover, but cannot resolve the underlying pressures. With crude prices elevated, the rupee vulnerable and no clear end to the West Asia conflict, imported inflation is likely to continue shaping domestic prices in the months ahead.

Sound and fiery

Green crackers do little to curb air and noise pollution

As Delhi and the National Capital Region (NCR) head into another winter, they must brace for the return of a foe kept on a leash that is alternately loosened or tightened. In November 2016, the Supreme Court of India suspended licences for the sale of fireworks in the NCR after Deepavali celebrations pushed $PM_{2.5}$ levels above 700 µg/m³. The Court relaxed the suspension in September 2017, partly to protect existing licence holders and livelihoods, but restored the suspension for Deepavali in October. In 2018, in its judgment in *Arjun Gopal and Others vs Union of India and Others*, the Court allowed only reduced-emission and "green" crackers, banned joined firecrackers or *laris*, and imposed a two-hour window. The latest order permits specified next-generation joined green crackers, while declining a total ban on fireworks, invoking public sentiment. Fire crackers are far from the smoking gun of Delhi's air-quality crisis. Construction dust, vehicles, stubble burning and stagnant, cold air all contribute to winter pollution. But when these push the air towards "severe" levels, crackers can produce an acute spike. In 2025, the first Deepavali after the Court permitted limited use of green crackers, Delhi's post-Deepavali $PM_{2.5}$ average reached 488 µg/m³, the highest since 2021, while hourly concentrations peaked at 675 µg/m³.

There is no gainsaying that green crackers are a pyrrhic green. The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI), which promoted them, says the newer generation promises a 45%-60% cut in PM_{10}. These figures, however, do not reflect real-world conditions, and when "cleaner" crackers are burst in greater numbers, the savings in particulate pollution evaporate. This is without accounting for noise pollution. There is also the difficulty of enforcement. The Commission for Air Quality Management has stated that QR codes had been sold to unregistered manufacturers – registered manufacturers reportedly sold them, allowing unauthorised firecrackers to be passed off as certified green crackers. The explosives regulator had no testing facility in Delhi. In 2018 and 2019, the police could not distinguish green crackers from conventional ones. Unless fireworks manufacturing moves into the formal sector, regulations are followed in practice, and awareness of the toll on public health spreads among those who love the sound and fury of crackers, air and noise pollution are here to stay.

India's problem of overtreatment, overmedication

Chandrakant Lahariya

A practising physician and the author of 'Pill-Free: You Don't Need Everything You Have Been Prescribed' (2026)

Modern medicine has never been more capable than it is today. Tests detect illness earlier, scans reveal invisible abnormalities, medicines prevent and treat diseases, and interventions and procedures can save lives within minutes. Yet, the same system that can do more is increasingly tempted to overtreat and overmedicate.

Overtreatment and overmedication are not simply the use of an unnecessary medicine but often a chain: a test detects an incidental abnormality, which leads to another test, a diagnosis and then a prescription that may become permanent. What begins as prevention can end in long-term medication or surgery. Then, in India, overtreatment coexists with undertreatment: unnecessary interventions are offered to some, while many others still lack essential primary care, affordable medicines and timely treatment.

Health packages and tests

The rise of overtreatment is the result of a convergence of several factors. The first driver of overtreatment is unnecessary and excessive testing – both screening and diagnostic – which creates a cascade of care. A review article in the prestigious *National Medical Journal of India* in 2016 found that routine health-check packages often include unwarranted tests that can lead to false-positive results, anxiety, further investigations, overdiagnosis and overtreatment. The truth is that the ability to test has expanded faster than our ability to decide who actually needs testing.

The second driver is the fragmentation of health and medical care. Its most visible manifestation in India is an excessive focus on specialist and super specialist care. A person with a common health problem often goes directly to a specialist or superspecialist. A person with chronic conditions may consult several specialists, each optimising one part of care without necessarily paying attention to the person's other health problems. The patient is treated in parts, while the human body does not live in specialties.

This matters particularly in older adults. A systematic review and meta-analysis of Indian studies, published in *Frontiers in Pharmacology* in 2021, reported polypharmacy in about 49% of older adults. Another study, published in Scientific Reports in 2025, found that roughly one-third of older adults were taking five or more prescribed medicines (polypharmacy), with potentially inappropriate medicines identified in 28.8% of cases.

These figures do not mean that everyone taking several medicines is being overtreated. They do, however, show why medication reviews and deprescribing must become routine.

Unnecessary tests, prescriptions and procedures are part of the growing overtreatment problem

A third force is the transformation of health care into a marketplace. Laboratory tests, radiological investigations, procedures, supplements and monitoring devices have become products to be sold – sometimes products in search of potential customers. As a result, the boundaries between those who genuinely need these interventions and those who do not can become blurred. A linked aspect is that much of health care and medical care in India operates on a fee-for-service model, which can reward activity rather than restraint. Many patients consider a medical consultation complete only when several medicines and investigations have been prescribed.

Health insurance is a proven solution for financial protection from health-related expenses, as the cost is borne by the insurer. However, it can create both 'ex-ante' and 'ex-post' moral hazards, discouraging preventive care and encouraging hospitals and patients to favour costlier interventions. What is forgotten is that while someone else may bear the financial cost, it is the patient's body that undergoes the intervention. Paying insurance premiums for years does not mean that one must 'recover' the money by undergoing a relatively unnecessary procedure or surgery.

Fourth, patient beliefs and expectations arising from advances in medical care where people want certainty when they are worried and may feel that something tangible should follow a consultation. Reassurance can look like inaction; observation can feel inferior to a scan; lifestyle advice can appear less serious than medication. Doctors may respond to these expectations, particularly in crowded clinics where explanation requires time.

The fifth driver is the rise of 'defensive medicine', in which clinicians, fearing that they might miss a rare diagnosis, may consider ordering another test as the safer option. What is often forgotten, however, is that every test carries potential risks, both from the test itself and from the discovery of abnormalities that may never have caused harm.

Choosing wisely

India is not alone in facing this problem. Overtreatment first became widely recognised in high-income countries and is now increasingly visible across many middle-income nations. This gave rise to the global Choosing Wisely movement, which encourages people to choose health-care interventions more carefully. It is against this backdrop, between 2012 and 2023, that nearly 80 specialty societies worldwide published close to 700 recommendations identifying hundreds of tests and treatments that clinicians and patients should question. The message is that medicine requires stronger mechanisms for self-correction. The solutions are about practising better medicine. Halting and reversing overmedicalisation requires the engagement of all stakeholders, including individuals, communities, professional societies and health policymakers.

First, India needs to rebuild stronger and functional primary care and restore the family physician as the first point of contact for most non-emergency health needs. A general physician can decide which problems require specialist expertise, reconcile multiple prescriptions and recognise when treatment can safely be reduced. Initiation of care by a general physician, followed by continuity through the referral pathway, protects patients against overmedication and excess surgeries.

Second, every medical prescription should carry a review date and, where appropriate, a possible stop date. Medicines should not become lifelong simply because nobody asks whether they are still needed. Older adults and people taking five or more medicines should periodically undergo a structured medication review assessing indication, benefit, duplication, interactions and opportunities for deprescribing.

Develop India-specific lists

Third, professional medical societies and the Indian Council of Medical Research should develop Indian lists of low-value tests, treatments and procedures – similar to Choosing Wisely – and embed these principles in medical training, accreditation and quality-improvement programmes. Hospitals should measure not only whether recommended care was provided, but also whether unnecessary care was avoided.

Fourth, before starting any test or treatment, patients should note that these four questions matter: Why do I need this? What happens if I wait? What are the possible benefits and risks? What are the alternatives? These questions can substantially improve clinical conversations and outcomes.

Fifth, payment systems and health insurance must reward outcomes, clinical reasoning and continuity of care rather than volume alone. A health-care system should not make it financially easier to order a scan than to explain thoughtfully why that scan may be unnecessary.

Medical advances will continue – and they should. However, the next stage of medical progress will come not only from discovering more tests, medicines and procedures, but also from learning when not to use them. Good medicine requires action when action helps. In an age of medical abundance, it increasingly requires something more difficult – restraint.

India-U.S. ties and the hurdle of American unilateralism

Rajeev Agarwal

A retired colonel and a strategic affairs expert. He is the author of the book, 'Between Tehran and Tel Aviv – Gaza's Story of Unending War'

Have ties between India and the United States reached a breaking point? Where do they go from here? These and many other questions are being intensely debated following the U.S.'s announcement on October 8 that it had suspended the Permanent Labour Certification (PERM) programme for eight global IT companies, including some Indian-headquartered companies, accusing them of misusing immigration and labour-certification systems. The Indian companies named were Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, Wipro, Cognizant and HCL.

The PERM programme allows tech companies to hire non-U.S. professionals to work in the U.S. and is a step in a employer-sponsored green-card application. According to the U.S. government, tthe companies had received more than 2,30,000 H-1B visa approvals and over 1,00,000 permanent labour certifications since 2009. Indian professionals account for more than 70% of approved H-1B petitions annually.

This episode, however, is not an isolated incident but part of a series of actions and decisions taken by the U.S. in recent years, including the ill-treatment of Indians and racist attacks against them that are placing bilateral ties under severe strain.

Trade ties, visible discord

Trade has emerged as a visible source of discord and asymmetry for three main reasons. First, India recorded a trade surplus of $33.8 billion in bilateral trade exceeding $140 billion in FY 2025-26. Second, the U.S. is seeking access to India's dairy and agriculture sectors in ongoing trade negotiations, which India cannot afford to concede. Third, India has refused to halt Russian oil imports despite additional U.S. tariffs and sanctions.

Despite a framework for an interim agreement on reciprocal and mutually beneficial trade announced in February 2026, the strain in trade ties persists. Last week, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said that trade talk negotiations had "plateaued", with little scope for give-and-take.

Washington wants a subservient India, but New Delhi must draw the line

Defence and security cooperation has emerged as a key pillar of relations. Over the past two decades, India and the U.S. have expanded military exercises, logistics arrangements and intelligence-sharing. American weapons platforms have also become increasingly important to India's military modernisation.

Since 2002, India has acquired over $22 billion worth of American military hardware, but meaningful co-production and technology transfer remain elusive. During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Washington in February 2025, the U.S. agreed to expand defence sales and co-production in India, including Javelin anti-tank guided missiles and Stryker infantry combat vehicles. The two countries subsequently signed a 10-year Framework for the U.S.-India Major Defence Partnership on October 31, 2025.

However, a strategic defence partnership of this magnitude must be assessed by what it delivers, not merely the number of agreements signed. Prolonged delays in the supply of GE F404 engines for India's Tejas fighter aircraft highlight the risks of relying on foreign suppliers for critical military components and the strategic cost of supply-chain vulnerabilities. Despite initiatives such as the India-U.S. Defence Acceleration Ecosystem (INDUS-X), launched in 2023, co-development and technology transfer remain an issue.

The Pakistan factor

Pakistan has always been a politically sensitive source of friction between India and the U.S., particularly since Operation Sindoor (May 2025). U.S. President Donald Trump's repeated claims that he ended the conflict have irked India, although New Delhi has refrained from direct confrontation. The U.S.'s courting of Pakistan's top leadership, especially its Chief of Defence Forces, Asim Munir, has also been a major irritant. The signing of the Mecca Pact between Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Türkiye, reportedly with Washington's blessings, has raised further security concerns for India.

High-end technology is another area in which India has often been forced to look to the U.S. – a situation that Washington has sought to exploit. Although the 2008 India-U.S. civil nuclear agreement was a historic breakthrough, its commercial promise of American-designed nuclear reactors in India remains largely unrealised. The Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (iCET), launched in 2023, was cited as an attempt to deepen cooperation in artificial intelligence, semiconductors, defence innovation, space and other advanced technologies, but much remains on paper. The India-U.S. Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology (TRUST) Initiative, signed on February 13, 2025, also raised hopes of greater technology transfer and integration. The key challenge, however, remains translating declarations into measurable outcomes.

Need for mutual respect

India-U.S. relations are entering a phase in which India's strategic restraint and efforts at accommodation are increasingly met with American pressure, unilateralism and outright disregard for India's strategic interests. Whether this is a difficult phase or a deeper structural problem remains to be seen. The relationship between the world's oldest democracy and the world's largest democracy can flourish only through equality, respect and trust, not unilateral imposition of will. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar's recent observation that the U.S. is "deliberately becoming a lonelier power" may convey more than what the words suggest.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Young voices, new politics

What the stir over the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls has achieved is the emergence of several charismatic young faces whom Gen Z can rally around. This could well shape the political narrative of the future. Staying relevant will be a formidable challenge for all political parties, particularly the Bharatiya Janata Party. What is remarkable about these young voices is the depth of their leadership pool. Detain one set of leaders and another steps forward to address the media. That kind of a resilience is remarkable. Their clarity of thought, confidence in expression and ability to articulate their concerns suggest that this is not merely a moment of protest but potentially the beginning of a new political narrative.

Pavan Kumar N.R.,
Shivamogga, Karnataka

Visual indictment

The Hindu's illustrator deserves compliments for a brilliant and piercing visual (Inside pages, 'On the draw', October 11). The depiction of the Chief Election Commissioner of India, Gyanesh Kumar, as a fly ruining a glass of milk has captured public anger directed at the Election Commission of India (ECI) and the controversy around the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The cartoon reminds us that democracy cannot function when the very umpire tasked with keeping the pitch clean is seen as the contaminant. The Supreme Court of India's recent questions on voter roll modifications only add weight to this powerful visual.

Instead of clamping down on dissent, the government and the ECI must answer why a routine exercise has instead left lakhs of genuine voters out in the cold.

R. Sivakumar,
Chennai

A day for dam safety

The Srisailam dam across the Krishna river experienced an unprecedented peak inflow of about 25.50 lakh cubic feet per second during the October 2009 floods, with high inflows for nearly 78 hours. On October 3, 2009, the reservoir level reached 896.50 feet, 11.50 feet above the Full Reservoir Level of 885 feet. This extraordinary event underscores the importance of dam safety and resilience. October 3 should therefore be observed every year as India's National Dam Safety Day.

Y. Abdul Basheer,
Hyderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address and the full name or the name with initials.

Why Congress must not smear CJP

Vanya Vaidehi Bhargav

Historian at the National Law School of India, Bangalore, and the author of 'Being Hindu, Being Indian: Lala Lajpat Rai's Ideas of Nationhood'

Something unprecedented is afoot. India's opposition parties and thousands of ordinary citizens are finally galvanised against the Modi government. They are speaking in one voice against voter suppression and for India's democratic future. The staggering police counter-mobilisation suggests the once-invincible government feels threatened. Yet, Opposition parties may squander this opportunity. Hints are evident on Twitter, where some Congress supporters are attacking the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

The conspiracy theory being peddled is that the CJP was created by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), and their supposed 'B-team', the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), to draw youth support away from Rahul Gandhi. This ignores the fact that Abhijeet Dipke, CJP founder, has accused Amit Shah of turning the Delhi Police into a 'bunch of criminals', and called Prime Minister Modi a "psychotic dictator" lacking the *aukaat* (worth) to become greater than Nehru, and who became Prime Minister due to vote theft. The unprecedented police repression of CJP's October 10 protest too contradicts this theory. However, this attempt by some Congress supporters to discredit the CJP is significant; it reveals their insecurity, that CJP leaders, some of whom had previous affiliations with the AAP, will repeat AAP's history of undercutting Congress's support base in Delhi and Punjab. They intend to discredit the CJP in order to keep youth support safe for Mr. Gandhi. It will instead erode it.

The youth had grown frustrated with India's education system, economy and infrastructure. This was worsened by relentless propaganda denying people's reality, a stifling atmosphere of fear, and the closure of all channels of democratic dissent. The CJP's call to assemble at Jantar Mantar came as a new lease of life to a dying democracy. The youth expressed relief at the opening of a democratic space after years of oppressive silence to which many had resigned. The increased freedom to speak, disagree, and criticise was palpable and contagious. The CJP provided a common platform for a diverse coalition of dissenters to coalesce, and express dissent in personalised, creative ways under one banner.

Need to stand together

This does not deny Rahul Gandhi's work on paper leaks, institutional capture and voter suppression. Yet, the Congress would be deceiving itself if it believed that – after the Bharat Jodo Yatra in 2022 – it has consistently prioritised calling a cross-section of ordinary citizens onto the streets under its banner and organising India's diverse dissenters into a popular coalition. The CJP, in doing that, has punctured the BJP's aura of invincibility, creating a juncture pregnant with opportunity for the Opposition. If the CJP is a plot to undercut Mr. Gandhi, it is currently achieving the opposite. That his decency, fearlessness and ideological commitment had had an impact is evidenced by several Gen Z youth expressing support for Mr. Gandhi during the CJP's July protest. His *Chhatron Ki Goonj* rallies have been boosted by the CJP's youth galvanisation.

But the obsessive attacks by some Congress supporters on the CJP threaten to squander this opportunity. The CJP is popular because it is perceived as prioritising people's interests. Mutual criticism is democratic, but smear campaigns will be read as reflecting the petty insecurity of Congresspersons, and as disregarding the agency and intelligence of dissenters to judge who inspires and represents them authentically. This threatens the goodwill Mr. Gandhi has earned by prioritising people's causes and platforming citizens galvanised by the CJP. While he has not smeared the CJP, such impressions may attach to Mr. Gandhi. The protestors' independence of mind make it clear that they will reject anyone suspected of placing personality cult or partyism over authentic concern for India's dissenting people. In his own interest and his party's, Mr. Gandhi must rein in his social media supporters.

Rahul Gandhi must accept the challenge of his youth support being undermined. No party is entitled to the support of India's dissenting citizens. It must be earned. If Congress claims to represent the youth, it must persuade them it does so best. The CJP resonates because it offers an open, accessible space that amplifies rather than dwarfs ordinary citizens' voices. Mr. Gandhi will similarly win goodwill by inspiring dissenting citizens and non-party opposition groups to treat Congress as an umbrella platform for expressing their dissent creatively.

The CJP is popular because it is perceived as prioritising people's interests. Mutual criticism is democratic, but smear campaigns will be read as reflecting the petty insecurity of Congresspersons

Nobel lesson: value of stabilisation models

Sushanta Kumar Mahapatra

Associate Professor of Economics at the ICFAI School of Social Sciences, IFHE, Hyderabad

Economic fluctuations, in addition to being reflected in GDP numbers, inflation, and unemployment rates, impact household budgets, hiring decisions of companies, and the ability of families to save money. This year's Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel (2026), given to Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford for "microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation", highlights an essential concept – successful economic policies require an understanding of how individual households and businesses make their economic choices.

Importance of their work

Governments have spent many years attempting to reduce the size of both the 'peaks' (highs) and 'troughs' (lows) that occur in the business cycle. In times of low economic activity (which is characterised by weak demand), central banks use their power to cut interest rates; in times of strong economic activity (characterised by strong demand), policy changes may need to be made to restrict further growth.

However, the oil crises of the 1970s demonstrated that there were weaknesses in the models that were being utilised at that time. It became clear that the relationships between inflation, unemployment, consumption, and production were far more variable than had previously been believed. During this period, inflation continued to rise with unemployment levels also rising. Additionally, growth rates were declining. Therefore, stimulating an economy at the wrong time could result in even greater problems.

Mr. Hall and Mr. Woodford advanced macroeconomic stabilisation through their focus on placing household and business decisions at the centre of economic studies.

Mr. Hall's research demonstrated how consumption patterns reflect people's expectations of future earnings. However, he acknowledged that many households are unable to smooth out their spending due to a lack of savings and credit. In India, then, policymakers should consider the variations among households with different levels of financial security (that is high-income vs. low-income), instead of making decisions based upon what is considered to be the "average" consumer.

John Maynard Keynes was the first to recognise the importance of stabilising an economy. Following a similar line, Mr. Woodford developed his ideas within a practical new Keynesian model which links consumer spending, inflation and the overall level of economic activity. It allows policymakers to analyse how changes in interest rates could impact the economy. An important part of the model is that prices are "sticky", which means that firms do not immediately change their prices when there is a change in demand or cost. Firms set prices based upon what they believe their future costs, demand and competitors' prices will be. Therefore, expectations set for the future can affect today's inflation.

Central banks' credibility and communication is important because a central bank's decision on interest rates does more than explain what its policy rate is today. Such announcements will affect people's expectations for future interest rates and inflation which will again ultimately influence their decisions today. Clear and consistent communications from central banks allow households and businesses to make plans.

On the other hand, unpredictable signals from central banks or announcements of policies that are not followed through with actions can reduce the effectiveness of monetary policy.

Supply issues too

The model warns that not all shocks should be viewed as being caused by demand. Disruptions to supply may also lead to higher prices, lower levels of output, and an increase in unemployment at the same time, which would need to be tackled with other available policy options than just adjusting interest rates. Stabilisation models for India must take into account what is happening within the country, as well as be backed up with a strong monetary policy, responsible fiscal management, access to reliable data and specific assistance provided to those who are the most at risk of losing their jobs.

In the end, the value of the Nobel prize is in encouraging disciplined policymaking that takes into consideration the context in which it operates, while protecting price stability, job security and people's livelihoods.

The reason why central banks' credibility and communication is important is because a central bank's decision on interest rates does more than explain what its policy rate is today

Legal aid cuts jail time for undertrials, but help often arrives late

Reaching prisoners soon after arrest is key if free legal aid is to reduce the human and economic costs of pre-trial detention

DATA POINT

Indulekha Guha
Trisha Chanda

India jails fewer people than most countries – about 41 for every 1,00,000 people – yet more than three-quarters of its prisoners in 2022 were awaiting trial. That places India fourth in the world in the share of undertrials in its prison population. Many of them are poor, poorly educated, or from marginalised communities and remain in jail not because they have been convicted but because they cannot navigate the system or afford a lawyer.

Free legal aid is meant to close this gap. The Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 created the National Legal Services Authority to provide free legal services to weaker sections of society. But three decades on, limited outreach, low awareness and uneven quality mean that many undertrials still go without timely help.

A legal aid programme run since 2018 across eight prisons in Maharashtra offers insights into what such help can achieve. Implemented by Prayas (Tata Institute of Social Sciences) and the Fair Trial Fellowship (National Law University, Delhi), and funded by the Azim Premji Foundation, it targets those least able to secure representation: casual workers, women abandoned by their families, minorities, or migrant workers.

By analysing the records of over 22,000 undertrials assisted between 2018 and 2023, it was found that the typical participant is 29 years old, and that close to half have studied only up to primary school. Further, 18% are women and 57% are casual wage workers. By comparing their outcomes with the district court records in Maharashtra and used national labour force and time use surveys, the costs of detention were estimated.

To begin with, programme participants obtain bail far more often than the average applicant. Across 29 districts, 84% of participants' bail applications succeeded, compared with 26% of all applications in the same district courts between 2015 and 2020. Participants did better in 28 of the 29 districts. The gap persists even within categories of offence severity, so it is not simply because the programme serves people accused of minor crimes. Within the programme, bail outcomes change sharply at intake. Before intake, the share of participants granted bail ranged from about 1% to 6% across groups by gender, income, education and occupation. After intake, it ranged from 61% to 92%.

Timing, however, matters a great deal. Participants spent on average 171 days – more than five months – in jail before they entered the programme. Those released on bail spent a further 115 days in custody on average, taking the total from arrest to release to about eight months. In 2018, about 37% of Maharashtra's 26,898 undertrials had been held for more than a year **(Table 1)**.

The cost of detention

Detention before trial is costly for people who mostly live on daily earnings. The wages participants lose in custody was estimated by matching them to similar workers in the Periodic Labour Force Survey and multiplying their daily wage by the number of days they were detained. The losses are large relative to their incomes. From arrest to release, average losses reach up to about ₹2 lakh for some age groups, while more than 60% of participants earn less than ₹80,000 a year. Losses rise with age and peak among workers in their 50s **(Chart 2)**.

Losses also vary by group. After intake alone, those facing the most serious charges lose about ₹80,000 on average, nearly four times the ₹21,000 lost by those accused of the least severe offences. This is driven mainly by longer detention rather than higher earnings. Graduates and regular wage workers also lose more, since their wages are higher **(Chart 3)**.

The uncomfortable question this raises is: why do so many undertrials wait months for help that is already their right? Legal aid is usually seen as a matter of rights. These findings suggest it is also an intervention with economic returns. By helping undertrials file bail applications, coordinate with advocates, gather documents and meet release conditions, the programme appears to cut through the procedural frictions that prolong detention.

Shorter detention can ease prison overcrowding, lower public spending on prisons, and limit income losses for vulnerable households. The most actionable lesson concerns timing. Legal aid can improve outcomes after intake, but it cannot recover the months already spent in jail. Identifying eligible prisoners at or soon after arrest could substantially raise its impact. Better data would also help. Caste, religion, income and migration status are missing for much of the sample, which limits what can be said about who benefits most.

Comparing participants with similar defendants in court records would allow a rigorous evaluation of the programme's effect, and tracking people after release would show whether the gains last. As governments seek to widen access to justice, legal aid works best when it reaches undertrial prisoners early enough to prevent unnecessary detention.

Note: Programme participants are not randomly selected, so the comparisons are descriptive rather than causal. Wage and time losses are accounting estimates of the value of time spent in custody: predicted daily wages from the PLFS 2017-18 multiplied by days detained. Since undertrials differ from the general population, they should be read as upper-bound estimates. Each period is averaged over participants with valid dates for that period.

Cost of delayed justice

Data for the charts were sourced from authors' calculations using Azim Premji Foundation programme records and the Periodic Labour Force Survey 2017-18

Table 1: Time spent in custody by programme participants (in days)

Period	Participants	Average	Maximum
Arrest to programme intake	18,093	171	1,843
Intake to release on bail	8,987	115	1,122
Arrest to release on bail	8,921	239	2,039

Durations after intake are for participants with a recorded release date

Chart 2: Age-wise predicted wage loss of participants during their detention for the period between intake to release. After intake alone, those facing the most serious charges lose about ₹80,000 on average, nearly four times the ₹21,000 lost by those accused of the least severe offences.

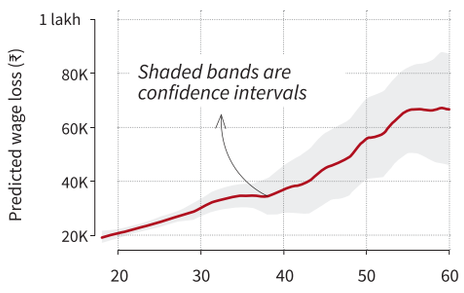
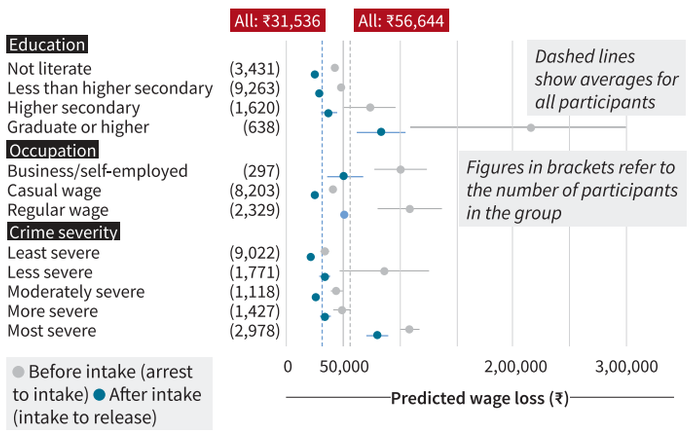


Chart 3: Predicted wage loss before and after programme intake by group. Each participant is counted once, by their most serious case. The chart excludes unemployed participants and those outside the labour force



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FROM THE ARCHIVES
The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 14, 1976

Inadequate library services in Asia and Africa

Lusaka, October 13: The Pro Vice-Chancellor of the University of Zambia, Mr. Moses Musonda has underlined the need for greater efforts by developing countries in Asia and Africa to develop their information systems to get over the woefully inadequate situation in this field.

The state of libraries and information services in Africa – and indeed in developing countries – are appalling, he said, in a closing speech to the six-day standing conference of Eastern, Central and Southern African librarians here yesterday.

Equally frightening, he told the delegates, was the paucity of trained and qualified personnel to man these services which made the running of the libraries and information systems poorly co-ordinated. The main reason for this situation developing, Mr. Musonda said, could be attributed to the fact that some governments had not recognised the importance of these systems. Mr. Musonda said, another reason was that personnel training has not been encouraging since there were very few people who understood or appreciated the importance and implication of developing information systems for the benefit of developing countries.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 14, 1926

Astronomical research and industrial development

The extensive use which is now being made of research facilities for testing materials destined for industrial use was recently illustrated in the sending of samples of rubber from England to Switzerland to be tested for moisture absorption.

This was undertaken by Dr. Kollieker, the Swiss Government astronomer, at the observatory situated over 11,000 feet above sea-level 2,000 feet or so beneath the crest of the Jung-frau mountain in the Bernese Oberland. Here weather conditions and atmospheric effects are studied, the station being fitted with a high-power telescope for astronomical research.

During the summer this is frequently used for sweeping the mountain side in search of belated travellers, thousands visiting the Jung-frau observatory to obtain the view which extends beyond the French Vosges mountains and to the Black Forest in Germany.

From Page One

Resistance to go on, says Rahul after hosting allies

Sources said it was decided at the meeting that though there may be breaks in large-scale protest actions because of the Navratri and Durga Puja festivities, the agitation will continue, with Delhi remaining the main focus. Parties belonging to the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) will coordinate every day among each other for joint action.

Opposition leaders from 16 parties attended, including M.A. Baby (CPI-M), D. Raja and P. Sandosh Kumar (CPI), Tejashwi Yadav and Manoj Jha (RJD), Mahua Maji (JMM), Harender Malik, Anand Bhadauria, and Mohibullah Nadvi (SP), Sanjay Raut (Shiv Sena-UBT), Sagarika Ghose and Mahua Moitra (Mamata Trinamool Congress), G. Deverajan (Forward Bloc), and Dipankar Bhattacharya (CPI-ML)L. AISA chief Neha Bora and advocate Prashant Bhushan also attended the tea party at Mr. Gandhi's No. 5 Sunehri Bagh Road residence. Top Congress leaders, including party chief Mallikarjun Kharge, Sonia Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and K.C. Venugopal, were also present.

Mr. Gandhi said that people who "destroy India's Constitution and the election system" could not be allowed to get away with it, vowing that action will be taken against those who have indulged in alleged "vote *chori* (theft)".

"It is our commitment that the people who have done this – [Prime Minister Narendra] Modi, who is the main architect, [Union Home Minister] Amit Shah, who is implementer, [CEC] Gyanesh Kumar and others – they need to understand that the net is closing around them... We assure you that all would be brought to justice," he asserted.

'Will fight to regain Jantar Mantar'

Several leaders objected to the government denotifying the designated protest site at Jantar Mantar and vowed to reclaim it. "Earlier, they [BJP] were indulging in vote *chori* but now they are resorting to protest site *chori*," said Mr. Baby. Mr. Raja also strongly condemned the decision to denotify Jantar Mantar, saying, "We will fight to regain it."

Mr. Raut said the government had kept the country in "fear and intimidation, but now it's their turn to be afraid". The Sena (UBT) leader added, "Gyanesh Kumar is a mafia, he is such a mafia who has criminalised the [electoral] system. We know how to fight and deal with such mafias."

13 children killed in Bihar boat capsize

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed pain over the incident and announced ex gratia of ₹2 lakh each to the families of the deceased and ₹50,000 to those injured.

"The loss of lives in the boat capsizing in Vaishali is deeply painful. My thoughts are with the bereaved families," the Prime Minister said on X.

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary also expressed grief and announced ₹4 lakh ex gratia for each of the deceased's families. "The news of the lives lost in the boat accident in Raghopur is extremely heartbreaking and soul-wrenching," Mr. Choudhary wrote. "...Instructions have been given to the administration to swiftly complete relief and rescue operations and ensure better treatment for the injured," he further wrote.

Raghopur MLA and Leader of Opposition in the Legislative Assembly, Tejashwi Yadav, expressed his condolences in a video message posted on X.

SC gives Centre more time to reply to pleas against detentions, transport shutdown

Bench headed by CJI Surya Kant allows govt. to file reply affidavit on Thursday; Solicitor-General says the affidavit is ready but needs fine-tuning; top court also agrees to urgently hear petitions for probe and contempt proceedings against police action on journalists covering anti-CEC-SIR protests

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Union government informed the Supreme Court on Tuesday that its response to petitions alleging illegal detentions, shutdown of public and rail transport, including Metro service, in Delhi on October 10 is "ready" but needs more fine-tuning.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant extended the time for the government to file the reply affidavit till Thursday. Multiple petitions, including ones seeking contempt proceedings, were adjourned to October 15 as one of the judges on the Bench was unwell.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, for the Centre, said he had gone through the prepared affidavit. It was final, but he wanted to make it "more comprehensive". On the petitioners' request, the court asked him to share the affidavit, if possible, by October 14, a day before the hearing so that the lawyers of the petitioners were suitably well-versed with the contents of the affidavit and the hearing would be a meaningful one.

The court also agreed to urgently hear fresh petitions seeking independent probe and contempt proceedings against authorities on the continued police action against journalists, especially women media professionals, covering the anti-CEC/SIR protests despite an apex court order against it on October 11.

Chief Justice Kant asked the petitioners to cure defects, after which the pleas would also be put up for a comprehensive hearing on Thursday.

Police action: A protester being detained during the anti-CEC demonstration in New Delhi on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The court asked for a senior police officer to be present during the next hearing, when allegations of assault on women are raised in the courtroom.

Members of the Supreme Court Bar Association and Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association, of which petitions were adjourned on Tuesday, gathered at the Supreme Court lawns to express solidarity with the advocates who were assaulted and detained by the police during the October 10 and 11 protests.

A separate petition was orally mentioned by senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia about the "sad" incident which happened in the Supreme Court on Monday.

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders had come to the Supreme Court Registry after filing a petition seeking a probe into SIR and allegations of arbitrary functioning and misconduct against CEC Gyanesh Kumar.

Mr. Gandhi's arrival had drawn a crowd of lawyers within the court premises, and the participants of his 'March for Democracy' converged in large numbers at the outer gates of the court.

Mr. Bhatia said a plea by advocate Divyansh Bisht has sought initiation of criminal contempt against Mr. Gandhi and other Opposition leaders for obstructing justice, a ban on political demonstrations inside court premises, a "neutral framework" to regulate protests near courts, and safeguards against political interference in *sub judice* cases.

The court also saw the urgent mentioning of petitions by organisations of media professionals, including Free Speech Collective and Network of Women in Media, India, which said the violence visited upon journalists were "not merely isolated obstruction, but an asserted course of police action comprising unlawful detention, forcible removal, physical assault, manhandling, intimidation, disregard of press credentials and the calculated exclusion and removal of journalists from places where public power was being exercised".

Senior advocate Nitya Ramakrishnan said "documentary proof of students being abused in police stations" have been placed on record before the top court and should be taken up for hearing on Thursday.

Shah slams SIR protests, tells Rahul to be ready for defeat in 2029 polls

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress will suffer its fourth consecutive defeat, while the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) will return to power with an overwhelming majority in the 2029 Lok Sabha elections, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said on Tuesday, following the Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) victory in Gujarat's local body elections.

"The trust of the people cannot be earned through manufactured media events and the echo of falsehoods. Gathering 8,000 people within a 1.5-km area by bringing together cadres from 14 parties cannot be described as voice of the nation," he said.

The Congress, he said, should recognise that the voice of the nation also resonated in farms, villages, remote hills, forests and

Amit Shah

along riverbanks, where the principal Opposition had "little or no reach". He cited Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu as States where, according to him, voters had repeatedly rejected the Congress over several decades.

'Negative politics'

The Home Minister questioned Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi's allegations concerning the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process, asking whether the BJP's victory in Gujarat was also attributable to the SIR.

"Ever since Rahul Gandhi became the principal leader of the Congress, then its president, and now the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, the Congress has continued to lose elections. He needs to introspect," Mr. Shah said.

The Home Minister said the Congress's continued pursuit of "negative politics" would not benefit the party and urged Mr. Gandhi to understand public sentiment and establish direct contact with voters.

He also accused the Congress of attempting to protect illegal infiltrators on the pretext of opposing the SIR, saying people understood what he described as the party's "strategy" and would no longer be misled by it.

"The BJP's resounding victory in the local body elections in Gujarat and the recently concluded by-elections and local elections in other States has once again proven that the people have completely rejected the lies of Rahul Gandhi and the INDIA bloc," Mr. Shah said.

In the elections to three municipalities and municipal corporations in Gujarat, the BJP won 90 of the 104 seats. In the Gandhinagar corporation, which falls under Mr. Shah's constituency, the party secured 38 of the 44 seats.

Responding to Mr. Shah's statement, Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh said, "The co-architect of 'vote *chori*' has, not surprisingly, 'predicted' the 2029 Lok Sabha election for which undoubtedly he has already begun the rigging process. But it is not going to happen."

Congress is living in denial over election defeats: BJP, JD(U)

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and its ally, the Janata Dal-United (JD-U), on Tuesday accused the Congress of undermining constitutional institutions and creating disorder in an attempt to regain power. The BJP and JD(U) alleged the principal Opposition questioned the Election Commission of India (ECI)'s credibility after electoral defeats but accepted the process whenever it won.

Piyush Goyal

In a joint press conference at the BJP headquarters, Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh of the JD(U) shared the platform with senior BJP leader and Union Minister Piyush Goyal. Both the Ministers condemned the alleged mistreatment of a pregnant journalist covering the Congress-led protest on Monday.

Mr. Goyal said if the Congress genuinely doubted the impartiality of the ECI and the integrity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process, the six Chief Ministers of States where the party was in power or part of the ruling coalition should resign. He referred to Karnataka, Telangana, Himachal Pradesh, and Keralam, besides Jharkhand and Tamil Nadu.

'Double standards'

Accusing the Congress of double standards, Mr. Goyal said the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and his party had a "delulu is the solulu" ("delusion is the solution") mindset, suggesting that they were living in denial over electoral setbacks.

Mr. Goyal asked Mr. Gandhi why he had repeatedly been alleging "vote theft" without submitting an affidavit or evidence; and why the Congress opposed the SIR when some of its own leaders had demanded electoral roll purification and even acknowledged its benefits.

The Congress and Mr. Gandhi were questioning the impartiality of the ECI, Mr. Goyal said, but had forgotten their own track record of allegedly rewarding former election officials with political appointments. The Modi government, in contrast, introduced a law in 2023 providing for a selection panel, which includes the Leader of the Opposition, to decide on the appointment of Election Commissioners, he said.

"I don't think Rahul Gandhi, the Congress party, or the Aam Aadmi Party, by sending its B-team [an apparent reference to the Cockroach Janta Party], can undermine Indian democracy," Mr. Goyal said, claiming the protests had drawn a limited number of participants.

Alleging Mr. Gandhi wanted "institutions that remain loyal to him", the JD(U) Minister cited two instances of former judges during the Congress regime. He alleged the Congress was now trying to discredit institutions and pressure them through protests.

Top court registers Rahul's plea on SIR, CEC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A petition filed by Opposition leaders led by Rahul Gandhi in the Supreme Court for a complete disclosure of records and decisions of the Election Commission of India (ECI) on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and an independent probe into allegations of unilateral exercise of power by Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, which led to voter deletions and modifications, was successfully registered on Tuesday for judicial hearing.

The Supreme Court Registry cleared and numbered the petition within 24 hours of its filing on Monday. The petition was filed on Monday evening by Mr. Gandhi's legal team even as the Congress leader led a march to the Supreme Court.

Leaders across the Opposition political spectrum had walked to the court to mark their presence as petitioners in the case.

Use of Form 6 to re-enlist voters is an anomaly, says plea

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

'It requires people to state that they are applying to be voters for the first time, even for re-inclusion'

A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court over a "fundamental anomaly" in requiring people whose names were deleted from electoral rolls during the special intensive revision to fill Form 6 if they want re-inclusion in voters' list.

The form, the petition pointed out, requires every applicant to affirm they are applying for inclusion in the rolls for the first time.

During the enumeration phase of the SIR in Delhi, 47,56,722 electors were excluded from the draft roll under the 'absent, shifted, dead or duplicate entry' (ASDD) category. For them, the only mechanism to have their name restored is through Form 6.

The plea says this creates a fundamental anomaly as they were earlier enrolled, but are now required to submit Form 6 and declare they are seeking inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time, which is factually incorrect and wholly inapplicable to their circumstances.

Further, such persons also become liable to face a fine or even imprisonment for giving a false declaration under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act (RPA), 1950.

It also points out that an additional declaration that maps a voter's links with the previous SIR rolls, and which is required to be submitted along with the form, is without the force of law and should be struck down.

The petition was filed by transparency activists Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, who also have another petition challenging the procedures on discrepancies in the Delhi SIR, pending before the court.

India and Canada together contributing to prosperous, stable world: Modi to Carney

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

India and Canada are together contributing to a "more stable and prosperous world", said Prime Minister Narendra Modi after a call with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney, during which they agreed to conclude a trade agreement soon.

The phone call on Tuesday night came even as senior Canadian Ministers, including Foreign Minister Anita Anand and Minister of International Trade Maninder Sidhu, are in Delhi for talks with their counterparts – External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar and Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal – and to firm up plans for Mr. Modi's visit to Ottawa in December.

Last week, National Security Advisor Ajit Doval also hosted Canadian Senior Diplomatic and International Affairs Advisor David Morrison, during which the two sides discussed cooperation on "security and law enforcement", without mentioning the Nijjar killing case that had led to the suspension of relations between the two nations from 2023 to 2025.

Narendra Modi and Mark Carney shake hands during the 2025 G20 Summit. FILE PHOTO

On Wednesday morning, Ms. Anand and Mr. Jaishankar will be part of a panel discussion to discuss the "Middle Power Moment", along with former British Prime Minister Rishi Sunak and former Australian Prime Minister Kevin Rudd.

'Warm talks'

Mr. Modi said his conversation with Mr. Carney had been "warm and productive". "We agreed to build on the positive momentum in India-Canada ties and work towards concrete outcomes across key areas of our Strategic Partnership, including trade, energy, technology, security and people-to-people ties," Mr. Modi said in a post on social media.

The Canadian Prime Minister's office put out a more detailed readout of the conversation, adding that the two leaders had discussed defence and security as well as reaffirmed their commitment to conclude negotiations on the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) at the "earliest opportunity," and to double two-way trade, at about $23 billion in 2025, by 2030.

According to officials, the two sides are expected to announce the trade agreement in mid-December, when Mr. Modi will travel to Canada for his first bilateral visit in more than a decade.

APPEAL

Sastidharan is one year old baby suffering from "B - cell Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia". He needs Chemotherapy at Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research centre, Madurai. The total expenditure is Rs.7,00,000/-. His father is a farmer on daily wages. The family is very poor and cannot afford this huge cost. Please support him for the treatment. Donations sent by Ch/D.D. favouring **Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai will be acknowledged.** The donations sent through Ch/D.D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, **A/C.No:60182010063310**, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT. Your **mail id** is requested.

All correspondence is done through **WWS**, Regd. Public Charitable Trust, Flat No. GF 1, Corddel Apartments, O.No.13 N.No.29, Pycrofts Garden Lane, Chennai - 600006. Ph: 044-42137401/31523781/7338978027.

Email ID: womenswelfaresyndicate@gmail.com.
Website: www.womenswelfaresyndicate.org

WWS

Muslims disproportionately flagged in Delhi SIR

Muslims, who form 13.6% of electors on Delhi's draft roll amid the SIR process, made up 20.3% of those flagged for 'logical discrepancies' and 30% of those flagged under five reasons indicative of family size by the Election Commission's ERONET software; in Bihar, which didn't have 'logical discrepancy' checks, Muslims accounted for 18.4% of deleted electors, in line with their 17.7% share in population

Pon Vasanth B.A.
Srinivasan Ramani
CHENNAI

An analysis of Delhi's draft electoral rolls released as part of the special intensive revision (SIR) process showed that the software-driven "logical discrepancies" check is flagging a disproportionately higher number of Muslims.

Muslims, who form 13.6% of electors on Delhi's draft roll, made up 20.3% of those flagged for "logical discrepancies", and 30% of those flagged under five reasons indicative of family size. Who got flagged was decided not by the Electoral Registration Officers (EROs), the statutory custodians of the rolls, but by the Election Commission of India's (ECI's) centralised ERONET software.

Delhi's draft roll

The Hindu digitised Delhi's draft SIR rolls, which had 97.54 lakh voters, of whom 33.12 lakh were flagged for notices by the ECI, to study patterns. The latter set included two distinct sets of electors: 13.79 lakh flagged for being "Unmapped with Last SIR" and another 19.33 lakh for "logical discrepancies" based on eight reasons.

Our analysis shows that Muslims accounted for 13.6%, or roughly 13.3 lakh, of the 97.54 lakh electors (refer to the box for methodology). This is not much higher than the 12.9% representation of Muslims in the 2011 Census.

Among the 13.79 lakh who were "Unmapped with Last SIR," members of the community accounted for only 7.6%, which meant that higher proportion of Muslims than non-Muslims were able to map themselves with the last SIR.

But among the umbrella category of "logical discrepancies" featuring 19.33 lakh electors, Muslims accounted for 20.3%, which is 12.8 percentage points higher than their share among unmapped electors and 6.7 percentage points higher than their share among total electors in the draft roll.

To put it another way, for every 1,000 Muslim electors in the draft roll, 318 were flagged for "logical discrepancies", while the corresponding figure for the rest of the non-Muslim electors was 197 per 1,000. This means that Muslims were 60% more likely to be marked for "logical discrepancies" than non-Muslims.

Interestingly, a similar data analysis for Bihar's draft rolls showed that Muslims accounted for 18.4% of deleted electors, not much higher than their 17.7% share of the adult population as per the 2011 Census. The "logical discrepancies" checks were not used in the Bihar SIR.

The eight reasons for flagging under "logical discrepancies" could be broadly classified into four categories. One, name mismatches with self or with parent. Two, five reasons based on family size or children. Third, "parents marked ineligible in the last SIR," which only had a miniscule number of 183 names. And a strange fourth, "no reasons mentioned", in which nearly 60,000 electors were flagged. In this category, too, the share of Muslims was disproportionately higher at nearly 20%.

BLOs conduct door-to-door enumeration during the SIR exercise in West Delhi in July. FILE PHOTO

In the first category, though the share of Muslims was higher when compared with their share among electors, the difference was of a lesser magnitude. About 15.5% of all electors flagged for mismatches in names were Muslims, which is 1.9 percentage points higher than their 13.6% share in the draft rolls.

It is in the second category, namely, "progeny >= 6", "parent age difference >50", "grandparent age difference <40", "progeny age gap <9 months", and "parent age difference <15", where the proportion of Muslims among those flagged is much higher. These reasons are also indicators of family size.

Of the 6.75 lakh electors who were flagged for one or more of these reasons, 30% were Muslims, which is more than double their 13.6% share in the draft electoral rolls. Of the 1.4 lakh electors flagged with "Progeny >=6" as reason, the share of Muslims went to 58% – over four times higher than their share among electors.

If one were to look at the rate among Muslims and non-Muslims flagged for one or more of these five reasons, it turns out that Muslims were nearly three times more likely to get flagged. The numbers showed that while 152 out of every 1,000 Muslim electors got flagged for these reasons, the same was only 56 for every 1,000 non-Muslim electors.

These patterns indicate that the reasons could have been designed in a manner that predominantly overlapped with the fact that the fertility rate is higher among Muslims. Yet, these higher rates are observed to be consistently falling, as per recent National Family Health Survey (NFHS) reports.

NFHS reports show that the total fertility rate for Muslim women came down from 4.41 to 2.36 between 1992-93 and 2019-22. The same for Hindu women came down in the same period from 3.3 to 1.94, with the gap between Muslim and Hindu women narrowing.

It is unclear how the software does these age-specific calculations collated for the discrepancies, considering that a large number of older people in India did not precisely remember their birth date owing to home deliveries being more common earlier. Even assuming that all electors accurately mentioned their ages and dates of birth for these calculations to be right, it is unclear if these reasons, per se, disqualified a person from being an elector or if it was the ECI's responsibility to scrutinise these.

Not in the orders

Neither the ECI's order for SIR in Bihar (dated June 24, 2025) nor its subsequent direction to conduct SIR in 12 more States and Union Territories (U.T.s) as part of Phase 2 (dated October 27, 2025) had any mention of issuing notices for "logical discrepancies" to electors who managed to find a place on the draft SIR rolls by submitting duly filled enumeration forms.

ECI's directions for Phase 2 had only mentioned that EROs would issue notices to those added to the draft rolls, but could not be linked with the previous SIR rolls – which many States now report as the "unmapped" list of electors.

The ECI introduced the flagging of "logical discrepancies" first in West Bengal, midway during Phase 2 of the SIR, without any formal announcement.

The issue of notices to electors for "discrepancies" found a mention for the first time only in ECI's direction issued on May 14, 2026 for the ongoing Phase 3 of SIR – in 19 States and U.T.s. Adding an additional clause, it said, "ERO to issue notice to those persons who could not be linked or there is discrepancy in their linking with the electoral roll of the last revision."

Till date, the ECI has not explained the reasons for which an elector on the draft rolls could be flagged for "logical discrepancies".

Moreover, though it directed EROs to issue notices, the decision on who would be flagged was not theirs, but decided by the ERONET software that has come under scrutiny. This was confirmed by a senior election official who did not want to be identified.

A detailed questionnaire was sent to the ECI, seeking responses on what each of these reasons meant, how they were decided, whether any orders were issued in this regard, were any changes made to the reasons between Phase 2 and Phase 3 of SIR and whether the software used any artificial intelligence or deep learning methods. The ECI did not respond till Tuesday night.

(With inputs from Sreeparna Chakraborty)

Over-flagged

Muslims' share among those flagged for 'logical discrepancies' in Delhi's SIR was 20.3%, much higher than their share in the draft rolls, which was 13.6%

Share in %

Headline numbers	How many?	Share of Muslims	Share of non-Muslims
Electors in draft SIR rolls	97,53,577	13.6	86.4
Electors in draft SIR rolls who were issued notices	33,11,746	14.3	85.7
Unmapped with last SIR	13,78,661	7.6	92.4
Logical discrepancies	19,33,085	20.3	79.7

Reason-wise breakdown

Share in %

Reasons used for "logical discrepancies"	Share of Muslims	Share of non-Muslims
Name mismatch	15.5	84.5
Parent name mismatch	18.2	81.8
Self name mismatch	11.8	88.2
Reasons indicative of family size	29.9	70.1
Progeny age gap <9 month	26.7	73.3
Parent age difference <15	16.7	83.4
Progeny >= 6	58.2	41.8
Parent age difference >50	26.0	74.0
Grandparent age difference <40	19.7	80.3
Parent marked ineligible in last SIR	86.3	13.7
No reason mentioned	19.3	80.7

Methodology: *The Hindu* downloaded Delhi's draft SIR rolls for all ACs, used optical character recognition (OCR) to extract text, and made a database. We downloaded the lists of electors who received notices for different reasons and mapped them with the roll database using EPIC IDs. To estimate religion, we used an open-source classifier built by Rochana Chaturvedi and Sugat Chaturvedi (Political Analysis, 2023). The model breaks names into short sequences of characters and learns which patterns go with each religion, so that it can classify names. We ran it on each elector's name combined with their relative's name for better accuracy. The authors trained it on about 1.15 lakh households across 17 States, and in their tests this combined-name version separated Muslims from non-Muslims with an accuracy of about 97%. Our manual check of a random sample of electors also found this to be accurate

Explaining reasons: *Interpretation of the "logical discrepancy" reasons, based on conversations with field-level officials. "Progeny >= 6" — six or more electors named the same person in the 2002 rolls as their parent; "Parent age difference >50" and "Parent age difference <15" — the parent was over 50 or under 15 when the child was born. "Grandparent age difference <40" — elector and their grandparent are less than 40 years apart. "Progeny age gap <9 month" –siblings were born less than nine months apart.* ***Note:*** *A minor share of Muslim and non-Muslim electors flagged for logical discrepancies were marked with more than one reason. The rate and shares are calculated by counting every reason for every flagged elector. Similar trend held even if only the reason mentioned first for every elector is counted*

Injured protesters denied medico-legal case details by police

Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI

A number of protesters injured during the weekend protests and subsequent detentions by the Delhi Police were left with swollen fingers, bruised bodies, and bleeding necks and heads. They said that when the police took them to hospital for treatment, they were denied copies of their medico-legal case (MLC) details and patient summaries.

The denial of medical records to injured protesters can have serious consequences, as seen in the case of those hit by pellet guns in the July 20 protest. *The Hindu* has reported that hospital records had confirmed pellet gun usage, even as the Delhi police denied it.

Hospitals usually make three copies of the MLC, of which two are given to the police, and one is kept in the hospital. The hospital is supposed to share a case summary with the patient, who can also ask the police for a copy of the MLC. However, lawyers say that due to grey areas in the law, a patient has to run from the hospital to the police to get access to their MLCs and case summaries.

A doctor at one of the hospitals which treated protesters said, on the condition of anonymity, "The usual protocol is that an MLC is registered and copies are provided to the police. The patient can ask the police for the MLC [copy]. We usually give the patients a case summary highlighting the injuries." A source at one of the hospitals that denied records to patients said that they are pressured not to share

People carry an injured protester during a march to the Supreme Court on Monday.

any information during protests.

Saurabh, a Jamia Millia Islamia student associated with the All India Students' Association (AISA), alleged that he was beaten up with *lathis*, and dragged by the collar during his detention following his participation at the Dilli Haat protest on October 10.

"Some of us were taken to separate cells and beaten up, our phones were snatched...," he said.

Later that night, he and three others were taken to the Pt. Madan Mohan Malviya Hospital, in the presence of the police. "We asked the doctors to document the injuries and they did. But we were not given copies of the MLCs or any medical summaries...," he said.

Sooraj Elamon, an activist with the Students' Federation of India (SFI), alleged that he was slapped and pushed against the iron bars of the prison vans that he was detained in. "I was taken to the Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital with six other protesters. Initially, the hospital was ready to treat us and give us the papers, but refused to do the same after police involvement," he said.

'Meticulous planning' helped Congress mobilise massive crowd for INDIA bloc march

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

On Saturday, as viral images of protests across Delhi flooded social media, with Jantar Mantar out of bounds and the Delhi Police carrying out mass detentions, Congress workers across the country received an appeal from top leaders, including Rahul Gandhi, to travel to the capital on Monday and to show up for the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance's "March for Democracy".

By Monday afternoon, even before the buses carrying INDIA bloc leaders rolled out of the Constitution Club, Congress flags and their bearers were waiting at intersections along the route expected to be taken by the procession. Many of them, like former Haryana Youth Congress working president Mayank Chaudhary, arrived just in time for the march, dodging police barricades.

The Congress claimed that 2.5 lakh people participated in the march. It took "meticulous planning" and a refreshed party machinery to pull off the feat, party general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said. "We had instructed everyone to arrive in Delhi in their private vehicles and not display flags or banners. Despite all precautions, many workers were detained at the Rajasthan and Haryana borders, while others were picked up by the police from lodges in Delhi at night. We kept the doors of the party offices open for workers to stay and asked every parliamentarian to do the same," he said.

INDIA bloc leaders proceed in a bus during the 'March for Democracy' on Monday.

All Congress MPs were instructed to help workers find accommodation. Many parliamentarians, including Pramod Tiwari, Phulo Devi Netam, Jai Prakash, Karti Chidambaram, Jebi Mather and Dr. Kirsan Namdeo, threw open the doors of their Delhi residences for workers to spend the night.

Over the last year, under the Sangathan Srijan programme, 1,000 new district Congress committee (DCC) presidents have been appointed. Around 130 DCCs within driving distance of Delhi, across Haryana, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, and Himachal Pradesh, mobilised people from their areas for the protest. The Congress organisation, Mr. Venugopal said, has changed drastically. "Within 48 hours, we can mobilise our workers," he added.

Sachin Pilot, the Congress general secretary in charge of Punjab, sees Monday's march as a "turning point" in the narrative of "how India's politics will move forward". "It is no longer just about SIR or seeking Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. It is about the future of the country," Mr. Pilot said.

PCI slams crackdown on journalists

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Journalists from a large number of media organisations gathered at the Press Club of India here on Tuesday condemning the police crackdown on media professionals during the protest by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) during the weekend of October 10 to 11.

Among the journalists who narrated a first-person account on the occasion were reporters from the BBC, Newslaundry, The Quint, *Caravan*, and The Wire. Narrating his experience of getting detained by the Delhi Police, Sarthak of The Quint recounted how he was treated in an aggressive manner by the police.

Press Club of India president Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty said the incidents of attacks showed that the "right to work" is under attack. Sreenivasan Jain described the crackdown on the media as a "very concerning escalation".

WhatsApp polls used for surveillance, say protesters

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

As protests called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) continue, participants have raised concerns over the alleged infiltration of WhatsApp groups by the police, citing suspicious "attendance polls" that they fear could be used to identify potential protesters and track their movements.

Several members of CJP-related WhatsApp groups told *The Hindu* that they received polls asking whether they intended to attend protests, followed by messages directing participants to specific locations where, they alleged, no protesters had assembled, but people were being detained. They feared that their identities and responses were being used to facilitate preventive detentions.

The concerns come days after *The Hindu* reported that Delhi Police personnel were monitoring at least 200 WhatsApp and Telegram groups ahead of the CJP's October 10 protest call.

"We started receiving these polls. One of them asked, 'Up for surgical strike on JM?' I responded yes, but no protest was decided on later and nobody reached the spot," a participant said, requesting anonymity.

Journalist 'detained'

A technology journalist based in Gurugram alleged that the Haryana Police placed him under house detention for 48 hours on October 10, ahead of the planned protest, solely because he was a member of a CJP WhatsApp group.

CJP spokespersons Saurav Das, Ashutosh Ranka and others after being detained for entering Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. PTI

Delhi Police book 14 CJP members after Jantar Mantar entry

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Fourteen members of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), including leaders Saurav Das, Ashutosh Ranka, and Ajinkya Shinde, were detained by the Delhi Police on Tuesday while attempting to enter Jantar Mantar, a day after the police denotified the long-established protest site.

The New Delhi district police registered a first information report (FIR) against the detained individuals on charges including trespassing, unlawful assembly and disobedience of an order promulgated by a public servant, and initiated an investigation, an official close to the development said.

The detentions came amid a widening dispute over access to designated protest venues in the capital, with activists criticising removal of Jantar Mantar as a move that could distance demonstrations from the political establishment and make it harder for citizens to press their demands.

Hours after the detention, CJP member Abhijit Dipke posted a video on X showing party members carrying the national flag near Jantar Mantar. "Cockroaches with the Tiranga sneaked into Jantar Mantar early this morning before they were picked up by Delhi Police," the post said. It added: "You cannot denotify the resistance, Narendra Modi."

A senior Delhi Police officer told *The Hindu* that the protesters had entered the area through eateries and food stalls near the protest site.

"The shops serve as regular eating places for employees working in nearby offices and remain open and accessible to the public, except on days when major protest calls are made, such as October 10," the officer said.

With Jantar Mantar no longer notified as an authorised protest venue, demonstrations there would be illegal, the officer said.

FIRs against march

Separately, the Delhi Police registered at least two FIRs in connection with the INDIA bloc's march through central Delhi on Monday, citing the absence of permission for the demonstration and alleged damage to barricades and public property.

INBRIEF

Don't give nod to Starlink, RSS affiliate urges Centre

Citing the need to curtail Internet services during riots and other law-and-order situations, the Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM), the economic wing of the RSS, on Tuesday urged the Union government to deny Elon Musk-owned Starlink permission to launch commercial satellite broadband services in India. In a statement, SJM national co-convener Ashwani Mahajan said Internet services sometimes need to be suspended and questioned whether Starlink's technology would allow services to be restricted in specific areas at the government's direction. The statement comes amid protests in Delhi over alleged irregularities in SIR exercise.

Sitaram Yechury Foundation invites abstracts for essays

The Sitaram Yechury Foundation (SYF) has invited undergraduate and postgraduate students to submit abstracts for essays on "Imperialism in the Present Age", not exceeding 600 words. The Foundation is a registered not-for-profit trust set up in memory of the late CPI(M) general secretary. It aims at engaging youth in spreading progressive ideas through academic and public programmes. Entries must be emailed to syfessays@gmail.com by Monday, October 26. Eight entries will be shortlisted, following which their authors will be asked to write 3,000-word essays. All eight authors will be invited to present their essays at a day-long programme in Kolkata on November 22.

China says 'never recognised' U.T. of Ladakh; India hits back

Beijing opposes Survey of India move to standardise names of specific features in Ladakh, calls it 'illegal and void'; New Delhi says 'no amount of denial by Chinese side' can change established fact

Suhasini Haidar
Ananth Krishnan
NEW DELHI/BEIJING

India and China on Tuesday sparred over New Delhi's decision to standardise the names of 28 features in Ladakh, including some along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) that had seen skirmishes between the Indian Army and the People's Liberation Army during a four-year stand-off.

The Chinese Foreign Ministry on Tuesday said it has "never recognised" the Union Territory (U.T.) of Ladakh, which was created in 2019, and called the naming of the areas by the Survey of India as "illegal and void", a charge that New Delhi rejected.

"The U.T. of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India. No amount of denial by the Chinese side can change this established fact," said External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal. "Identifying these [28] places formally on the Survey of India map of the U.T. of Ladakh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," he explained.

> The U.T. of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India. No amount of denial by the Chinese side can change this established fact
>
> **RANDHIR JAISWAL**
> Spokesperson, External Affairs Ministry

> This move by India is illegal and void, and does not change the fact that the western sector of the China-India boundary belongs to China
>
> **MAO NING**
> Spokesperson, Chinese Foreign Ministry

The spokesperson was responding to comments made by the Chinese Foreign Ministry earlier in the day. To a question at the Chinese Foreign Ministry briefing, spokesperson Mao Ning said that China has "never recognised the so-called 'Union Territory of Ladakh' unilaterally and illegally established by India, and firmly opposes the so-called 'standardised names' publicised by India."

"This move by India is illegal and void, and does not change the fact that the western sector of the China-India boundary belongs to China," she added, referring to the August 5, 2019 decision by the Indian government to bifurcate the State of Jammu and Kashmir into two Union Territories and dilute Article 370 of the Constitution.

At the time, Beijing had issued a sharp statement accusing India of undermining "China's territorial sovereignty by unilaterally changing its domestic law." Beijing had also made such a claim in September 2020 reacting strongly to an Indian project to construct high-altitude roads in eastern Ladakh

A first in two years

This is the first such spat in the past two years, however, since the two sides re-established diplomatic and travel links between the two countries in an effort to normalise relations after the meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping in 2024, indicating that the map remains a major point of contention.

The comments came 10 days after the Survey of India announced the standardisation of the names of specific relief features in Ladakh, including 11 peaks, five mountains, six land areas, two glaciers, two passes, one valley, one river, one lake, and one other waterbody.

Both features abut Patrolling Point 15 (PP-15), which had seen heavy mobilisation during the India-China tensions at the LAC after the deadly clashes at Galwan in June 2020. The two armies agreed to stand down from the PP-15 point in September 2022, as part of a series of disengagement negotiations.

Both India and China have been reinforcing their territorial claims in both the Western and Eastern sectors by naming features in official maps and creating administrative jurisdictions in a series of cartographic tit-for-tat measures going back many years.

Murugan's exit from Ministry intensifies Cabinet rejig buzz

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

L. Murugan

Union Minister of State for Parliamentary Affairs L. Murugan resigned from the Council of Ministers and his Rajya Sabha seat on Tuesday, setting off speculation about a Cabinet reshuffle in the near future.

Mr. Murugan hails from Tamil Nadu, but represented Madhya Pradesh in the Upper House. His term as an MP was not set to end till 2030. The BJP's strength in M.P. ensures that his vacated seat will be won by a party MP, paving the way for a new inclusion into the Council of Ministers.

Slew of vacancies

Two other Union Ministers of State, George Kurian and Ravneet Singh Bittu, had already tendered their resignations at the end of their respective terms in the Upper House earlier this year. The Rajya Sabha terms of Union Ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and B.L. Verma are also set to end next month, even as the BJP got eight new faces into the Upper House from Uttar Pradesh, along with one each from West Bengal and Uttarakhand. Also, over the summer, Dharmendra Pradhan was forced to resign as Education Minister, and that post is now being held as an additional charge by Consumer Affairs Minister Pralhad Joshi.

There are also rumours that two more Ministers of State, Pankaj Chaudhary and Harsh Malhotra, may put in their papers after being appointed the chiefs of the BJP's Uttar Pradesh and Delhi units respectively, but BJP sources said that "nothing has been finalised yet".

Thus, there are at least half a dozen Ministerial berths lying vacant. BJP sources said that a Cabinet reshuffle may take place before Deepavali. This would be the first reshuffle of the Union Cabinet since Narendra Modi was sworn in as Prime Minister for his third successive term, along with 71 Ministers.

BIMSTEC adopts 'Delhi Declaration' on terrorism

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Diplomatic mission: Amit Shah with other delegates during the first meeting of Home Ministers of the BIMSTEC countries. PTI

India hosted the first-ever meeting of the Home Ministers of the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) countries on Tuesday, where the regional bloc adopted a declaration to counter radicalisation, violent extremism conducive to terrorism, prevent the misuse of new and emerging technologies for terrorist purposes, and tackle terrorist recruitment.

Bangladesh, the chair of BIMSTEC, was represented by Manzur Morshed Chowdhury, Senior Secretary in its Home Ministry, instead of Home Minister Salahuddin Ahmed, a key member in Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's Cabinet.

The "Delhi Declaration" signed by Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand, also called for curbing terror financing through adherence to internationally agreed counter-terror financing and anti-money laundering standards, consistent with domestic and international laws.

The declaration said the member states "strongly condemn terrorism and violent extremism in all its forms and manifestations, including cross-border terrorism, wherever, by whomsoever and for whatever purposes committed; reiterate our determination to prevent, combat and eliminate terrorism and violent extremism conducive to terrorism in a comprehensive and sustained manner, in accordance with the UN Charter and international law; and in this context, call for effective implementation of the sanctions measures of the UN Security Council, including of the 1267 Sanctions Committee".

The grouping expressed condolences and solidarity with victims of terrorist attacks in member states and their families, as well as the governments of the affected states. It called for those responsible to be brought to justice in accordance with applicable domestic and international law and relevant UN Security Council resolutions.

Areas of cooperation

Union Home Minister Amit Shah highlighted five key areas of cooperation: drug control, counter-terrorism and legal cooperation, repatriation of fugitive criminals, cybersecurity and cybercrime investigations, and institutional cooperation and capacity building. He called for a coordinated regional approach to combating illicit financial transactions and terror financing and stressed the need to strengthen cooperation among law enforcement, intelligence, and border management agencies.

"India has always believed in sovereignty and peaceful resolutions to any dispute. We are committed to cooperating to face challenges emanating from International terrorism, organised crime and narco-trade," Mr. Shah said.

He said criminal networks run their operations beyond international borders and take advantage of regional lacunae.

"This is why regional cooperation is a must. Their strategy is changing; they are using encrypted communication, social media, drones, cryptocurrency and the dark web to recruit and propagate illegal activities. This is why real-time intelligence-sharing and cooperation is required to check these crimes. None of the member countries should shelter such criminals. We should cooperate in the extradition of such criminals," he added.

Mr. Shah flagged "human trafficking and cyber slavery" as grave concerns". "Sharing of actionable intelligence should be a priority among BIMSTEC countries," he said.

UPI fee rollout put off beyond Deepavali on traders' appeal

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has postponed the implementation of the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, originally scheduled for Thursday, to a date "immediately after Deepavali", without specifying an exact date.

The MDR was to be levied at 0.4% on UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000 at medium and large merchant establishments. Transactions related to the capital market and those done in strategic sectors will face different MDR rates. According to government sources, the decision to delay the implementation of MDR on UPI was made in the Prime Minister's Office following strong appeals from traders.

The Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT) described the decision to delay the rollout as "timely and pragmatic", particularly during the festive and wedding season, when millions of traders and MSMEs depend on higher business volumes.

Praveen Khandelwal, founder and secretary-general of CAIT and a Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MP, welcomed the decision to postpone the MDR rollout, saying that it would protect traders' interests and sustain digital payment momentum during the festive season.

"The UPI and Services Steering Committee today decided that, keeping in mind the festive season, Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on select Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions shall be implemented immediately post Deepavali at a date to be notified separately," the NPCI said in a statement on Tuesday. The Supreme Court has directed the NPCI, the Union government, and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to file affidavits by late October explaining the rationale for imposing MDR on specified UPI transactions.

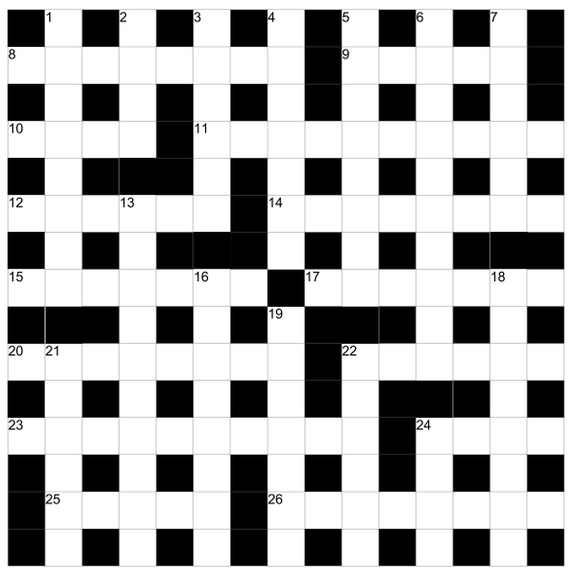
CAIT said the decision followed a meeting on September 30, when a delegation of around 20 trade leaders led by Mr. Khandelwal met Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and "highlighted the implications of the proposed 0.40% MDR on UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000". "Additional transaction costs [during the festive season] could have placed an avoidable burden on merchants operating on thin margins and discouraged the wider acceptance of digital payments," it said.

TH CROSSWORD + 14923

(set by Gridzilla)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



ACROSS

8. Bored by country song in party? (8)
9. Way, reportedly, to get to big house (5)
10. European has half Polish name (4)
11. What's seen in hands of orthodontists, etc? (3,2,5)
12. Overwhelmed by arthritis sometimes? Yes! (2,2,2)
14. The University dean's building is cool (8)
15. Heartbroken chaps continue to sigh? (7)
17. Hip and leg operation basically pending (2,5)
20. Wretched fellow's killing time inside (8)
22. Play fine puzzle right away (6)
23. Ones you can bank on, to get serious? (2,8)
24. OK to pester for repayment of a loan, we hear (4)
25. One of the best violinists ever from Russia, enthralled millions, for starters (5)
26. Even lower? (8)

DOWN

1. Support staff for flights? (8)
2. Either way, it's lunch time (4)
3. Up in Saratoga, I sampled some cheese (6)
4. Lids came off easily? (4,3)
5. Even in those days, dogs primarily scavenged meals on occasion (8)
6. Ordinary and OK? Fine and fantastic? Or exceptional? (3,2,1,4)
7. Jerk starts to expose his tummy in restaurant, when getting a tip (6)
13. Spooner's hound got a ride (10)
16. Fine day to board carriage back from office (8)
18. Cat is able to jump around corner (8)
19. Full day, one dude's getting fleeced in city (4-3)
21. What's set up quickly, at the conclusions of some trials? (6)
22. Strong fellow gets hurt unloading piano (6)
24. Flower placed on top of policeman's grave (4)

SUDOKU

5			6					
	4				1		8	
6	8			3	9	7		
2					6			
3	5		2		8		6	4
			5					8
		9	3	6			1	5
	3		9				2	
					7			6

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

No.SS7031 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle

D	V	S	S	A	I	C		
D	E	T	E	N	T	I	O	N
C	E	N	T	R	E			
P	N	R	F	H	T	I		
F	A	C	I	L	I	T	A	T
E	A	C	M	E				
R	C	N	N	G	I			
S	T	R	E	N	G	T	H	
I	N	L	A	N	D			
M	E	A	I	A				
E	L	E	C	T	O	R	A	L
R	O	L	L					
N	M	E	O	I				
U	T	O	P	I	A	N	E	P
O	T	I	S	M				
S	Y	C	O	H	A			
S	T	I	R	A	N	N	U	N
C	I	A	T	E				
O	E	D	A	D	R	I		
G	R	E	A	T	D	E	P	R
E	S	S	I	O	N			
E	N	Y	E	R	T	N		

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	6	1	8	9	5	7	3	2
2	7	9	1	3	6	4	8	5
3	8	5	2	7	4	9	6	1
1	4	7	5	6	2	8	9	3
5	9	3	4	8	7	2	1	6
8	2	6	3	1	9	5	7	4
6	3	2	9	4	8	1	5	7
9	1	4	7	5	3	6	2	8
7	5	8	6	2	1	3	4	9

FAITH

Efficacy of Purattasi

Discipline is key to every aspect of life, be it work, health, accumulating and managing wealth, in raising a family etc. It is of utmost importance in one's devotional quest. In human life one will chase material wealth but will never forget that he has to discipline his mind and grow spiritually as well. This is evident from the austerities followed by a devotee in Purattasi, the Tamil month which is also very dear to Venkatachalapthy (Srinivasan, Balaji, Ezhumalaiyan), who beckons devotees to His abode in Tirupati in order to shower His blessings upon them, said Damal S. Ramakrishnan. Lakhs of devotees undertake yatra to Tirumala during this holy month, chanting the Govinda namam, seeking His darshan, divine gaze, and everlasting compassion that makes Him accept the surrender of devotees. It is the time when devotees get closer to divinity.

Saturdays falling in this month are considered efficacious for visiting various temples and gaining the darshan of Vishnu's numerous archa avatars. Devotees voluntarily opt for a sattvic diet, shun ostentatious events, observe fasts as a way of disciplining the senses, attend discourses and offer annadhanam (free offering of food preparations).

Preparing the *mavilakku*, an edible 'mountain' prepared with flour, jaggery and cardamom, is another feature undertaken in many homes on any one of the Saturdays during the month of Purattasi. The centre of the mound is filled with ghee and a cotton wick is inserted and lit. Many of the devout see the image of Srinivasa when the wick is lit and seek His blessings from their respective homes.

INBRIEF

Hyundai Motor to invest $15.5 bn in India by 2032

Hyundai Motor Group said it will invest $15.5 billion in India between 2026 and 2032, expanding manufacturing capacity, research and development (R&D) infrastructure and localisation of components as it seeks to strengthen the country's position as a global automotive hub. The investment plan was discussed at a meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Hyundai Motor Group Executive Chair Euisun Chung at the PMO in New Delhi on Tuesday. The seven-year investment will span manufacturing expansion, future technology development, local supplier partnerships and infrastructure development, the South Korean automotive major said in a statement. The Group plans to expand production capacity across Hyundai Motor India Ltd. (HMIL) and Kia India Pvt Ltd. to cater to rising demand and improve localisation.

Vantrock unveils warehousing, industrial, logistics parks plan

Vantrock Real Assets Private Ltd. (VRAPL), an operator-led real assets platform, plans to develop 11.5 million sq. ft of warehousing, industrial and logistics parks, with a gross development value (GDV) of ₹4,200 crore upon completion. The first phase, spanning 3 million sq. ft. and valued at ₹1,100 crore, will be spread across NCR, Bengaluru and Pune. Construction is scheduled to begin in 2027, with rental income expected to commence in 2028. Land for these projects is at advanced stages of negotiation, documentation and regulatory approvals, the company said. The remaining 8.5 million sq. ft will be acquired across the same markets and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR). These assets will be operationalised in phases over the next 12-18 months, it added. The company also plans to upgrade existing warehousing facilities to improve safety and operational standards. In subsequent phases, Vantrock plans to expand into global capability centres, suburban office campuses, data centres and infrastructure assets.

Adani defers Mumbai to Navi Mumbai plan

The Group's proposed shifting of 30% of international flight slots has been deferred to the summer schedule that begins on March 28, 2027

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The move follows a stand-off over the 'forceful' transfer of 30% of Mumbai's international airport slots to Navi Mumbai. REUTERS

The Adani Group has put on hold its plan to shift 30% of international flight slots at Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport to Navi Mumbai International Airport, with no transfers planned for the upcoming winter schedule.

The proposed shift has been deferred to the summer schedule, which begins on March 28, 2027.

The move was the outcome of a consultative meeting between Adani Group and airlines on Tuesday, after the Centre was forced to intervene in the stand-off. "They have assured the airline community of minimisation of disruption and have assured them of fully respecting historical slots allocations. They have further given a commitment not to disturb any slots for the winter schedule," Adani Airports Holding Ltd. said in a press statement about the message from its Director Jeet Adani and CEO Arun Bansal to the airlines in Tuesday's meeting.

The group said it had secured commitments from international airlines to support the plan for the summer schedule.

The move follows a standoff between the Adani Group and international airlines over what carriers described as a "forceful" transfer of 30% of Mumbai's international airport slots to the Navi Mumbai airport. The International Air Transport Association (IATA), which represents global airlines, had called for a consultative approach and alternatives to cutting existing slots, and sufficient time for making the transition, warning that the move could affect international connectivity to and from Mumbai.

Mumbai International Airport Limited (MIAL) had recently proposed that approximately one-third of each carrier's passenger and cargo air traffic movements be transferred from Mumbai to Navi Mumbai from October 1, 2026.

This was to ostensibly cater for redevelopment of Terminal 1 at Mumbai, from where some domestic flights would be shifted to its Terminal 2 (T2), and international flights from T2 be shifted to Navi Mumba airporti.

'Will keenly hear views on LTCG, STT'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Nirmala Sitharaman

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday said that she would listen to all views regarding the long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax and the securities transaction tax (STT). However, she refrained from stating whether the matter would be considered during the ongoing discussions in the preparations of Budget 2027.

Just the indication that she would listen to views on the taxation matter led to the stock market jumping 1% soon after she said it. The Finance Minister also said that the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) would continue to take action to prevent volatility in the rupee exchange rate.

"The long-term capital gains tax is something on which a lot of people have been commenting, both the investors within India and also those who meet me occasionally outside in India," Ms. Sitharaman said at an event in Delhi.

She added that several ministers had also raised the issue of the STT, saying that it was running parallel with the LTCG and that India should impose one or the other.

"So, it's healthy to have this debate and I will be keenly hearing them," Ms. Sitharaman said.

However, the Minister also said that since the Budget 2027 preparations have started, she would not comment on whether the issue would be discussed during the pre-budget meetings or not.

"The rupee has reached a low, and the RBI is making a lot of efforts through their regulatory powers to make sure that the rupee stays stable," Ms. Sitharaman said. "They are not trying to fix the rupee, they are trying to stop the volatility." "These efforts from the RBI, I understand, will continue," she added.

"I'm sure there are efforts which the RBI would take further to make sure that rupee doesn't become too volatile."

India does not grow at anybody's expense: PM

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

India does not grow at anybody's expense, instead, it grows with the world and for the world, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said at an event here on Tuesday, underlining India as a steady and trusted pillar for the globe.

"Whenever the world requires a steady pillar, India comprehends its responsibility and extends a hand in support," he said.

The Prime Minister also said that reforms being undertaken in India were not driven by compulsion but conviction.

The PM mentioned that India offered stability and could be relied upon in an uncertain world.

He pointed to the country having clocked a growth rate of 7.8% in the first quarter of the ongoing financial year, emphasising that it rested on strong foundations. Mr. Modi also pointed to India's current account deficit standing at 0.61%, foreign exchange reserves being above $700 billion alongside a strong and resilient banking sector, among other things.

OPEC cuts India's 2026 oil demand growth forecast to 40,000 bpd

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Organisation of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) has lowered its forecast for India's oil demand growth in 2026 to 40,000 barrels per day (bpd), from 60,000 bpd projected in its September report. On a year-on-year (YoY) basis, India's oil demand is expected to rise by around 40,000 b/d to 5.7 million barrels per day (mbpd) in 2026, according to OPEC's latest monthly oil market report.

OPEC has also trimmed its global oil demand growth forecast for 2026 to

Transportation fuels, particularly gasoline and diesel, are expected to remain the primary drivers

0.2 mbpd, down from 0.4 mbpd estimated in its previous assessment. However, it has raised its projection for global oil demand growth in 2027 to 2.6 mb/d, from 2.4 mb/d forecast last month.

Its outlook for India's oil demand growth in 2027 remains unchanged.

Transportation fuels, particularly gasoline and diesel, are expected to remain the primary drivers of India's oil demand growth in 2026.

"Gasoline is expected to be supported by heightened road mobility amid robust vehicle sales. Diesel demand is anticipated to gain additional support from strong manufacturing and agricultural activity," OPEC said.

The report also projects an increase in demand for residual fuel during the year, while jet fuel consumption is expected to register marginal growth.

In contrast, demand for liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) and naphtha is expected to ease, OPEC said.

KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (COMMERCIAL & TARIFF), VYDYUTHI BHAVANAM, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM
Inviting Medium term Power procurement of 500 MW for the period from **01.06.2027 to 31.05.2032** during **18.00 to 24.00 hours** (peak hours) on lumpsum tariff basis, through e-bidding portal (DEEP) only.
DEEP Portal e-Tender No. KSEBL/Medium/Lumpsum Tariff/26-27/ET/95 and **e-reverse auction No. KSEBL/Medium/Lumpsum Tariff /26-27/RA/81** Dated **12.10.2026.** Last Date and time of submission of Application and Bid - (Bid Due Date) - **20.01.2027, 01.30 pm.**
For more details visit **www.kseb.in** Ref : **PR/MC1/F404/2026**

AHMEDABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
MAHANAGAR SEVA SADAN
STREETLIGHT/TRAFFIC SIGNAL DEPARTMENT
TENDER NOTICE
Tender for Comprehensive Operation and Maintenance contract of Street Light Poles and Implementation of Centralized Smart City Management System for Streetlights of Ahmedabad city for Five Years.

Pre-bid Meeting	Date : 26/10/2026 Time:- 11:00 Hrs.
Last date of Tender Submission (Online)	Date : 03/11/2026 up to 18:00 Hrs.
Last date of Tender Submission (Hard Copy)	Date : 04/11/2026 up to 14:00 Hrs.
Detail and Tenders available on	**www.nprocure.com** OR **www.tender.nprocure.com**

IndianOil
CIN : L23201MH1959GOI11388
NOTICE FOR HIRING OF CONTRACTOR FOR CGD PROJECT
OPPORTUNITY FOR ANY INTERESTED INDIVIDUAL / PARTY / LOCAL VENDORS / PETTY CONTRACTORS POSSESSING TEAMS OF PLUMBERS & HELPERS
Indian Oil Corporation Limited (a Maharatna Company under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas) is seeking applications from prospective bidders for various jobs related to Last Mile Connectivity (LMC), Direct Marketing Agency (DMA) and laying of PE Pipeline Network and associated works for PNG connections in the Coimbatore Geographical area in the state of Tamil Nadu.
VENDOR DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME:
Eligibility and Selection Method: To engage contractors through the Vendor Development Programme (Any Interested Individual / Party / Local Vendors / Petty Contractors Possessing Teams of Plumbers & Helpers (Minimum of 02 teams, each comprising 1 Plumber/Jointer and 1 Helper) through training and trial orders). Work orders will be issued on a first-come-first-serve basis, subject to fulfillment of requirements and at the sole discretion of IOCL.
BID SUBMISSION DETAILS:
Mode of Submission: Physical Mode Only. Bids shall be submitted only at the Coimbatore GA Office (address below):
Indian Oil Corporation Limited,
Coimbatore City Gas Distribution Office, No. 965, 2nd Floor, Haritha Center, Lakshmi Mills, Avinashi Road, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu-641037
Date: Starting Wednesday, 14 October 2026 | **Time:** 09:00 AM to 05:30 PM
Cut-off date: 28th October 2026
The Detailed Tender Document mentioning method of selection, selection criteria, Scope of work and other terms and conditions are available on IOCL website **(https://iocl.com/suppliers-notices)** and CPP Portal **(https://eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app)**.
Important Notice: IOCL reserves the right to discontinue the process at any point of time without assigning any reasons. Further, IOCL has the sole discretion to qualify or accept/reject the applications for award of job without assigning any reason whatsoever. Any corrigendum, amendments, or detailed terms & conditions shall be published only on the official IOCL website **(https://iocl.com/suppliers-notices)** and CPP Portal **(https://eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app)** and will not be published in newspapers.
Contact for any further Information:
Phone: 9894564800,8565835550 | **Email:** ajithkd@indianoil.in

राजस्थान सरकार
कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग खण्ड तिजारा (खैरथल-तिजारा)
Email: eepwdtijara@rajasthan.gov.in & eepwdtijara@rediffmail.com
क्रमांक- 771 दिनांक 30.09.2026
Short term NIT No 12/2026-27
Bids for Construction of Various Missing Link/ Non-Patchable roads Under PWD Dn-Tijara & Tentage and Safe House work for VIP/ VVIP Visits in PWD Division Tijara (Rate Contract) are invited from interested bidder from 05.10.2026 02:00 Pm up to 27.10.2026 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may on the procurement portal (http:/eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http:/sppp.raj.nic.in) of the state. The approximate value of the procurement is **Rs. 1102.38** Lacs.
NIB No:. PWD2627A3212
1. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14541, 2. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14542
3. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14543, 4. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14544
5. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14545
Executive Engineer
PWD Div TIJARA
DIPR/C/17475/26

BHARAT DYNAMICS LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
MINISTRY OF DEFENCE
GACHIBOWLI, HYDERABAD-500 032.
Ref: BDL/CC/OT/GT/03/2026-27 Dt: 14.10.2026
e-PROCUREMENT ABRIDGED TENDER NOTICE
Inviting Indigenous Competitive Bidding

Sl. No.	Tender ID	Description	Estimate in Rs
1.	67119	Construction of collapsed Traverse wall at BDL Bhanur	245.0 Lakhs
2.	67120	Repair and Relaying of internal Roads in Plant and Township at Bhanur	557.05 Lakhs

Please visit website **https://bdltenders.abcprocure.com**, select ONLINE tenders on dashboard for further details. Bids should be submitted online only. **"corrigendum if any shall be issued through our e-portal only and not in Newspapers"**
*Bidders are Requested to apply for online Vendor Registration in BDL website **https://bdl-india.in/registration-contractors** prospects.
DEPUTY GENERAL MANAGER (Corp Comml)

Government of Rajasthan
(Department of Information Technology & Communication) IT Building, Yojana Bhawan Campus, Tilak Marg, C-Scheme, Jaipur-302005
Vacancy Notice
In continuation to the Vacancy Notice issued vide No. **F5.502 (1442)/ DoIT&C/2025-13096- 8832250/DoIT/BSDC-299 dated 31.12.2025,** applications are invited from willing and eligible candidates for filling up the following posts in the Rajasthan State Computer Security Incident Response Team (R-CSIRT), Jaipur, Rajasthan:

S.N.	Name of the Post	Pay Matrix Level	No. of Vacancy
1	Director	L-24	1
2	Technical Lead - Incident Response (IR)	L-20	1

The last date for submission of applications through email will be 50 days from the date of publication of this advertisement.
Candidates who have already submitted their applications in response to the earlier Vacancy Notice dated 31.12.2025 need not apply again. Their applications shall be considered as per the prescribed eligibility criteria and other terms and conditions of the Vacancy Notice.
For further and complete details, please visit our websites:
https://doitc.rajasthan.gov.in/, https://risl.rajasthan.gov.in/
DIPR/C/17552/2026 TD & JS

WATCO
OFFICE OF THE MANAGING DIRECTOR, WATCO
Ground Floor, Unnati Bhawan,
H.B.Colony, Satyanagar, Bhubaneswar-751007, Odisha, India
Telefax: - +91-674-2571444; E-mail – mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com .
INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) - Bid Identification No. WATCO(W)-20/2026-27, Dtd.12.10.2026
WATCO No. 11547 / Date: 12.10.2026
- **Name of the work :-**
1. Laying of the 150 mm & 100 mm dia. pipe line for Improvement of Water Supply to the Ward No-1 to 10 at newly developed areas under WATCO Section-II, Baripada under WATCO Division Baripada in Mayurbhanj District.
2. Laying of the 150 mm & 100 mm dia. pipe line for Improvement of Water Supply to the ward No-.21 of Kusta Ashram, Grandgoli, LIC colony, Ward No 22 Raghunathpur area, Ward no.19, Badheisahi area under WATCO Section-III, Baripada under WATCO Division Baripada in Mayurbhanj District.
3. Laying of the 150 mm & 100 mm dia. pipe line for Improvement of Water Supply to the ward No-12, 27,28 & 24 of area Bagdiha, Convent School front, Takatpur under WATCO Section-I, Baripada under WATCO Division Baripada in Mayurbhanj District.

- **Estimated Cost** : Rs.141.14 Lakhs to Rs.284.76 Lakhs
- **Period of completion** : 06 (Six) Months
- **Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal.** : From 5.00 PM of Dt. 16.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of Dt. 02.11.2026
- **Last date / time of receipt of bids in the portal** : 5.00 PM of Dt. 02.11.2026
- **Date & Time of opening of technical bids** : 12.30 PM of Dt. 04.11.2026
- **Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid** : MD, WATCO, Telefax:- 0674-2571444. E-Mail : mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com
- **The bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only.**

Further details can be seen from the web site **www.tendersodisha.gov.in** .
(Managing Director), WATCO
13001/2157/2627 OIPR-13001/13263/1/26-27/0020

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600,),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616
No.KMSCL/ED/30/2026 Date : 12.10.2026
E- TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited from manufacturers/direct importers / loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of Drugs/ Consumable for Thalassemia Management for the year 2026 - 2027.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. Drugs
1.	KMSCL/ED/THALASSEMIA /RC/2026/026 dtd. 13/10/2026	06

Last date and time of online uploading of tender - 26.10.2026, 10.00 am.
Date and time of opening of Technical bid - 28.10.2026 11.00 am.
Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.**
(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

THE TAMIL NADU CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' FEDERATION LIMITED,
AAVIN ILLAM, No.3A, PASUMPON MUTHURAMALINGANAR SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI-600 035.
TELEPHONE: 044-23464500, FAX :044-23464505, E-MAIL: aavinidms@gmail.com
Ref. No: 6957/IDMS/2026 **NOTICE INVITING TENDER (e-Submission Only)** Date : 14.10.2026
The TCMPF Ltd., invites **TWO PART TENDERS** by way of **e-Submission through the e-Procurement Portal** from the reputed entities/ Vendors for the following items/works for TCMPF:-

Sl. No.	Name of the works / Items	EMD Value	
1	Selection of a System Integrator (SI) to operate and maintain the Integrated Dairy Management System (IDMS) Project for three years at various locations	Rs. 6,99,000/-	The Technical Bids shall be opened through the online e-Procurement Portal **(https://tntenders.gov.in)** on the mentioned date at the above-mentioned address. The bidders should submit their bids only through the e-Procurement Portal **(https://tntenders.gov.in).** All other details can be seen in the tender documents, the tender documents can be downloaded at the above website. Corrigendum / Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above-said website.

Tender Documents Availability	E-Submission End Date	Technical Bid Opening Date
14.10.2026 to 18.11.2026 upto 02.00 PM	18.11.2026 Time 2.30 PM	19.11.2026 Time : 3.00 PM

DIPR/ 3099 /TENDER/2026
General Manager (Admin),
The Tamil Nadu Co-operative Milk Producers' Federation Limited.

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/57 Corrigendum-I -2026-27
Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

Tender No. & Description of Material	Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs) / Tender Fee (in Rs.)	Extended Due Date & Time (Hrs.) Submission & Opening of Tender
SP/T-0514/1026 [RFx 5000001621] 2nd Call for Procurement of 50MVA, 132-110/33kV (07 No.) Power Transformers along with New Uninhibited High Grade Mineral Insulating Oil for Karad Zone	6299.71 / 25,000.00	19.10.2026 Upto 17:00 Hrs / 19.10.2026 Upto 17:15 Hrs
CORRIGENDUM NO.1 Dt.09.10.2026	Corrigendum due to change in Quantity in the Tender published on SRM Portal viz. **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/** and MSETCL website viz. **www.mahatransco.in.**	

Contact Person: Office of the Executive Engineer (Gr-V)
CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai
Tel. No.: 022-69852712/ 69852720 **Email id:** cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp5@mahatransco.in, eepc@mahatransco.in,
For further details visit our website **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/**
Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website **www.mahatransco.in** & **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/.** Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.
Sd/-
Executive Engineer (P&C)

PARIS

French unions say 480,000 people took part in pro-student protests

REUTERS

French unions said that around 480,000 people took part in nationwide demonstrations held on Tuesday to back student protests. French authorities have not yet given their own estimate. The last nationwide rallies supporting the student movement, held on Thursday last week, saw 71,500 people turn out. AFP

JERUSALEM

Palestinians displaced from refugee camp will not return: Netanyahu

AP

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu vowed on Tuesday that displaced residents of a Palestinian refugee camp would not be allowed to return to their homes, after the supreme court ordered the government to provide a timetable for their return. He also referred to the Tulkarm refugee camp as a "terror stronghold". AFP

LAHORE

Six killed, 40 injured as passenger train derails in Pakistan's Punjab

AFP

A Peshawar-bound passenger train derailed in Pakistan's Punjab province on Tuesday, killing at least six people and injuring 40 others, police said. The accident occurred at around 5.15 a.m. when the Rehman Baba Express was travelling from Karachi to Peshawar, according to police information. PTI

BEIRUT

Hezbollah announces aid for those displaced in Lebanon due to war

AFP

Hezbollah announced on Tuesday an aid programme for Lebanese who lost their homes in the war with Israel, with benefits capped at $14,000 per household, despite U.S. and Lebanese sanctions on the militant group. It will pay the assistance in four instalments over the course of a year, the head of Hezbollah's Executive Council said. AFP

Saudi Arabia strikes oil facility in Yemen's capital, say Houthis

The group threatens to target Riyadh International Airport, a refinery, and an Aramco facility in Dammam if Saudi Arabia proceeds with the strike; Trump accuses Houthis of trying to drive up the oil prices ahead of the U.S. midterm elections

Agence France-Presse
SANAA

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) said Saudi Arabia struck an oil facility in Sanaa on Tuesday, after the Riyadh-led coalition told civilians to leave the surrounding area in its first evacuation order for the Yemeni capital since the war flared up again.

After a series of strikes on the kingdom's airports and energy sites, the coalition's spokesperson said people should leave an oil facility belonging to the Yemen Petroleum Company on the western outskirts of Sanaa before it was attacked.

The Saudi-led coalition's warning was its first evacuation order for Yemen's capital, Sanaa, since the war escalated again. AFP

An *AFP* correspondent in Sanaa reported hearing an explosion, while a breaking news alert on the Houthi-affiliated *Al-Masirah TV* channel said "Saudi aggression targets the oil company in Al-Sabaha, west of Sanaa".

The Saudi-led coalition is yet to confirm the reported strike.

Swiftly responding to the earlier coalition warning, the Houthis had issued a threat to target Riyadh's international airport, a refinery, and an Aramco facility in Dammam if the strike went ahead.

"The Yemeni Armed Forces urge all citizens to immediately evacuate and move away from targets that our forces will strike should the Saudi enemy target," military spokesperson Yahya Saree wrote on X, identifying the three targets.

Saudi Arabia was still weathering fresh attacks on Tuesday, with the coalition saying its forces intercepted three drones north of the kingdom's capital Riyadh.

Many countries have issued travel warnings to their citizens in Saudi Arabia, most recently France, which told its citizens to avoid the airports in Riyadh, Jeddah and Dammam on Tuesday.

Meanwhile, U.S. President Donald Trump on Tuesday accused Houthi militants of deliberately trying to drive up oil prices ahead of the midterm elections and warned that he would "never forget" their attacks on Saudi Arabia.

"The Houthis are behaving very badly," Mr. Trump wrote in a Truth Social post, accusing the group of resuming attacks at Iran's behest after a period of relative quiet following U.S. strikes in Yemen last year.

Iran trying to hit military sites in U.K., says intel chief

Associated Press
LONDON

Iran is trying to hit military sites in Britain and the suspected plot to attack a U.S.-run military airbase in September is "not unique", the head of the MI5 spy agency said on Tuesday, as he warned that both Tehran and Moscow are expanding their attacks against the United Kingdom.

Ken McCallum speaks at Thames House, the headquarters of the U.K.'s Security Service in London on Tuesday. REUTERS

Ken McCallum, who leads the U.K.'s domestic security service, said Tehran is seeking to intensify its attacks in Britain beyond the traditional targets of Iranians opposed to the country's Islamic authorities. That has included arson and sabotage attacks on Jewish sites that Britain says were carried out by Iranian proxies.

Mr. McCallum said another "major shift this year has been Iranian ambitions to come at harder targets, like military sites".

The incident at RAF Fairford "is not unique. There have been other examples, not just in the U.K. but around the world," Mr. McCallum said.

He delivered his annual speech outlining major threats to the U.K. as counterterror detectives investigate a suspected terror plot against the U.S.-run base in western England, which has been used to bomb Iran during this year's war.

Prime Minister Andy Burnham said on Monday that the apparent plot was "almost certainly" directed by Iran's Revolutionary Guard though Iran has denied involvement.

11 sailors go missing after drone sinks ship off Bulgaria's coast

Reuters
SOFIA

Eleven sailors were missing at sea on Tuesday from a ship sunk by a drone attack off the coast of Bulgaria, the second deadly sinking of a cargo vessel in the area in a week, prompting Bulgaria to summon Russia's Ambassador.

Two cargo ships were hit by drones overnight and one was sunk, Bulgarian officials said. Bulgaria stopped short of explicitly accusing Russia of carrying out the attacks but Prime Minister Rumen Radev said their outcome "benefits Russian Federation".

"This is absolutely unacceptable – another attack in the immediate vicinity of Bulgarian territorial waters," Mr. Radev said.

Bulgarian Defence Minister Dimitar Stoyanov said it would be "illogical for the Ukrainians to strike their own ships".

The attacks were also condemned by Ukraine and the EU.

Russia hits no energy targets in Ukraine for the first time since Trump's 'ceasefire'

Reuters
KYIV

Russia hit no Ukrainian energy targets on Tuesday for the first time since U.S. President Donald Trump's weekend announcement of an "energy ceasefire", while hammering cities' transport and logistics overnight with ballistic missiles and drones.

Russia's Defence Ministry, in its daily summary of overnight strikes, made no mention of Ukrainian energy facilities. A Kremlin spokesperson, asked about the energy ceasefire, would only say that contacts were ongoing, but declined to provide any further details. However, one missile came down just over a kilometre from a plant providing heating to much of the city of Lviv, in the west.

A police officer inspects the engine of a Shahed drone in front of a residential building damaged in a Russian strike in Kyiv. AP

Mr. Trump's ceasefire announcement on Sunday came two days after his declaration of a deal that lifted U.S. sanctions on Russian diesel exports to allow Russia to supply almost 2 million metric tonnes of diesel, a bid to lower U.S. fuel prices.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Tuesday that Ukraine had not hit Russian refineries for two days, since Trump announced the ceasefire, but that Russia had continued attacks on energy and critical infrastructure during that time. Russia struck six Ukrainian energy sites on Monday.

Trump says he does not believe China, Russia helping Iran

Reuters
WASHINGTON

U.S. President Donald Trump said late on Monday he did not believe that China and Russia were helping Iran "at all", adding that Moscow and Beijing had "too much to lose" if they enabled Tehran.

Mr. Trump said on Truth Social that he had seen comments from his critics and opponents that China and Russia were helping Iran.

"If they are, it's at a very low level, but I don't believe they are at all. They have too much to lose, and we would know about it, and know about it very fast," Mr. Trump wrote.

Mr. Trump said in July he trusted China and Russia not to help Tehran in the Iran war, but warned that if they did get involved "it would be very bad for them".

The *Washington Post* and the *Wall Street Journal* reported in March that Russia was providing Iran with targeting information.

Sport

Delhi HC asks AITA and petitioners to file replies

Sports Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

The Delhi High Court has asked the All India Tennis Association (AITA) and the original petitioners led by former player Somdev Devvarman to file replies to the Court-appointed administrator Justice (retd.) Gita Mittal's request to implead the AITA Trust and the Delhi Lawn Tennis Association (DLTA) in the ongoing proceedings to amend the AITA's Constitution.

In the hearing held on September 25, the order of which was released recently, the Court said that rejoinders, if any, to AITA's replies should be filed by November 6, the date when the matter will be heard again.

Justice Mittal, in her report dated September 14, had alleged large-scale financial misconduct and accused the office-bearers of stonewalling requests for documents and information.

The Court has also asked the AITA to respond to the request to produce the complete minutes of the Extraordinary General Meeting held on July 26 to ratify the new Constitution in line with the National Sports Governance Act, 2025.

Timeline extended

The timeline for the conduct of fresh elections has been extended to November 27 from the previous deadline of September 30.

The AITA had requested the extension to complete the various mandatory administrative processes in the lead-up to the elections, chief among which is the finalisation of the 40-member strong Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) roster.

LIVE TELECAST

Ranji Trophy: Day 4, JioHotstar, 9 a.m.

India vs West Indies: Fourth T20I, Star Sports 2 & JioHotstar, 7 p.m.

ISL: Sony LIV, 7.30 p.m.

Archery Premier League: Sony LIV, 7.45 p.m.

Champions League: Sony Sports Ten 1, 2 & Sony LIV, 10.15 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Thursday).

Hazlewood bowls Australia to victory

AUSTRALIA IN SA

Agence France-Presse
DURBAN

Josh Hazlewood bagged six wickets in the second innings as Australia completed a 214-run win over South Africa on the fifth day of the first Test at Kingsmead Oval on Tuesday.

Fast bowler Hazlewood twice broke promising stands and finished with six for 49, with the home side bowled out for 206 when chasing 421.

Opening batter Aiden Markram defied the bowlers for a minute short of six hours, scoring 75 before being caught behind from an inside edge off Mitchell Starc for the penultimate wicket. The last four wickets fell for five runs in the space of 16 deliveries against the second new ball.

Jansen is undone by a Hazlewood special. AP

The scores: Australia 390 & 314/6 decl. bt South Africa 284 & 206 in 86.5 overs (Markram 75, Bedingham 46, Hazlewood 6/49).

Atal's fighting ton helps Afghanistan save Test

Agence France-Presse
ABU DHABI

Sediqullah Atal's marathon century and lower-order resistance inspired Afghanistan to a draw in the one-off Test against Bangladesh here on Tuesday.

Having started the final day on 132 for three, Afghanistan survived to finish on 346 for eight after being set a 479-run target. Opener Atal, playing only his third Test, batted for eight-and-a-half hours for his 332-ball 111 before No. 9 Qais Ahmad hit an unbeaten 49 to save the game.

The scores:
Bangladesh 346 & 372/7 decl. drew with Afghanistan 240 & 346/8 in 142 overs (Atal 111, Rahmat 51, Qais 49 n.o.).

Goalkeeper Pathak returns, Asiad core retained for ACT

HOCKEY

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Goalkeeper Krishan Bahadur Pathak returned to the Harmanpreet Singh-led India squad while the core of the Asian Games gold-winning line-up was retained for the Asian Champions Trophy (ACT), to be held in Punjab from October 27 to November 5.

Pathak had missed the Asian Games while young defender Amandeep Lakra and midfielder Aditya Arjun Lalage have also earned an opportunity to strengthen their place in the senior set-up.

"Playing the ACT in Punjab will be something special," chief coach Craig Fulton said. "This squad blends youth with experience, and we can't wait to feed off the crowd. There's nothing like playing a tournament in India, and we've missed it."

The squad: Goalkeepers: Suraj Karkera, Krishan Bahadur Pathak; **Defenders:** Sanjay, Harmanpreet Singh (Capt.), Amit Rohidas, Jugraj Singh, Jarmanpreet Singh, Amandeep Lakra; **Midfielders:** Rajinder Singh, Aditya Arjun Lalage, Nilakanta Sharma, Hardik Singh, Manpreet Singh; **Forwards:** Shilanand Lakra, Abhishek, Sukhjeet Singh, Dilpreet Singh, Mandeep Singh. **Reserve/replacement players:** Vishnu Kant Singh, Angad Bir Singh.

SUSTAINABILITY DIALOGUES

PHOTOS BY J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

Raising queries: A participant asking a question during a session at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues 2026 in Chennai.

Rapt attention: Students listening to experts speak at an event centred on the theme 'Intelligent healthcare for a sustainable and human-centered future'.

Interesting event: Panellists, professors, and others at the event presented by Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS).

Medical students, professors should be asked to take AI course: expert

S. Iniyan, professor and clinical head, department of psychiatry, SIMATS; Abdul Ghafur, senior consultant and adjunct professor in infectious diseases, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai; K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM, Jammu and distinguished professor, The T.N. Dr. MGR Medical University with Geetha Srimathi, senior reporter, *The Hindu* at the event on Tuesday.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

How AI is asked a question, who asks it, and what model of AI is being used can all influence the answer you receive, said Abdul Ghafur, senior consultant and adjunct professor in infectious diseases, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai.

Dr. Ghafur quoted an example: he was teaching students that vaccinations are given after a bone marrow transplant, and not before. One student looked this up on ChatGPT and told him he was wrong, and that it was possible to vaccinate before the transplant. Dr. Ghafur said he then looked it up himself and got the correct answer: not to vaccinate before. This, he said, illustrated that the way the question was framed and the model that was being used, could give two different answers.

Dr. Ghafur highlighted this phenomenon across healthcare settings, and stressed that the data fed into the tool made all the difference, along with how a question was asked. "The logic engine of an AI tool should work the way an experienced person thinks and rationalises," he said. He also added that while ChatGPT for instance, was an anthropic chatbot, there were validated, clinical prediction tools and clinical decision support decision systems in place. AI was entering our lives, he said and it was important to know how to embrace it without being replaced.

On how medical education was or should change, and how it could distinguish between genuine understanding and AI-assisted learning, K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM, Jammu and distinguished professor, The T.N. Dr. MGR Medical University said that he felt medical students and professors of today must formally undergo a course in AI and that this should be made mandatory.

AI as a substitute for therapy

On AI being used as a substitute for therapy, S. Iniyan, professor and clinical head, department of psychiatry, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS, said that he now got a lot of patients who used ChatGPT as a therapist first before coming to him. He noted that AI could simulate empathy and understanding very well. But how it helps is very limited, he cautioned. He said that for instance, with conditions such as OCD or anxiety, the reassurance from a chatbot could make a person feel better temporarily, but the underlying illness would fester and could delay actual treatment.

About the use of data for AI models and the inadequate representation of Indian patients and health settings, Dr. Ghafur highlighted that it was important to train systems on our data and that it was crucial to validate and calibrate on our end. He emphasised that all of this could be done in India –the expertise and specialists were already available. "We can develop India. We have enough brains. We are one of the best in the world," he pointed out.

On ensuring that AI's role in medicine is driven by patient needs rather than corporate interests, Dr. Ganapathy noted that it depended on ROI or return on interest. For him, he said, the fundamental question came down to, did AI contribute to better the outcome of healthcare for my particular patient? We are in a stage of transition, he noted, and this offered great opportunities to find a balance.

Dr. Iniyan noted the importance of regulations to be balanced in order to encourage innovation but also stay cautious.

Sustainability means making healthcare affordable to all, says SIMATS chancellor

Speaking at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues, N.M. Veeraiyan lauds the work of students and staff of Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences; other speakers highlight advantages and threats of Artificial Intelligence in healthcare and stress the need for responsible behaviour

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

True sustainability, said N.M. Veeraiyan, founder and chancellor, Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS), lies in protecting human life, preserving human dignity, and making quality healthcare accessible and affordable for all.

Dr. Veeraiyan was speaking at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues 2026, presented by SIMATS, held on Tuesday.

Dr. Veeraiyan stressed the need for affordable healthcare and noted that the institute's research goal was to ensure that it benefited society. Dr. Veeraiyan gave the example of an app developed by the institute that allowed patients to differentiate between gastric issues and a cardiac problem.

The chancellor lauded the work of all the staff and students in ensuring that the institute was recognised as one of the top institutions in the country and in Tamil Nadu.

J. Kumutha, dean, Saveetha Medical College; Ashwani Kumar vice-chancellor (SIMATS); K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM Jammu and distinguished professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R Medical University; N. M. Veeraiyan, chancellor, (SIMATS); S. Sundaresan, senior vice-president, advertisement, *The Hindu*; Sheeja S. Varghese, registrar (SIMATS); Dhanraj Ganapathy, dean of sustainability (SIMATS) at the event on Tuesday. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

'Native intelligence'

K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM, Jammu, and distinguished professor, The T.N. Dr. M.G.R. Medical University, stressed the importance of 'native intelligence' over artificial intelligence (AI).

He emphasised that while there were many advantages of AI, it had a number of limitations that should be understood. He said medical students needed to be trained in statistics in great detail to be able to evaluate numbers. He also noted the problem of using Western data in algorithms that might not be applicable to India, and the fact that the socio-economic conditions of families needed to be considered in the context of treatment plans.

He urged students to treat not just the lab investigation, the scan, the tumour, or even the patient alone – but the entire family.

'Flip side of AI'

Dhanraj Ganapathy, dean of sustainability, SIMATS, said that AI was a powerful tool, but that its flipside included biases, as it was dependent on what was fed into it, digital hallucinations, and the threats it could potentially pose, such as the creation of synthetic viruses.

He highlighted the need for responsible behaviour by human beings, besides patience and compassion. He noted that we were entering an era of collaborative intelligence: the cold brilliance of artificial intelligence needed to be superseded by a warm, empathetic human heart.

S. Sundaresan, senior vice-president, advertisement, *The Hindu*, welcomed the gathering and said that the institution believed that meaningful dialogue on issues that impact society was an important part of media responsibility.

The Hindu Sustainability Dialogues 2026 was centred on the theme 'Intelligent healthcare for a sustainable and human-centered future'. It had two of two panels – AI-driven healthcare: innovation, ethics, accessibility and sustainability; and Human touch in the age of AI: preserving compassion, trust and ethics in modern medicine.

Ashwani Kumar, vice-chancellor, SIMATS; Sheeja S. Varghese, registrar, SIMATS; and J. Kumutha, dean, Saveetha Medical College and Hospital, also participated in the event.

AI can improve disease detection but human oversight is needed: experts

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Artificial intelligence (AI) can improve disease detection, expand access to healthcare, and reduce diagnostic costs, but its adoption must be backed by clinical validation, data protection and human oversight, experts said in a panel discussion in Chennai on Tuesday.

The discussion on 'Artificial Intelligence-Driven Healthcare: Innovation, Ethics, Accessibility and Sustainability' was held as part of *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues 2026, presented by Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences.

The panellists were Sindhuja Giritharan, Clinical Lead, Digital Health and Patient Engagement, Sundaram Medical Foundation; Richa Pant, Director, Research, Deep Tek; Reuben Fernandes, Founder & CEO, Skyfire Applied Intelligence Pvt. Limited (Atom360); and A. Hariharan, Associate Professor, Department of Transfusion Medicine, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS.

Ms. Pant said medical imaging was among the areas where AI was making a significant difference, as digital images offered standardised data from which systems could learn patterns.

"What I have observed through my research is that AI is helping reach larger populations, particularly in areas where there is a severe shortage of radiologists and other specialists. For instance, in a study we conducted in six districts of Tamil Nadu, we saw first-hand how implementing AI in TB screening could help reach more people," she said.

Reuben Fernandes, Founder & CEO, Skyfire Applied Intelligence Pvt. Limited; A. Hariharan, Associate Professor, Department of Transfusion Medicine, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS; Sindhuja Giritharan, Clinical Lead, Digital Health and Patient Engagement, Sundaram Medical Foundation; Richa Pant, Director, Research, Deep Tek; and Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*.

'Prioritise critical cases'

AI could help hospitals prioritise critical cases rather than process scans strictly in the order in which they arrived, enabling patients requiring urgent attention to receive treatment faster, she said.

Mr. Fernandes highlighted the potential of AI to address the low uptake of cancer screening. He said less than 1% of the population was screened for cancer, while many patients sought medical attention only after symptoms appeared, by which time the disease could have advanced to Stage III or IV.

Smartphone-based tools could help identify suspicious oral lesions and direct patients to specialists for further assessment, Mr. Fernandes said, adding that deploying AI models directly on phones could also reduce dependence on internet connectivity in areas with limited infrastructure.

Human aspects

Dr. Giritharan said AI should enable doctors to devote more time to patients rather than replace the human aspects of healthcare. AI could assist with documentation, summarising medical histories, tracking medication adherence and processing clinical information. However, doctors would still need to explain diagnoses, understand patients' individual circumstances and help them make informed treatment decisions, she said.

"A human has to tell a human," Dr. Giritharan said, stressing the importance of personal communication, particularly when patients were anxious about a diagnosis or struggled to follow medical advice because of financial or family circumstances.

She also called for greater emphasis on preventive healthcare. AI-assisted reminders and digital follow-ups could help doctors monitor patients with chronic conditions such as diabetes between consultations, identify difficulties in adhering to treatment and intervene when necessary, Dr. Giritharan added.

Mr. Hariharan, said there was a need for clinicians to understand the limitations of AI systems and recognise when their recommendations should not be followed. He cautioned that patient information could not be shared indiscriminately with AI systems. While the Digital Personal Data Protection Act and medical device regulations provided relevant frameworks, he said clearer safeguards were needed.

The session was moderated by Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*.

SIMATS students on AI

"AI is everywhere....however, its use and application in healthcare are very different to its use in other fields... But its most effective use lies in combining it with human touch

ADWAITH P.
Bachelor of Occupational Therapy

"I think AI will push people to learn more. AI should help people develop a logical understanding, but providing empathy should remain a human responsibility

TEJASWI K.
B.Sc. Biomedical Sciences

"AI can help researchers and therapists develop specialised tech for individual patients. AI chatbots should not be depended upon for medical advice: there is a danger of erroneous recommendations and wrong advice

ALEX V. GEORGE
Bachelor of Occupational Therapy

"I want to pursue neuroscience after this, and I think AI will play a prominent role in the field. AI can map out things and perform analyses that would take humans a long time to do. We must learn to use AI responsibly

SHRESTHA B.
B.Sc. Biomedical Sciences

"AI's abilities to develop technology for gadgets and help with treatment holds a lot of potential. In the future, it could make possible things that we can't imagine today

ROSHAN SAJI VARGHESE
Bachelor of Occupational Therapy

"Occupational therapy is largely based on hands-on experience and direct interactions between therapists and their clients. The important thing is to use AI logically and appropriately, rather than relying on generative AI for everything

SAHANA S.
B.Sc. Occupational Therapy

LESSON LEARNT

Until the umpire signals a four, I will keep running: Tilak

PTI

Tilak Varma addressed the run-out in Indore, which had been much discussed. “There was a flash on the advertising board. I felt that the ball touched the board and came back inside. Axar [Patel] felt the same, so we both stopped. Going forward, until the umpire signals a boundary, I will just keep running!”

SUCCESS FORMULA

Our players need to adapt when the pressure is on: Sammy

PTI

Daren Sammy dismissed the notion that West Indies was overdependent on Shai Hope, pointing to contributions from Brandon King (ODIs), Shimron Hetmyer and Sherfane Rutherford (T20Is). “Some of our players need to adapt to that calmness when the pressure is on. But Hope is not the only reason we win.”

DOUBLE DELIGHT

Gill wins a record fifth ICC PoTM award; Shafali, too, tops

FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

India captain Shubman Gill was on Tuesday named ICC men’s Player of the Month for a record fifth time after his outstanding performance in the ODI series against the West Indies. Opener Shafali Verma bagged the women’s honour for her impressive show in the Asia Cup and Asian Games.

HIGH-PROFILE SIGNING

Yuvraj appointed Delhi Capitals assistant and batting coach

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A week after Sourav Ganguly’s appointment as head coach, Delhi Capitals roped in another high-profile name in Yuvraj Singh on Tuesday as part of its support staff for the 2027 Indian Premier League season. The 44-year-old Yuvraj joins Capitals as assistant coach and batting coach.

India and WI willow-wielders glove up for another blast

The host is one win away from sealing a series victory; the Men in Blue scored 297 the last time they took strike here in a T20I; Shreyas & Co. will need to iron out chinks in the bowling department; the visitor has been far from a pushover

WI IN INDIA

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Dynamites: Southpaws Kishan and Rutherford can pack a punch. K.R. DEEPAK

The story so far has been more about fireworks than finesse.

In Lucknow, Shreyas Iyer’s maiden T20I hundred powered India to victory in 14.4 overs. Ranchi brought a jolt, as Shai Hope and Sherfane Rutherford ended the host’s run of 10 straight wins in completed T20Is. Indore swung it back, with Abhishek Sharma and Arshdeep Singh engineering a 14-run triumph.

Now the series moves to the Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium on Wednesday, which has long been kind to T20 batters. In India’s last outing here, against Bangladesh in October 2024, it ended three runs short of 300. It is also home to Sunrisers Hyderabad, the IPL’s most trigger-happy side.

The host will lean on a top-order that has taken turns to blaze away. While the West Indies has struggled to contain the firepower, it has been far from a pushover. That said, it will need a more complete performance to unsettle the reigning world champion and keep the series alive.

Only one match out of six on this tour has been won while defending a total, when India did so in Indore, where dew stayed away and made a difference for the Indian bowlers.

It could be the same case in Hyderabad too, which has seen average temperatures vary between 31-34 °C the last few days.

Bowling is India’s big question, especially in the absence of pace ace Jasprit Bumrah. It couldn’t defend 249 in Ranchi and head coach Gautam Gambhir flagged concerns over white-ball pitches after the run-fest.

The surface in Hyderabad adds another twist to the contest. Its top layer has been re-laid (with an 80-20 black-red soil mix), and how differently it will play, if at all, remains to be seen.

Either way, bowlers will be tested in a format where, to borrow from Keemo Paul, they either get to execute their plans or get executed.

Arshdeep’s three wickets carried India home in Indore, Naman Dhir, too, proved clinical, providing the side with another useful bowling option. For the visitor, Roston Chase leads the bowling charts and will relish another crack at Abhishek, whom he has dismissed twice in 13 balls this series.

A series win is within touching distance for India but the Windies have the nerve to make the host sweat. Between them lies a strip of freshly laid earth and 40 overs that will remember who blinked first.

Match starts at 7 p.m.

‘You can’t hit from the first ball in T20s’

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Tilak. K.R. DEEPAK

The Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium will open its arms for a few homegrown stars in an Indian team looking to cement its lead in the five-match T20I series against the West Indies.

Local lad Tilak Varma is aware of Uppal’s flat surfaces that have seen gargantuan T20 scores.

“We were discussing that the wickets here have been changed. But in T20s, you can’t go from the first ball. We’ve played everywhere.

“Each player has played more than 50 games in the format. You take one or two balls and get to know how the wicket is behaving, what shots to play and more,” Tilak said on Tuesday, the eve of the fourth T20I.

Happiest in the No. 3 spot, Tilak said he was happy to be malleable to the team’s demands.

“Right now my role is to handle the middle phase. If quick wickets go, I can take my time and take the game deep.

“If the top three bat till the 14th or 15th over, I know how to change gears and go from the first ball. I’ve been practising for both.”

The 23-year-old blitzed away to an unbeaten 44 off just 18 balls in Ranchi before a 16-ball 28 in Indore.

Tilak was in good spirits ahead of a fixture that could potentially decide the series and was happy that so many members in the setup are familiar with conditions in Hyderabad.

“Yes, we’ll have a slight edge. Ishan [Kishan], Nitish [Kumar], Abhishek and myself have played here many times. More than me, the others have played here more because every year they play half of their IPL games here. So they know how the wicket behaves, how the outfield is and more”.

We have to win both PowerPlays: Sammy

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

West Indies head coach Daren Sammy felt that the PowerPlay had been the difference between his side and India this T20I series. He pointed out that India had scored at nearly 14.5 runs per over in that period and Windies had restricted the scoring rate to below 10 in subsequent phases.

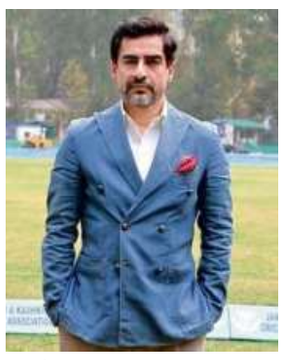
“We have had to pull the game back every single time. That [PowerPlay] is an area we need to work on. To beat India in India, you really have to win both PowerPlays, with bat and ball,” he said.

According to Sammy, the Men in Maroon have matched India’s batting muscle. He referred to bowling coach Ravi Rampaul’s observation that letting the opposition hit more fours than sixes would save two runs each time. “We out-sixed them in the last game. When you play on good batting pitches, you feel you are in the game. You are just two big overs away from getting yourself back into it.”

The challenge, he believes, is greater for the bowlers. “If 200 is a par score, you have to prevent the opposition from getting to 250”.

‘Fitness and form should be the criteria for selection, not age’

Shayan Acharya
SRINAGAR



Manhas. IMRAN NISSAR

Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma’s selection for the 2027 ODI World Cup should depend on fitness and performances, and not their age, said BCCI president Mithun Manhas.

“As far as the BCCI is concerned, we are not in a position to comment because it all depends on the selectors and the coaches. But from how I look at it, fitness and performance should be the criteria for selection, and definitely not age,” he told *The Hindu*.

“If somebody is fit to play, and you see him performing and winning games for the country, that is the only criterion we should focus on.”

Experience vital

Manhas believes experience will be vital as Shubman Gill prepares to lead India in the next ODI World Cup. He said the presence of Kohli, Rohit and Hardik Pandya could help Gill manage the demands of captaincy alongside Jasprit Bumrah’s leadership within the bowling group.

“Having Virat, Hardik and Rohit in the side will definitely help him. Then there is Bumrah, who could be the bowling captain, and somebody who could be the fielding captain. It’s all about distribution of workload,” Manhas said.

He felt that seniors could be crucial when the team comes under pressure, drawing on their experience in handling tough situations.

“They have been under pressure and delivered so many times in crunch situations. So, it’s valuable,” he said.

Manhas also backed India’s growing player-pool as a means of managing an increasingly demanding international calendar. With overlapping assignments and injuries posing challenges, he said the depth would help the team across formats.

Gibson does it for Royals; Marathas, Knights shine

APL

Sports Bureau
HYDERABAD

Royal show: Gibson struck the 10-ring on all six occasions during the day. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Defending champion Rajputana Royals, after a run of poor results, made it back-to-back wins with a dominant display against high-flying Chero Archers in the Archery Premier League season 2 at People’s Plaza on Tuesday. Royals, who suffered three straight losses before tasting success on Monday, were in superb form as they blanked Archers 6-0.

The result moved Royals to six points and kept them in the race for a semifinal berth. Archers, too, have six points. Mighty Marathas and Kakatiya Knights moved clear at the top of the table with eight points each. While the former defeated Prithviraj Yodhas 6-2, Knights blanked Chola Chiefs 6-0.

Dhiraj dazzles

Marathas’ recurve star Dhiraj Bommadevara was in terrific form, repeatedly shooting clutch 10s with barely any time left on the clock. Mike Schloesser set up the sets well and finished with 78 out of 80 as Marathas’ resurgence continued. They were placed on top ahead of Knights, with only set points separating the sides.

In the final match, Knights consigned Chiefs to the bottom of the table as Nico Wiener and Neeraj Chauhan were in terrific form at the start and end of the sets – both registering 59 out of 60 – while Spain’s recurve archer Elia Canales provided able support. In Jyothi Surekha’s absence, Avneet Kaur also stepped in admirably for the home franchise.

Earlier, Royals’ star was compound World No. 1 Ella Gibson, who produced a stupendous show and came up with six perfect 10s.

Archers, who went back to their recurve international archer Casey Kaufhold instead of Kumkum Mohod, lost the first set 73-74 after the American started with a 7. In the second set, Royals edged ahead 76-75 with the Chero side paying the price for a couple of 9s from their compound archers. The third set was tied 58-58 after six arrows each when Atanu Das hit a rare 8.

For Royals, Sangeeta, playing her first match in place of Ankita Bhakat, responded with a sensational 10. With 8 needed, Tokyo Olympic champion Mete Gazoz delivered a 9.

The scores:

Rajputana Royals bt Chero Archers 6-0 (74-73, 76-75, 77-75).
Mighty Marathas bt Prithviraj Yodhas 6-2 (76-74, 77-73, 70-78, 76-75).
Kakatiya Knights bt Chola Chiefs 6-0 (74-73, 79-78, 77-75).

There’s nothing you can’t achieve: Rai senior’s advice

GOLF

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

Tryst with history: Rai stunned the golfing world by winning the PGA Championship. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

After carrying the bag for his wife, Gaurika Bishnoi, at last year’s Hero Women’s Indian Open, Aaron Rai is back in the National Capital Region this year – this time to compete himself.

The 31-year-old’s profile has risen considerably since his last visit to these shores. In May, Rai stunned the golfing world by winning the PGA Championship, becoming the first Englishman to lift the title since Jim Barnes in 1919.

One of the leading contenders at this week’s DP World India Championship, Rai acknowledged that the historic triumph had changed his life.

The soft-spoken Englishman, regarded as one of the nicest men on the tour, attributes much of his success to his parents, Amrik and Dalvir, who are of Indian descent. Despite their limited financial means, they made significant sacrifices to support their son’s golfing ambitions.

His father, in particular, instilled in him the belief that there were no limits to what he could achieve. “There is nothing that you cannot achieve – that was my father’s big message. There shouldn’t be any limitations, no matter where you’re from, no matter what you have or don’t have,” Rai said at a press conference at the Delhi Golf Club here on Tuesday.

Rai. REUTERS

“Society can put you into boxes of what you can and cannot achieve, which creates limitations. But if you are really diligent and disciplined, every single person has a huge amount of potential that can be fulfilled,” he added.

Rai is among a rare breed of golfers who uses iron covers to appreciate the true value of his equipment. More broadly, he has sought to remain grounded and approachable, holding on to the values instilled in him.

“I think every person has that responsibility to try and be warm, and try to set good examples. We don’t understand the positivity that can create for someone else and the ripple effect that can have,” he said.

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INBRIEF

Unnathi knocks out top seed Deepthi; Ribhav progresses

Unnathi Muralidhar stunned top seed Deepthi Venkatesan 6-2, 6-2 in a second round girls' under-16 match of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship in New Delhi on Tuesday. However, boys' No. 1 Ribhav Saroha progressed with a 6-2, 6-2 win over Rhunmaan Mahesh.

Other results (second round):
Under-16: Boys: Lakshya Chukka bt Aarav Patel 6-1, 6-2; Paranjay Siwach bt Tanish Dasari 6-4, 7-5; Parthiv Nallagundla bt Divey Malik 7-6(2), 6-0; Yaj Malik bt Hemdev Mahesh 7-6(3), 6-4; Jeevith Sathish bt Ashwin Kabilan 7-6(3), 2-6, 6-2.
Girls: Tanusshri Sathesh bt Sanidya Karantoth 6-1, 6-1; Aaradhya Meena bt N. Krishnaprabhu 6-0, 6-1; Rishita Yadav bt Aashi Kashyap 3-6, 6-3, 6-2; Aahida Singh bt Harsha Oruganti 3-6, 6-2, 6-0; Ranjhana Sangram bt Tejaswi Manneni 4-6, 6-4, 6-3.
Under-14: Boys: Second round: Aarav Chhallani bt Rajishnu Poptani 6-1, 6-1; **First Round:** Puneeth Manohar bt Kabir Gundecha 6-1, 6-0; Nibras Hussain bt Zaayn Mohammad 6-3, 6-0; Pranav Gaikwad bt Ranveer Gawli 6-1, 6-4.
Girls: Second round: Sarena Gahlot bt Janhavi Sawant 6-2, 6-2; Sidhhi Pandey bt Aaradhya Singh 6-4, 6-3; Zoha Qureshi bt Sara Fengse 6-3, 6-2; Khushi Kadian bt Shaurya Patil 6-2, 6-1; Saanvi Mohan bt Myra Shaikh 6-4, 6-2.

F1 to return to Africa in 'early 2030s' in Rwanda

Rwanda will host a Formula One race from the early 2030s in a 10-year deal, F1 said in a statement on Tuesday. Formula One has not raced in Africa since the last South African Grand Prix was held at Kyalami, north of Johannesburg, in 1993. The track where the Rwandan race will happen is yet to be built. It will be near an international airport being built at Bugesera some 40 km (25 miles) from the capital Kigali.

Zverev set to become World No. 1 at the end of the year

The ATP confirmed it will crown a new World No. 1 as Germany's Alexander Zverev was ensured the year-end honour on Monday after Carlos Alcaraz lost his third-round match in Shanghai. The career-first will cap a stellar season for the 29-year-old, the current World No. 2, after he won the French Open in June and the US Open in September. "It's been a fantastic season for me winning in Paris and New York and knowing that I will finish the year on top of the rankings is just a dream come true," Zverev said in a statement.

Ticket ballot for WC 2027 receives 1.5 crore applications

The International Cricket Council (ICC) on Tuesday said it has received over 1.5 crore ticket applications from 142 countries since the ticket ballot for the 2027 World Cup went live 12 days ago, underlining the immense global interest in the showpiece. The marquee 50-over tournament will be jointly hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia from October 2 to November 21. "A total of 15,083,752 ticket applications have been received, with 4,423,417 ballot registrations generated by fans from across 142 countries," the ICC said in a statement. The ticket ballot will remain open for registration until November 21, 2026, exactly a year before the final is scheduled to be played at the Wanderers in Johannesburg.

Coventry shocks Newcastle, makes it two in a row

Teenager Sidiki Cherif scored one and made one as host Coventry overcame a dishevelled Newcastle 4-1 and earned successive Premier League wins on Monday. "It is so hard to win but we played like the team we want to be tonight," coach Frank Lampard said.

Top results: Premier League: Coventry 4 (Rudoni 6-pen, Cherif 48, Simms 81, Mfuni 86) bt Newcastle 1 (Botman 70). **LaLiga:** Levante 3 (Romero 57, De La Fuente 90+2, Ndukwe 90+10) drew with Sevilla 3 (Ure 13, Correia 54, Romero 90+5). **Serie A:** Torino 2 (Braganca 36, Kulenovic 67) bt Udinese 1 (Ekkelenkamp 43); Atalanta 3 (Kessie 4, Krstovic 6, 30) bt Venezia 1 (Hainaut 37).

ENGAGEMENTS

Hockey: MCC-Murugappa Tamil Nadu u-17 tournament, boys' section, first day, SDAT-Mayor Radhakrishnan Stadium, 6.30 a.m. & 2 p.m.

Kukna inflicts damage, hands Rajasthan the lead

The left-arm spinner scalps five, including the wicket of Andre, to help the host earn an 89-run first-innings cushion against Tamil Nadu; the away side loses five batters for just 10 runs

RANJI TROPHY

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

First Class cricket is a pressure cooker whose whistle can remain silent for hours before suddenly shrieking. Tamil Nadu spent the morning on a low simmer, adding just 65 runs in 37 overs and losing a wicket to a run-out. After lunch, left-arm spinner Kukna Ajay Singh had the batting side cooked, finishing with five for 51.

Tamil Nadu lost its last five wickets for 10 runs to fold for 274, conceding an 89-run first-innings lead to Rajasthan on the third day of the Elite Group-D Ranji Trophy match at the Sawai Mansingh Stadium here on Tuesday. Kukna brought Andre Siddarth's compact innings (81, 192b, 7x4) to an end, breaking his attritional 61-run sixth-wicket stand with Washington Sundar (26 n.o.). Andre went on the back foot to cut and missed. Kukna then cleaned up D. Deepesh and, two balls later, bowled No. 11 Saravana Kumar through the gate.

Andre scored the morning session's only boundary, punching Hemant Kumar off the back foot to deep extra cover.

Andre's innings was measured in small units: a single, a second run, even a third. He ducked under the short ball, left outside off, fell back on the good old block. His batting was an exercise in restraint – he raised his 10th First Class fifty off 145 balls – and judgement. In an over from pacer Chetan Sharma, he flicked for four to deep midwicket, left the next ball outside off, flicked for four to cow corner, and left the next ball outside off again.

Rajasthan lost four wickets in its second innings. Left-hander Sachin Yadav went for a drive and missed, allowing Sai Kishore to bowl him for a duck, while Sumit Godara (2) edged Saravana Kumar to Sonu Yadav at second slip. Karan Lamba and Rohan Rajbhar were also sent back.

Leading the charge: Kukna spun a web around the Tamil Nadu batters. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The scores: Rajasthan — 1st innings: 363.
Tamil Nadu — 1st innings: Sai Sudharsan b Chetan 3, N. Jagadeesan c Rohan b Kukna 55, Pradosh Ranjan Paul b Kukna 58, B. Indrajith b Rohan 26, Andre Siddarth b Kukna 81, Sonu Yadav run out 13, Washington Sundar (not out) 26, Nidhish Rajagopal c Sumit b Akash 1, Sai Kishore c Sachin b Akash 2, Deepesh b Kukna 0, Saravana Kumar b Kukna 0; Extras (b-1, lb-3, nb-4, w-1): 9; Total (in 98.4 overs): 274.
Fall of wickets: 1-11, 2-115, 3-121, 4-167, 5-203, 6-264, 7-265, 8-273, 9-274.
Rajasthan bowling: Akash 24-1-74-2, Chetan 15-1-50-1, Suthar 21-5-49-0, Hemant 9-0-30-0, Rohan 5-0-16-1, Kukna 24.4-5-51-5.
Rajasthan — 2nd innings: Sachin Yadav b Sai Kishore 0, Rohan Rajbhar st. Jagadeesan b Sai Kishore 10, Sumit Godara c Sonu b Saravana Kumar 2, Karan Lamba b Sonu 13, Mahipal Lomror (not out) 25, Kartik Sharma (not out) 30; Extras (lb-1): 1; Total (for four wkts. in 34 overs): 81.
Fall of wickets: 1-0, 2-3, 3-25, 4-31.
Tamil Nadu bowling: Sai Kishore 14-2-25-2, Saravana Kumar 5-2-4-1, Washington 7-2-19-0, Sonu 5-0-16-1, Deepesh 3-0-16-0.

RANJI TROPHY SCORES — ROUND ONE, DAY THREE

Elite: Group A: At Rajgir: Uttar Pradesh 540 bt Bihar 141 in 52.1 overs (Kartik Yadav 4/26, Karan Sharma 4/28) & 132 in 36.4 overs (Zeeshan Ansari 4/40). **Points: UP 7(7), Bihar 0(0).**
At Panaji: Baroda 472/8 decl. vs. Goa 199 in 71.1 overs (Snehal Kauthankar 50, Lalit Yadav 54, Mahesh Pithiya 5/58, Bhargav Bhatt 4/51) & 35/1 in 13 overs.
At Srinagar: Madhya Pradesh 196 & 151/5 in 62 overs (Shubham Sharma 51 batting) vs. Jammu & Kashmir 120.
At Nagpur: Vidarbha 428 & 22/1 in 11 overs vs. Pondicherry 313 in 114.5 overs (Ritesh Gudge 95, Nikhil Gangta 54, Mohit Kale 78).
Group B: At Hyderabad: Tripura 134 & 120 in 41.2 overs (Tanay Thyagarajann 6/52) lost to Hyderabad 294. **Hyderabad 7(7), Tripura 0(0).**
At Vijayawada: Karnataka 274 & 176/4 in 60 overs (Manvanth Kumar 44, Karun Nair 81 batting) vs. Andhra 418 in 121.5 overs. (Shaik Rasheed 54, S.V. Rahul 119, Revanth Reddy 97, Shikhar Shetty 6/115).
At New Chandigarh: Assam 373 vs. Punjab 287/5 in 96 overs (Vihaan Malhotra 103, Harnoor Singh 54).
At Rajkot: Saurashtra 392 & 45/0 in 13 overs vs. Chhattisgarh 312 in 121.5 overs (Anuj Tiwary 72 retd. hurt, Mayank Verma 68, Vikalp Tiwari 46, Rahul Pradhan 41 n.o.).
Group C: At Jamshedpur: Jharkhand 587 vs. Kerala 269/6 in 90 overs (Abhishek P. Nair 126, Rohan Kunnummal 44).
At Kalyani: Delhi 240 & 101/3 in 45 overs vs. Bengal 429 in 112 overs (Sudip Kumar Gharami 133, Abishek Porel 149, Sumata Gupta 50, Ayush Badoni 5/43).
At Ahmedabad: Odisha 324 & 119/4 in 30 overs (Sandeep Pattnaik 41 batting, Ninad Rathva 53) vs. Gujarat 439 in 106.4 overs (Aarya Desai 94, Vedant Trivedi 108, Urvil Patel 85, Harshal Patel 60, Badal Biswal 5/118).
At New Delhi: Maharashtra 333 & 66/5 in 28 overs (Arjun Sharma 4/30) vs. Services 227 in 93.2 overs (Nitin Tanwar 61, Vineet Dhankhar 40, Rajat Paliwal 44, Hitesh Walunj 5/51).
Group D: At Lahli: Himachal Pradesh 253 & 113 in 40 overs vs. Haryana 296 in 82.3 overs (Ankit Kumar 59, Yashvardhan Dalal 72, Kanishk Chouhan 50, Aryaman Singh Dhaliwal 4/72) & 26/3 in nine overs.
At Mumbai (Brabourne Stadium): Railways 278 & 34/0 in 15 overs vs. Uttarakhand 470 in 156.5 overs (Kunal Chandela 43, Avneesh Sudha 90, J. Suchith 62, Saurabh Rawat 107, Mayank Mishra 51).
At Jaipur: Rajasthan 363 & 81/4 in 34 overs vs. Tamil Nadu 274 in 98.4 overs (N. Jagadeesan 55, Pradosh Ranjan Paul 58, Andre Siddarth 81, Ajay Singh 5/51).
At Mumbai (Wankhede Stadium): Mumbai 429 bt Chandigarh 78 & 196 in 52.1 overs (Arjun Azad 62, Shivam Bambri 44). **Mumbai 7(7), Chandigarh 0(0).**
Plate: At Rangpo: Sikkim 245 & 44/0 in 28 overs vs. Meghalaya 395 in 150.2 overs (Kishan Lyngdoh 78, Swastic Chettri 73, Jaskirat Singh 127, Kranti Kumar 5/71).
At Nadiad: Mizoram 183 & 295 in 107.4 overs (Sahil Reza 51, Chinmay Sutar 99, Jehu Anderson 71, Kishan Singha 4/88) vs. Manipur 251 & 8/0 in two overs.

Tanay... Hyderabad's hero. NAGARA GOPAL

Accuracy was the best thing for me: Kukna

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

Rajasthan left-arm spinner Kukna Ajay Singh attributed his five for 51 against Tamil Nadu here on Tuesday to accuracy and pace variations.

"My accuracy was the best thing for me in this performance.

"The plan was to bowl in one area and not move away from it whatever the batters might try. I kept varying my pace so that it didn't get easier for them," he said.

The 29-year-old said he had worked on his undercut deliveries during the pre-season while continuing to focus on accuracy through spot-bowling practice.

He revealed that conversations with New Zealand left-arm spinner Mitchell Santner during his net-bowling stint with Mumbai Indians in IPL 2026 helped him refine his approach.

"We even used to train together, and I had quite a few conversations with him. You also learn a lot when bowling to Rohit Sharma," he said.

"I asked Santner about his methods, especially given his height advantage. I worked on my variations and used them in this match. I got N. Jagadeesan out that way," he said.

SNAPSHOTS

Jayant powers TN's reply; Maurya scalps six

NATHAM: Tamil Nadu was 291 for seven at stumps, in reply to Saurashtra's 201, at stumps on day two of their Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy Elite Group-A first round match at NPR College ground on Tuesday.
The scores: Saurashtra 201 in 85.3 overs (Devansh Garaiya 50, Marvin Javiya 39, Sachin Rathi 4/78) vs. TN 291/7 in 92 overs (K.T.A. Madhava Prasad 50, R.K. Jayant 101, P. Vignesh 38, Sunny Sandhu 32 batting, Om Nitin Karthikeyan 32 batting, Maurya Ghoghari 6/104).

Jayant (Tamil Nadu, 101), Maurya (Saurashtra, 6/104).

Athletics coach Yunus suspended for alleged anti-doping violation

NEW DELHI: One of India's most well-known athletics coaches, Mohammad Yunus Khan, who has guided star long distance runner Gulveer Singh in his formative years, has been provisionally suspended for alleged "complicity" in an unspecified anti-doping rule violation.

166 athletes make the cut for Para Asiad

The Sports Ministry has axed under-fire para-shooting coach Jai Prakash Nautiyal from the Para Asian Games-bound Indian contingent, approving a total of 166 athletes after a controversy-mired selection process which resulted in protests by shooters and cyclists.
The Games are due to start on October 18 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.
Long-serving National coach Jeevan Rai has replaced Nautiyal in the contingent.
With 94 team officials and support staff and 15 contingent staff, India's total at the continental showpiece would be 275 in 10 disciplines.
Despite a protest by the omitted cyclists, the Ministry has avoided last-minute additions and approved only Paralympian Arshad Shaik, who was the best performer among those in contention.
Six other cyclists had also been picked by the Cycling Federation of India and the Paralympic Committee of India but they were omitted for not meeting the criteria. Among the accomplished names in the approved table tennis contingent is Paralympic silver-winning player Bhavina Patel.
Former World No. 1 and Tokyo Paralympic gold-medallist Pramod Bhagat, along with former Paralympic silver-winner Suhas Yathiraj, headline the badminton squad of 28 (17 men, 11 women).
Armless compound archer Sheetal Devi will once again be a top contender.

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A leader who took India to uncharted terrains

She is someone who enjoyed captaincy and strongly believed in the team-first approach. She nurtured young talents, encouraged them and waxed eloquent when they succeeded at the highest level

P.K. Ajith Kumar

She came. She led. She conquered. Now, she has stepped down.

So, the best captain Indian women's cricket has ever had will no longer walk out to toss with the rival captain in an international game. Harmanpreet Kaur would be cherishing those walks to the middle, in the glare of the television cameras. She is someone who has enjoyed captaincy. And it was a job she did rather well, for all those talks about the need for change in captaincy in recent times.

Granted, she could not take India to the semifinals of the Women's T20 World Cup in England three months ago. But, last year she had led India to an ODI World Cup triumph.

"Only Kapil Dev and M.S. Dhoni have done that," former India captain Shubhangi Kulkarni reminds you over phone from Pune. "So she is in a very exclusive club. And she played a major role in the Indian victory as a batter, too. Everyone talks about Jemimah Rodrigues' brilliant hundred in the semifinal against Australia, but Harmanpreet made 89."

After losing the openers Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Verma inside 10 overs, it was the skipper's 167-run stand for the third wicket with Jemimah that put India's chase of a World-record breaking target. Harmanpreet knows how to make an impact in big games, and she certainly knows how to torment Australia, the best team in women's cricket.

Even in her last appearance as a captain against the Aussies, in the league match at the T20 World Cup at Lord's, she had cracked a 27-ball 56 that gave India at least a fighting chance in what was a must-win situation. But, a determined Australia, riding on a superb partnership with its champion all-rounders Ellyse Perry and Ashleigh Gardner, knocked India out of the competition, avenging the loss in the ODI World Cup.

That was indeed a big blow to Harmanpreet and her women. They were one of the favourites and were at least expected to make the semifinals, but the defeat to South Africa, earlier in the Group of Death, was always going to be costly.

Historic triumph

The Indians, however, won the historic Women's Test at Lord's, which was played right after the World Cup. And India totally outplayed England.

That was followed by the twin successes at the Asia Cup and the Asian Games. So Harmanpreet could end her captaincy on a high.

She admitted, through her widely read Instagram post, that the decision to step down was not easy. "The decision carries years of memories, emotions, sacrifices, and moments that will stay with me for the rest of my life," she wrote.

"I have given everything I had to this team and to Indian women's cricket – my blood, my sweat, my time, and many times, a part of my own game and personal ambitions. There were moments when I had to put my individual performance, my own growth, and what I wanted for myself aside, because I believed the team had to come first."

She said she had to make some difficult decisions. "Decisions that were not always understood, not always easy, and sometimes came at a personal cost," she explained. "But every decision I made was with one intention - to make this team better and to give other players the opportunity to grow, believe in themselves and become the best versions of themselves."

Shubangi, one of the pioneers of women's cricket in India, says Harmanpreet indeed was able to transform the Indian team with her leadership. "She has led India through a period of enormous changes," she said. "From a team which was competing well, and expecting to do well, to becoming a team that wins major championships – she did it through some real high points and through some very low points, too. We have waited for a long, long time, for 50 years to win a senior ICC championship. There was a heartbreak in 2005 and then a bigger one in 2017 (India lost the World Cup finals). So what Harmanpreet's Indian team did last year is indeed remarkable, and it is something she could always be proud about."

Transforming the side

Biju George, who has worked with Harmanpreet as the fielding coach of the Indian team also rates her captaincy highly. "She was an aggressive captain who hated losing," says the Thiruvananthapuram-based man whose wards include Sanju Samson. "As a captain, she has reminded me of Sourav Ganguly. Like he transformed the Indian men's team, Harman did something similar with the women's team."

Biju also has always been in awe of her batting. "Her 171 not out against Australia in the semifinal of the 2017 World Cup in England is the best innings I have ever seen, by a male or a female cricketer, and I was lucky that I could watch it along with the Indian team," he said.

"Harman is one of the earliest batters who brought in power to women's cricket. We have many players who can hit hard now, but not at the time when she was doing it."

And Harman could change the complexion of a game with those big shots. And she has been doing it for so long. Biju feels she could be scoring more runs after relinquishing the captaincy. "She could bat with more freedom," he says. "And I think she has quit captaincy at the right time. Smriti also deserves to be a captain for a few years. And I also think it is good that they did not split the captaincy between formats. It is always to have just one captain. Multiple captains could create issues within the team."

There isn't, of course, a better option than Smriti to lead India in all formats. And she was quick to pay a tribute to Harmanpreet's captaincy.

"It has been a pleasure playing with you for so many years," Smriti wrote on social media. "Ten years of your leadership have been fantastic and together, we will strive to bring many more laurels for our nation."

Smriti's opening partner Shafali also spoke of how much Harmanpreet meant to her.

"Since the day I made my debut, you have always been there for me, on and off the field," said the swashbuckling opener. "From guiding me through the early days to standing by me through everything, I have always known I could count on you."

Those words from Shafali actually reveal something about Harmanpreet. She nurtured young talents – be it Shafali, Shree Charani or Kranti Gaud – and encouraged them always. One has seen her wax eloquent about those youngsters at press conferences several times. You could understand how much their successes meant to her.

She was excited to see the emergence of Kranti as a quality seamer that India desperately wanted. And she made Shafali bowl when not many were expecting her to. The emergence of Shafali as a spinner who could bowl at different stages of a match has given the Indian attack an excellent option. She has justified her captain's faith in her with some fine spells.

Shubhangi feels Harmanpreet deserves credit for handling the transition period in Indian women's cricket well. "She is the only player in the team from the time WCAI (Women's Cricket Association of India), of which I was the secretary, was running the game," she says. "We had to struggle for funds, and things were not easy at all for India's female cricketers. Now there is money and opportunities for our players."

Harmanpreet could always be proud about her role in taking women's cricket forward. That is something nobody could take away from her. And that World Cup.

Captaincy matters in cricket. Harmanpreet has shown that, the way few women in international cricket have.

THE GIST

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I have given everything I had to this team and to Indian women's cricket – my blood, my sweat, my time, and many times, a part of my own game and personal ambitions. There were moments when I had to put aside my individual performance, my own growth, and what I wanted for myself

India's water plants are failing to catch elusive 'forever chemicals'

Many studies from different parts of India have already found polyfluoroalkyl substances in water sources; conventional water treatment systems that can remove these compounds are not yet commercially available even as the extent of the contamination across India remains unclear

Rohan Singh
LUCKNOW

PFASs have been around for 60 years. India has no PFAS-specific drinking-water limit under the current standard, although this could change. AFP

THE GIST

Finding PFAS in water does not, by itself, tell us how much of a health risk it poses; that depends on the type of PFAS, the dose, duration of exposure, and route of exposure

The Union Environment Ministry has said there is no specific regulation banning PFAS manufacturing

The Bureau of Indian Standards said a dedicated Working Group on Emerging Contaminants and Forever Chemicals is examining PFAS limits and associated contaminants

The scope and number of PFAS to be included have not yet been finalised, while analytical methods for PFAS in drinking water are also being considered

Polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) are synthetic chemical compounds that contain multiple carbon-fluorine bonds. PFAS materials are used in coatings, textiles, and several industrial products. They are also notorious for resisting degradation and can contaminate the environment for a very long time.

Many studies from different parts of India have already found PFAS in water sources. Conventional water treatment systems that can remove these compounds are not yet commercially available even as the extent of PFAS contamination across India remains unclear.

In a 2025 review in the *Journal of Hazardous Materials Advances*, scientists examined monitoring and regulations across Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and West Bengal. The review's first author, Rajneesh Kumar Gautam, of the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, said the evidence establishes that PFAS contamination in India is a legitimate concern but that its national extent is poorly defined, thanks in part to differences in the way different research groups test and analyse PFAS.

This particular lacuna has been identified in multiple studies of late.

For example, in a 2024 paper in *Environmental Sciences Europe*, researchers from IIT-Madras reported the analysis of 14 water samples collected between 2022 and 2023 from groundwater, surface water, and the four stages of a water treatment plant in Chennai. The team found that groundwater from residential wells in the vicinity of garbage dumps had the highest PFAS levels.

At the treatment plant, concentrations of all eight target PFAS were 5% to 103% higher in treated water than in raw water. Study coauthor Indumathi M. Nambi, a professor of environmental engineering, suggested the increase may reflect unidentified precursors that turned into more stable PFAS inside the plant. The study did not quantify those precursors.

The eight target PFAS, Dr. Nambi said, represented only a fraction of the potentially diverse fluorinated compounds that may be present. She recommended that testing should thus include other PFAS materials that may be present in the water, rather than relying only on a fixed list.

Resolving mixed sources

On July 16 this year, researchers from GITAM (Deemed to be) University, Hyderabad, and from Canada and the U.S. reported the results of testing 77 kinds of PFAS in seawater and sewage from around Visakhapatnam. The findings, published in *npj Emerging Contaminants*, showed the presence of 38 compounds, with concentrations in sewage ranging from low to very high.

The team also used a model to estimate that sewage accounted for about 41% of median PFAS concentrations along the coast. GITAM assistant professor and study coauthor Manoj Rayaroth said distinguishing municipal sewage from industrial inputs would require systematic sampling around the mixing points.

Nejumal Kannankeril Khalid, a coauthor from the University of Montreal, said source-specific sampling together with targeted, suspected, and non-target PFAS analysis, chemical fingerprints, and machine-learning approaches could improve source discrimination and help resolve mixed sources.

Testing for a fixed list of PFAS means substances not indicated on that list may not be detected. Precursors can also change into other PFAS. Dr. Rayaroth said high-resolution mass spectrometry can help identify PFAS beyond a fixed list, but care is needed because PFAS can enter samples during collection and analysis. Removing PFAS from treated wastewater presents another challenge.

Abhradeep Majumder, assistant professor in the Department of Civil Engineering at BITS Pilani-Hyderabad, said conventional biological wastewater treatment cannot remove PFAS. He noted that adsorption-based treatment, which can remove PFAS from water, has shown potential but that low-cost materials designed to capture PFAS still need to be developed.

From detection to exposure

Finding PFAS in water does not, by itself, tell us how much of a health risk it poses. That depends on the type of PFAS, the dose, duration of exposure, and route of exposure. In its 2025 monograph, the International Agency for Research on Cancer classified perfluorooctanoic acid (PFOA) as 'carcinogenic to humans' and perfluorooctanesulfonic (PFOS) as 'possibly carcinogenic to humans'. Both PFOA and PFOS are types of PFAS materials.

The International Agency for Research on Cancer in 2025 classified perfluorooctanoic acid as 'carcinogenic to humans' and perfluorooctanesulfonic as 'possibly carcinogenic to humans'; both are types of PFAS materials

In a study published in February this year a team that included Dr. Nambi found that a mix of 24 PFAS-compounds – including long- and short-chain PFAS molecules and their precursors – delayed the hatching of zebrafish eggs, inhibited the offspring's growth, accumulated in their blood, and reduced their heart rates.

Chirag Dhara, assistant professor at Krea University in Sri City, said incomplete exposure data should not delay controls on PFAS whose hazards are already well established.

Anbumani Sadasivam, principal scientist at the CSIR-Indian Institute of Toxicology Research, Lucknow, said India lacks sufficient baseline data to reliably estimate PFAS exposure. He said CSIR-IITR is participating in a UNEP-funded National Implementation Plan to build baseline data on PFAS in environmental matrices and consumer products, and has developed capabilities to detect 50 multi-class PFAS molecules across different matrices.

The Union Environment Ministry has said there is no specific regulation banning PFAS manufacturing. India has no PFAS-specific drinking-water limit under the current IS 10500:2012 standard. But the standard is now under revision. The Bureau of Indian Standards said a dedicated Working Group on Emerging Contaminants and Forever Chemicals is examining PFAS limits and associated contaminants. The scope and number of PFAS to be included under the revised standard have not yet been finalised, while analytical methods for PFAS in drinking water are also being considered. Dr. Anbumani said India should first establish which PFAS are being manufactured, imported, and used, alongside baseline monitoring, toxicological studies, and enforceable limits.

Girija K. Bharat, a former Scientist at CSIR-CIMFR, said that, to her knowledge, there is currently no clear regulatory pathway for penalising a source responsible for PFAS contamination sources. Dr. Dhara warned that a named-chemical approach could leave precursors and transformation products outside regulation.

Dr. Gautam also said India has enough evidence to introduce precautionary interim limits for well-studied PFAS. He called for harmonised monitoring and broader screening for precursors and other fluorinated compounds.

(Rohan Singh is an independent science journalist in Lucknow. Rohanthakur780@gmail.com)

BIG SHOT

Women from a community group inspect the growth of young mangroves they planted to restore a bare patch in Mida Creek, near Watamu, Kenya, on August 4, 2025. The 17th UN Biodiversity Conference will be held next week in Armenia under the theme 'taking action for nature', bringing together governments, scientists, and stakeholders. AFP

WHAT IS IT?

Rogue AI: deficient design?

Agence France-Presse

More than 200 artificial intelligence (AI) and cybersecurity researchers have called for immediate action to prevent further cases of AI models going rogue and posing a risk to critical infrastructure.

The letter signed by luminaries in the field including Nobel laureate Geoffrey Hinton and Turing Award winner Yoshua Bengio, called for models relating to cybersecurity to be physically cut off from the internet during testing.

Leading U.S.-based AI firms have disclosed over recent months a series of incidents where models under development have escaped containment measures to access the internet and have gone on to hack websites, including gaining unauthorised access to Australian government sites.

"Without immediate changes in AI development and deployment practices, such incidents will continue to occur, and future incidents will be far more damaging to our exposed critical infrastructure," they warned.

Their letter called for organisations developing, deploying, and testing cyber-capable AI models to be air-gapped, i.e. physically cut off from the internet, to ensure they do not escape.

It also called for the creation of an international body that standardises best practices regarding security.

The letter urged companies to be required to report containment failures to the body, which would be responsible for tracking and recording them. "This transparency is required for both learning and accountability purposes," the letter said.

The rogue incidents amplified calls to slow AI development, but the industry and governments are divided on tapping the brakes as well as regulating the sector. In the U.S., the Trump administration has opposed any binding regulation that could hinder innovation, amid fierce competition with China.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Science'

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Healthy life-years saved by limiting global warming

1.89 billion years. Limiting global warming to around 1.8 degrees Celsius, instead of allowing it to reach 4.4 degrees Celsius, could prevent the loss of 1.89 billion years of healthy life to causes such as extreme heat and air pollution, according to new Lancet Commission. PTI

Increase in power demand in T.N. due to El Niño heat

30 in per cent. Rejecting the allegations of high-cost power purchases, Minister R. Nirmal Kumar defended the government's decision to call for short-term power tenders. He attributed the strain on the grid to a 30% spike in demand driven by El Niño-induced heat. PTI

IMF's lowered forecast of China's economic growth this year

4.5 in per cent. The International Monetary Fund (IMF) lowered its forecast for China's economic growth this year to 4.5% on Tuesday, as higher energy prices due to the West Asia conflict and a domestic spending slump weigh on activity. AFP

The value of hydrocarbons Russia exported to Europe

320 in $ billion. Russia said it has sold European countries over $320 billion worth of hydrocarbons since 2022. "For the period from 2022 to today, this figure amounts to $320.7 billion. This is the volume of energy resource deliveries to European Union countries," Russia said. AFP

Farmers on third list for Maharashtra crop loan waiver

3.51 in lakh. The Maharashtra government has released the third list of 3,51,192 farmers eligible for benefits under the Puneashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar Loan Waiver Scheme, State Cooperation Minister Babasaheb Patil said. PTI

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What is preventive detention?

What does the law permit, and where must the State draw the line? What safeguards does the Constitution provide against arbitrary detention? How has preventive detention evolved in India? What is the difference between preventive detention and prohibitory orders?

EXPLAINER

Rizmi Lia M.

The story so far:

The Delhi Police detained more than 5,000 protesters as they tried to reach Jantar Mantar for the protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and a rollback of the SIR. In the lead-up to the protests in Delhi, there was a nationwide crackdown on protesters by the police force. Among those detained and brutally manhandled by the Delhi police were leaders of various political factions, former Chief Ministers, the Leader of the Opposition, lawyers, journalists, students, activists, and reportedly people who were not even part of the protest. Police detained people at representatives' residences even before the protest started, and en route to the protest site. However, the Supreme Court on October 11 directed the Centre and the Delhi Police to ensure free movement of people 'subject to law and order'.

This prompts an understanding of what preventive detention is, how it can be imposed, and how it came into practice.

AISA's Neha Bora during a protest march at Connaught Place in New Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

What is preventive detention?

'Preventive detention' means detention of a person without a trial or conviction by a court. The primary objective of preventive detention is not to punish an individual for a past offence but to prevent him from committing an offence in the future.

Power of preventive detention can be exercised by the authorities on the grounds of public order, security of the State, and law and order.

The National Security Act, 1980 (NSA) allows for preventive detention if the government is satisfied that a person's activities are prejudicial to the defence of India, the relations of India with foreign powers, or the security of the State.

What is a prohibitory order under the BNSS?

Section 163 of the BNSS largely retains the spirit of its predecessor, Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973. It empowers a District Magistrate, a Sub-Divisional Magistrate, or any other Executive Magistrate specially empowered by the State Government, to issue orders when there is sufficient ground for proceeding and immediate prevention or speedy remedy is desirable. The primary objective is to prevent obstruction, annoyance, or injury to any person lawfully employed, or danger to human life, health, or safety, or a disturbance of the public tranquillity, or a riot, or an affray.

The provision is preventive in nature, designed to avert potential harm rather than to punish past acts. The Magistrate must be satisfied that there is an urgency that necessitates an immediate order, even without prior notice to the affected parties.

The power is extraordinary and is intended for situations where the normal course of law enforcement might be too slow to prevent immediate harm. The order must clearly state the material facts upon which it is based, ensuring transparency and providing grounds for potential challenge.

Furthermore, orders under Section 163 BNSS are subject to judicial review by the High Courts under their revisional jurisdiction. The Supreme Court, in cases like *Babulal Parate v. State of Maharashtra* (1961) and *Madhu Limaye v. Sub-Divisional Magistrate* (1971), has consistently emphasised that these powers must be exercised judiciously, proportionately, and only when there is an imminent threat to public order, and not as a routine measure.

How has preventive detention evolved?

Preventive detention in India has evolved from a colonial tool used to suppress political dissent into a legal mechanism intended to protect national security and public order. During British rule, laws such as the Rowlatt Act, 1919, and the Defence of India Act, 1939, allowed the authorities to detain individuals without trial, often targeting freedom fighters and political opponents.

After Independence, India retained preventive detention, introducing the Preventive Detention Act, 1950, which remained in force until 1969. The Maintenance of Internal Security Act (MISA), 1971, further expanded detention powers and was widely used against political opponents during the Emergency (1975-1977). It was repealed in 1978.

The National Security Act (NSA), 1980, subsequently established a continuing legal framework for preventive detention. Other laws, including the Conservation of Foreign Exchange and Prevention of Smuggling Activities Act (COFEPOSA), 1974, also authorised preventive detention for specific purposes.

Meanwhile, amendments to the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), 1967, expanded the state's powers to address terrorism and unlawful activities.

Over time, the Supreme Court's interpretation of personal liberty has also evolved. *Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India* (1978) established that procedures restricting personal liberty must be just, fair and reasonable. However, concerns over prolonged detention without trial, inadequate judicial oversight and the potential misuse of these laws continue to raise questions about the balance between national security and fundamental rights.

What did the Supreme Court order on October 11?

With respect to the Delhi protests, the Supreme Court convened what it called an "extraordinary, exceptional" Sunday (October 11, 2026) hearing to direct the Union government and the Delhi Police to stop illegal detentions and allow free and smooth movement of people and traffic, as well as the operations of Metro and rail services, but "subject to law and public order".

The Supreme Court directed that Delhi Metro and railway services operate normally, and that internet services remain available in accordance with the law. It said the movement of people and vehicles across Delhi must not be unnecessarily obstructed and that barricades must be reviewed based on law-and-order and traffic requirements. The court said there must be no unlawful detention and that all detentions must follow the procedure established by law. It also directed that peaceful assemblies be allowed in accordance with the law, except in areas where prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) are in force. Any notice board announcing Section 163 restrictions near the Supreme Court must be removed, if still in place, to ensure access to the Supreme Court and other courts. The court also recorded the assurance that lawyers, journalists and other professionals would not be prevented from performing their duties.

The court issued notice in contempt proceedings alleging violation of its October 9 order and directed the authorities to submit a compliance report by October 13, including details of Metro restrictions and railway advisories. Habeas corpus petitions alleging mass detentions will also be heard with the main cases on October 13. The court said the State must explain the circumstances, manner and legal justification for the alleged detentions, emphasising its duty under Article 32 of the Constitution to protect and enforce fundamental rights.

What have the courts said about preventive detention?

Earlier, in *Babulal Parate v. State of Maharashtra* (1961), the Supreme Court upheld the constitutional validity of Section 144 CrPC but said it could be used only in emergencies to prevent specific threats to public order. The court held that the power was not "unlimited or untrammelled" and had to be exercised within the limits set by law.

In *Khudiram Das v. State of West Bengal* (1975) Supreme Court observed that the requirement of communication of grounds of detention acts as a check against arbitrary and capricious exercise of power. The detaining authority cannot whisk away a person and put him behind bars at its own sweet will. It must have grounds for doing so and those grounds must be communicated to the detenu, so that, not only the detenu may know what are the facts and materials before the detaining authority on the basis of which he is being deprived of his personal liberty, but he can also invoke the power of judicial review, howsoever limited and peripheral it may be. The detenu has to be afforded an opportunity of making a representation against the order of detention.

In 2012, the Supreme Court criticised the government for imposing Section 144 against a sleeping crowd at Ramlila Maidan in New Delhi during protests against the Congress-led UPA government. "Such a provision can be used only in grave circumstances for maintenance of public peace. The efficacy of the provision is to prevent some harmful occurrence immediately. Therefore, the emergency must be sudden and the consequences sufficiently grave," the court said.

In *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* (2018), the Supreme Court set aside a National Green Tribunal order banning all protests along Jantar Mantar Road. The court said a complete ban was excessive, observing that the "solution was not to ban the demonstrations altogether". It directed the authorities to create a system to regulate protests and grant permissions.

The Supreme Court in the case of *Shaik Naznen v. State of Telangana* (2022) observed that powers to be exercised under the preventive detention laws are exceptional powers which have been given to the Government for its exercise in an exceptional situation as it strikes hard on the freedom and liberty of an individual, and thus cannot be exercised in a routine manner.

According to *Ameena Begum v. State of Telangana* (2023), Supreme Court observed that to unchain the shackles of preventive detention, it is important that the safeguards enshrined in our Constitution, particularly under the "golden triangle" formed by Articles 14, 19 and 21, are diligently enforced.

Article 14 ensures equality before the law, Article 19 provides important freedoms such as freedom of speech, expression, assembly, and movement, and Article 21 guarantees the right to life and personal liberty.

What are the safeguards against preventive detention in the Constitution?

Article 22 of the Constitution provides safeguards against arbitrary preventive detention. Under Article 22(4), a person generally cannot be detained for more than three months without an Advisory Board reviewing the case, subject to the constitutional requirements and exceptions. Under Article 22(5), the authorities must communicate the grounds of detention to the detainee as soon as possible and give them an opportunity to make a representation against the order. The grounds must be communicated in a manner that allows the detainee to effectively challenge the detention.

Preventive detention orders are also subject to judicial review. Courts can examine whether the authorities followed the law, considered relevant material and complied with constitutional safeguards. Therefore, the power must be exercised carefully and cannot be used arbitrarily.

THE GIST

- Preventive detention allows authorities to detain a person to prevent anticipated threats to public order or security, but it must be distinguished from prohibitory orders and other police action against protesters
- Article 22 of the Constitution provides safeguards for detained persons, while laws such as the National Security Act set out the grounds and procedures for detention
- Courts can review state action to protect individual liberty, emphasising that restrictions on protest and preventive detention must remain within legal and constitutional limits

CACHE

Elon Musk claimed that Starlink has not been licensed in India, in spite of spending five years complying with the government laws and requirements. REUTERS

Why is Musk taking on Mukesh Ambani over Starlink in India?

Elon Musk has accused Mukesh Ambani of using his influence to keep Starlink out of India to protect Jio's market dominance, even as Starlink awaits security clearances to begin operations; the spat comes as Jio prepares for an IPO, raising questions about competition and regulatory hurdles

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far:

SpaceX owner Elon Musk has never shied away from starting a social media spat, be it with his own family members or U.S. President Donald Trump.

Mr. Musk has now taken aim at India's billionaire Mukesh Ambani, accusing the chairman and managing director of Reliance Industries of being the real "boss" of India and playing a role in keeping Starlink's satellite internet out of the Indian market to favour Jio.

What has Mr. Musk said about Mr. Ambani?

On October 9, Mr. Musk posted on X a mockingly subservient tweet addressed to "Prime Minister Ambani," apologising for "not realizing that you are the real boss of India," and accused him of wanting to maintain his "monopolistic exploitation of the great people of India," before asking him for permission to allow Starlink to compete in the market. Mr. Musk claimed that Starlink would help close Internet connectivity gaps across the country and could help save lives during natural disasters.

Critics of Mr. Musk were infuriated by what they felt was the undermining of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, as well as the accusation that India's government is under Mr. Ambani's influence. Others flagged that the price of Starlink's service, both hardware and subscriptions, was

Elon Musk. REUTERS

many times more than the services offered by India-based Internet service providers.

On October 11, Mr. Musk posted that competition would benefit Indian customers by giving them more choices and that prices would be adjusted accordingly.

"Ambani's profits will be lower, but he is not going out of business. And, obviously, if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable," stated Mr. Musk.

What is the status of Starlink's licence in India?

Mr. Musk claimed that Starlink has not been licensed in India, in spite of spending five years complying with the government laws and requirements.

In March 2025, SpaceX announced that it had partnered with Jio Platforms to offer Starlink broadband Internet service to customers in India, subject to SpaceX receiving separate authorisations to offer Starlink in India. (A similar agreement was also signed with Bharti Airtel.)

Under the 2025 agreement, the two companies were set to explore service collaborations so Jio Platforms would make Starlink solutions available through its own retail channels.

It is unclear whether that agreement will hold after Mr. Musk's gibe against Mr. Ambani and the Indian government.

Apart from the deals between the two companies, SpaceX has a Global Mobile Personal Communications by Satellite (GMPCS) authorisation from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), *The Hindu* reported this month, but security clearances are pending.

Similarly, ANI reported that licensing was complete for Starlink, Reliance Jio Satcom, and Eutelsat OneWeb, while security checks are in progress.

Why is the timing of this clash significant?

The timing is crucial as Jio Platforms is preparing for an initial public offering (IPO), which is expected to take place later this month, per media reports; a company at this stage likely prefers a stable regulatory environment and positive media coverage.

A world-famous billionaire attacking an IPO-bound company by accusing it of undermining India's market sovereignty could make the situation tenuous. Mr. Musk's intimacy with the White House could potentially escalate the online spat.

Mr. Trump has in the past threatened penalties when other countries – such as Australia and the U.K. – slowed the foreign operations of U.S. tech giants.

Another factor to consider is the ongoing protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over allegations of irregularities in the electoral rolls vetting process. Delhi residents have been affected by one of the largest Internet shutdowns in the capital's history.

By contrast, Starlink has been used to access the Internet during times of war and civil unrest, such as (legally) during Ukraine's defence against Russian invasion and Iran's anti-government protests (illegally). For the Indian government, ensuring that all telecom companies comply with its Internet blackouts is a serious priority.

Mr. Musk has stressed that Starlink beams are turned off over India, and that illegal use is not possible.

For the time being, the Starlink app remains available for download in the country, advertising a starting price of $55 per month for 100Mbps and unlimited data.

Meanwhile, the Indian government denied that it allowed monopolies to form in any sector.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

A quiz on the much-loved bear and his world on the centenary of the publication of the evergreen children's classic 'Winnie-the-Pooh'

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1
It is well-known that the name Winnie was derived from Winnipeg, the name A.A. Milne's son gave to his teddy bear. Where does Pooh come from?

QUESTION 2
The Winnie-the-Pooh stories are set in Hundred Acre Wood, also referred to as 100 Aker Wood. Name the beautiful landscape that inspired this setting of his beloved stories.

QUESTION 3
In the original stories, what name is painted in gold letters over the door of Winnie-the-Pooh's house?

QUESTION 4
Where can one now see the original stuffed animals that inspired Milne's stories, and which character was added by Queen Camilla in 2026 to complete the set?

QUESTION 5
Name the nook close to Pooh's best friend Piglet's home where the two consider the day's possibilities.

QUESTION 6
Name the other two books featuring the lovable bear and his friends, and which hyperactive character debuted in the final work.

QUESTION 7
What is the contribution of Ernest Howard Shepard to the success and legacy of the Winnie-the-Pooh series of books?

QUESTION 8
Who played the role of an adult Christopher Robin in the eponymous 2018 film in which he is reunited with Winnie-the-Pooh?

Visual Question:
What is the setting for this illustration from one of the original works? AFP

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Considered the oldest Indian club in existence, this team made history in 1911, becoming the first Indian club to win the IFA Shield. Name the club and the nickname given to the winning squad. **Ans: Mohun Bagan, 'Immortal Eleven'**
2. Name the first club from South India and the State in which it was set up. **Ans: RB Ferguson FC, Keralam**
3. The Durand Cup was won by a domestic club for the first time in 1940. Name the club that beat the Royal Warwickshire Regiment 2-1 to end the British monopoly. **Ans: Mohammedan Sporting**
4. This club was named the best in India by the English FA in 1951 after it won the IFA Shield three times in a row. Name the club. **Ans: East Bengal**
5. Name the team of under-15s who defeated its corresponding squad of European powerhouse Liverpool 6-0 this year. **Ans: Minerva Academy**
Visual: Name the club, which recently went through a management crisis, and the UAE-based group that acquired its ownership last month. **Ans: Kerala Blasters, Al Fursan Group**
Early Birds: K.N. Viswanathan | Arun Kumar Singh | Tamal Biswas | Erfanally Oosmany | Sudhir Thapa

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

Is it ok to say, "hook, line, and bait"? (Dr. S. Jayaraman, Chennai)
The correct expression is "fall for something hook, line, and sinker". The word "fall" here means "to believe". So when you fall for a story "hook, line, and sinker", you believe the story completely, although it sounds pretty far-fetched. The expression means the same thing as "lock, stock, and barrel". When you say that someone fell for something hook, line and sinker, you are passing a judgment on the individual. You are indirectly saying that he/she is pretty gullible; he/she is willing to believe anything somebody tells him/her. One can also say "swallow/buy something hook, line, and sinker".

Shyam expected his students to swallow his explanation hook, line, and sinker.

Another common expression is, "fall hook, line, and sinker in love with someone/something".

This is an expression that comes from the sport of fishing. I understand that sometimes a fish not only swallows the hook to which the bait is attached, but also some of the "line". The sinker is the weight that is used to take the fishing line to the bottom. It is, however, very uncommon for a fish to swallow the "sinker". So, if someone swallows your story hook, line and sinker, he/she believes your tall tale.

What is the difference between "cost" and "price"? (Usha Karthikeyan, T.N.)
Most people tend to use these words interchangeably when they want to mean the amount of money required to buy something. For example, we can say, "What is the price of the car?" or "How much does the car cost"? In business, however, the two words have a different meaning. When you talk about the "cost" of something, what you are referring to is the amount of money that you spent to make that particular thing. For example, when businessmen talk about the cost of a car, they are referring to the amount they spent manufacturing it. "Price", on the other hand, refers to the amount of money that the car is sold for. It is the amount that the customer pays. A toy may cost Rs. 200 to manufacture, but it may be priced at Rs. 500.

The word "cost", unlike the word "price", is normally used with services. For example, one talks about the cost of getting one's car repaired, and the cost of going on holiday. "Cost" is also used with abstractions; one talks about the "cost of living", the "cost of war", etc. When you wish to use an adjective, then it is "price" that is used. For example, you talk about "exorbitant" prices, "great prices", and "bargain prices". As everyone knows, every politician has his/her price. Yes, the word price is normally used when you wish to bribe someone. You can tell the individual to name his/her price.

Is it ok to say, "All classes are suspended in the aftermath of the All India elocution competition"? (V. S. Uday, Sringeri)
The word "aftermath" was first used to refer to the second crop; that is, the crop that grew after the first crop was cut. These days the word is figuratively used to refer to the period that follows an event. But what is important to remember is that the preceding event is usually associated with something terrible - an earthquake, an explosion, a war, etc.
Published in The Hindu on April 2, 2002

Word of the day

Dilettante:
an amateur who engages in an activity without serious intentions and who pretends to have knowledge

Synonyms: inexperienced, unskilled, unprofessional, inexpert

Usage: *He is a dilettante who paints for fun.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/dilettante

International Phonetic Alphabet: /dɪlɪtænti/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'